

# Future Perfect

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# Grammar Notes

## FUTURE PERFECT

### A. Introduction

The future perfect is used to talk about two actions that will occur at two different times in the future. In a future perfect sentence, the first action uses the *future perfect* tense and the second action (further into the future) uses the *simple present* tense.

| Future Perfect |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram        | <div style="display: flex; align-items: center;"> <div style="text-align: center; margin-right: 20px;"> <p>6:00 pm</p> <p><b>1</b></p> <p><b>X</b></p> <p>I will eat dinner.</p> </div> <div style="text-align: center; margin-right: 20px;"> <p>8:00 pm</p> <p><b>2</b></p> <p><b>X</b></p> <p>He will call me.</p> </div> <div> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>will have eaten</b> dinner by the time he calls me.</li> <li>By the time he calls me, I <b>will have eaten</b> dinner.</li> </ul> </div> </div> |
| Form           | will + have + past participle                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Function       | one future action will happen before another future action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Time Markers   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>by the time</li> <li>when</li> <li>before</li> </ul> <p>(Note that other time markers such as <i>next</i>, <i>tomorrow</i>, and <i>from now</i> are often used in the dependent clause.)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Examples       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Our manager <b>will have gone home</b> by the time we finish this project.</li> <li>By the time he moves to Seattle, he <b>will have quit</b> his job.</li> <li>When she gets back to me next week, I <b>will have made</b> other plans.</li> <li>They'll <b>have handed out</b> five dozen fliers before they call it a night.</li> <li>Uni <b>will</b> already <b>have accepted</b> another job offer when they get back to her two weeks from now.</li> </ul>                       |

## Grammar Notes cont.

### B. Notes

#### Note #1

When the dependent (time) clause begins the sentence, we usually use a comma. We don't need a comma when the independent clause begins the sentence. There is no change in meaning.

- **By the time the conference ends,**  
I will have spoken to more than 50 people.
- I will have spoken to more than 50 people **by the time the conference ends.**

#### Note #2

Instead of a dependent clause, we can use an adverb phrase of time (note that a phrase has no subject or verb). Examples of typical phrases include *by July 2030*, *by 9:00 tomorrow night*, *two months from now*, etc.

- They will have completed construction on the new building **three months from now.**
- **By 5:00 pm tomorrow,** we will have wrapped up the negotiations and finalized the deal.

#### Note #3

A future perfect action can be repeated, or there could be multiple actions before the final one.

- **I'll have gone to the gym hundreds of times** before it closes next December.
- **They will have cleaned their condo and prepared all the food** by the time their guests arrive at 8:00 pm.

#### Note #4

The future perfect is not as common as the simple future. In fact, we can often use the simple future instead of the future perfect, especially in informal situations (mostly when a time marker other than "by the time" is used). There is often no change in meaning.

- I **will have turned off** all the lights before I leave the house.
- I **will turn off** all the lights before I leave the house. (*more common*)

## Exercise 1

### FILL IN THE BLANKS

Write the future perfect or simple present tense of the verbs below.

- Ex. By the time Min Jun gets to the theater, the movie will have started .  
(start)
1. By the time Sonya finishes work, her boyfriend \_\_\_\_\_ dinner.  
(make)
  2. Malik \_\_\_\_\_ his third week on the job by this time next Tuesday.  
(complete)
  3. When Daniel \_\_\_\_\_ work, everyone will already have left the office.  
(wrap up)
  4. I \_\_\_\_\_ to bed before my wife gets home tonight.  
(go)
  5. The baseball field will have become muddy by the time it \_\_\_\_\_ raining.  
(stop)
  6. By the time Adrian heads home, the sun \_\_\_\_\_ .  
(set)
  7. Mariam \_\_\_\_\_ her degree by next May.  
(earn)
  8. They will have traveled around the world by the time they \_\_\_\_\_ in Thailand.  
(arrive)
  9. By the time she finishes studying tonight, her brother \_\_\_\_\_ asleep.  
(fall)
  10. Aisha \_\_\_\_\_ her sales training by November.  
(finish)
  11. Mateo and Lola \_\_\_\_\_ from their trip before their son's 18th birthday.  
(return)
  12. All the schools will have closed by the time it \_\_\_\_\_ later this afternoon.  
(snow)
  13. By the time your plane lands, I \_\_\_\_\_ at the airport to pick you up.  
(arrive)
  14. The lecture will have already started by the time Keiko and Ren \_\_\_\_\_ to class.  
(get)
  15. We \_\_\_\_\_ the heavy lifting by the time you get here.  
(do)

## Exercise 2

### YOU'RE TOO LATE!

Imagine you have a friend who's always late. Use the future perfect and the following prompts to give advice or warnings to your friend.

Ex. By the time you apply for the job... (someone else / get)

*By the time you apply for the job, someone else will have gotten it.*

---

1. By the time you get to the stadium... (concert / start)

---

2. By the time you get to the party... (everyone / eat / all the food)

---

3. By the time you call your mother back... (she / angry / for weeks)

---

4. By the time you join a gym... (out of shape / for months)

---

5. By the time you go apartment-hunting... (everyone / rent / good places)

---

6. By the time you hand in your homework... (teacher / already / correct / everyone else's assignments)

---

7. By the time you go to the doctor... (rash / get worse)

---

8. By the time you go to the hospital to visit your friend... (she / go home)

---

9. By the time you arrive at the restaurant... (your friends / leave)

---

10. By the time you do the dishes... (mold / grow)

---

## Exercise 3

### SENTENCE FORMATION

Write future perfect sentences based on the following information.

Ex. Next Tuesday at 5:00 pm, I will leave work.

Next Tuesday at 6:00 pm, my brother's flight will arrive.

*By the time my brother's flight arrives, I will have left work.*

---

1. Next summer, Pavel will graduate. Next fall, Pavel will visit his relatives in Russia.

---

2. Tomorrow at 5:00 pm, Amalia will take her cat to the vet.

Tomorrow at 4:00 pm, Amalia will finish work.

---

3. Next Wednesday at 1:00 pm, Jae will take his psychology exam.

Next Wednesday at 6:00 pm, Jae will attend a history lecture.

---

4. Next week, the Jones family will buy a new car. This weekend, the Jones family will sell their old car.

---

5. Tonight at 7:00 pm, Mr. and Mrs. Kim will get home.

Today at 3:30 pm, the workmen will finish installing their new windows.

---

6. In November 2022, Pablo will go to Qatar to watch the World Cup.

By October 2022, Pablo will save \$3,000.

---

7. Next week, Diego and Sara will get married. Next month, Diego and Sara will move into a new apartment.

---

8. Tonight at midnight, Youssef will go to bed.

Tonight at 11:00 pm, Youssef will finish his homework.

---

## Exercise 4

### PAIR WORK

Fill in the schedule with things you will (or might) do next Saturday. Then, with a partner, take turns asking and answering future perfect questions. Give as many details as you can.

#### Example:

- A:** What will you have done by 11:00 am next Saturday?
- B:** I will have gone for a coffee with my friend by 11:00 am. We meet at Starbucks every Saturday morning at 9:00, and then we go for a walk. What will you have accomplished by 7:00 pm next Saturday?
- A:** By 7:00 pm, I will have finished making dinner for my family, but we will probably still be eating. How about you?

| Schedule |  |
|----------|--|
| 7:00 am  |  |
| 9:00 am  |  |
| 11:00 am |  |
| 12:00 pm |  |
| 1:00 pm  |  |
| 3:00 pm  |  |
| 5:00 pm  |  |
| 7:00 pm  |  |
| 9:00 pm  |  |
| 11:00 pm |  |

## Exercise 5

## MY GOALS

What will you have accomplished in life by the time you reach certain milestones (graduation, 30th birthday, 40th birthday, retirement, etc.)? Write a few paragraphs about the goals and dreams you have for your life. Use the future perfect tense as often as possible.

### Example:

I have a lot of hopes and dreams for my future. I will have studied English for many years by the time I graduate from university, so I will be pretty fluent. A year after that, I imagine I will have started my career as an English teacher...

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

## Exercise 6

### MIXED TENSES

#### A. Complete the Story

Complete the following story by filling in the blanks using the verbs provided. Decide if each sentence should be in the **present perfect**, **past perfect**, or **future perfect** tense. Use the story's context and time markers to help you choose which tense to use for each verb.

I \_\_\_\_\_ so confused lately. I feel like I \_\_\_\_\_ in too  
(1. be) (2. be pulled)

many directions for weeks now. I'm trying to think of what I want to do with the rest of my life so that by the

time I \_\_\_\_\_ from university next year, I \_\_\_\_\_  
(3. graduate) (4. decide)

on a career path. When I \_\_\_\_\_ a teenager, I \_\_\_\_\_  
(5. be) (6. decide)

that I wanted to be a news anchor, but now I don't think I want to be on TV. What I really love is writing.

I \_\_\_\_\_ years writing short stories and newspaper articles. In fact,  
(7. spend)

I \_\_\_\_\_ more than 100 articles by the time I \_\_\_\_\_  
(8. write) (9. enter)

university, so maybe I should become a journalist instead of a news anchor. I can still put my communications

degree to good use!



## Exercise 6 cont.

### A. Complete the Story cont.

Also, my friends \_\_\_\_\_ a lot of my time lately, and  
(10. take up)

I \_\_\_\_\_ as focused on my school and career as I should be. It will be the middle of  
(11. be, not)

the term two days from now, and I \_\_\_\_\_ all my assignments by then because I have  
(12. hand in, not)

been going out too often. I feel so stressed out. Maybe I need a vacation! My best friend is going on a six-week

trip to Europe next month, and I'm so tempted to join her. If I \_\_\_\_\_ to Europe with  
(13. go)

her, I \_\_\_\_\_ many countries by the time I'm 25! That would be amazing. Before  
(14. see)

I \_\_\_\_\_ university, I \_\_\_\_\_ five different countries with  
(15. start) (16. visit, already)

my parents, but I \_\_\_\_\_ to Europe. What should I do?  
(17. go, never)

### B. Discussion

After completing this story, tell your partner or group what advice you'd offer this student. Try to use the present, past, and future perfect tenses as often as possible.

## Exercise 7

### QUIZ

Circle the best answer.

1. By the time this postcard \_\_\_\_\_ you,  
we will have left Paris.  
a) will have reached  
b) will reach  
c) reaches
2. Ali \_\_\_\_\_ his roof before the rainy season began.  
a) will have fixed  
b) had fixed  
c) will fix
3. She \_\_\_\_\_ her training course.  
a) has already begun  
b) had begun already  
c) will already has begun
4. They \_\_\_\_\_ to another city  
before they find new jobs.  
a) will have moved  
b) had moved  
c) have moved
5. Before I \_\_\_\_\_ home tonight,  
I will have completed my assignment.  
a) will head  
b) headed  
c) head
6. Isabella had already arrived in Spain when  
she \_\_\_\_\_ about her host family's accident.  
a) will hear  
b) heard  
c) hears
7. Haru and Ai \_\_\_\_\_ English  
since they were five years old.  
a) will have studied  
b) had studied  
c) have studied
8. By the time Daila got to class, it \_\_\_\_\_.  
a) will have started  
b) had started  
c) have started
9. By the time Johanne \_\_\_\_\_ a new car, he will  
have saved enough money for the down payment.  
a) will buy  
b) buy  
c) buys
10. By next December,  
I \_\_\_\_\_ in California for 15 years.  
a) will have lived  
b) had lived  
c) have lived
11. It's our anniversary today,  
and we \_\_\_\_\_ for 25 years.  
a) will have been married  
b) had been married  
c) have been married
12. Our new office building \_\_\_\_\_  
by this time next year.  
a) will have been built  
b) will have built  
c) will build

# Answer Key

## LESSON DESCRIPTION:

Students learn how and when to use the future perfect tense in English. This lesson includes mixed exercises that combine the present perfect, past perfect, and future perfect tenses.

**LEVEL:** Adv

**TIME:** 2 hours

**TAGS:** future perfect, simple present, present perfect, past perfect, verbs, verb tenses, grammar, grammar exercises

## Exercise 1

- |                        |                            |
|------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1. will have made      | 9. will have fallen asleep |
| 2. will have completed | 10. will have finished     |
| 3. wraps up            | 11. will have returned     |
| 4. will have gone      | 12. snows                  |
| 5. stops               | 13. will have arrived      |
| 6. will have set       | 14. get                    |
| 7. will have earned    | 15. will have done         |
| 8. arrive              |                            |

## Exercise 2

Answers may vary slightly. As a follow-up, ask students to form the future perfect passive in sentences 2 and 5. (Answers: 2. *By the time you get to the party, all the food will have been eaten.* 5. *By the time you go apartment-hunting, the good places will have been rented.*) As an additional follow-up, pair up your students and get them to offer each other advice/warnings of their own using *by the time* and the future perfect.

- By the time you get to the stadium, the concert will have started.
- By the time you get to the party, everyone will have eaten all the food.
- By the time you call your mother back, she will have been angry for weeks.
- By the time you join a gym, you will have been out of shape for months.
- By the time you go apartment-hunting, everyone will have rented the good places.
- By the time you hand in your homework, the teacher will already have corrected everyone else's assignments.\*  
(\*Note: Placement of *already* can vary.)

- By the time you go to the doctor, your rash will have gotten worse.
- By the time you go to the hospital to visit your friend, she will have gone home.
- By the time you arrive at the restaurant, your friends will have left.
- By the time you do the dishes, mold will have grown.

## Exercise 3

Answers will vary. Encourage students to vary beginning their sentences with the dependent or independent clause and to try using a variety of time markers.

- Pavel will have graduated by the time he visits his relatives in Russia.
- By the time Amalia takes her cat to the vet, she will have finished work.
- Jae will have taken his psychology exam before he attends a history lecture.
- By the time the Jones family buys a new car, they will have sold their old one.
- By the time Mr. and Mrs Kim get home, the workmen will have finished installing their new windows.
- Pablo will have saved \$3,000 before he goes to Qatar to watch the World Cup.
- Diego and Sara will have gotten married before they move into a new apartment.
- When Youssef goes to bed tonight, he will have finished his homework.

(continued on the next page...)

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 4

Answers will vary. Follow up by having each student share an item or two from their partner's schedule (using the future perfect) with the class.

### Exercise 5

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 6

- |                      |                                       |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 1. have been         | 10. have taken up                     |
| 2. have been pulled  | 11. haven't been                      |
| 3. graduate          | 12. won't have handed in              |
| 4. will have decided | 13. go                                |
| 5. was               | 14. will have seen                    |
| 6. had decided       | 15. started                           |
| 7. have spent        | 16. had already visited               |
| 8. had written       | 17. have/had never gone/<br>didn't go |
| 9. entered           |                                       |

### Exercise 7

- |      |      |      |      |       |       |
|------|------|------|------|-------|-------|
| 1. c | 3. a | 5. c | 7. c | 9. c  | 11. c |
| 2. b | 4. a | 6. b | 8. b | 10. a | 12. a |

#### SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Theater*, *Traveled*, and *Mold*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Theatre*, *Travelled*, and *Mould*. Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

#### EDITOR'S NOTE:

For practice comparing the future perfect with the future perfect progressive tense, please see our future perfect progressive lesson: <https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/1972>

# Future Perfect Progressive

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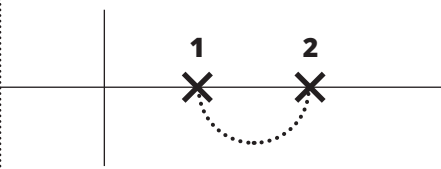
|           |                                                                                                       |
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## Grammar Notes

### A. The Future Perfect Progressive

The future perfect progressive (also called the *future perfect continuous*) is used when we need to discuss two future actions, where the first action continues to the second action.

The future perfect progressive is not commonly used in English because we don't usually need to imagine such a specific future situation, but it is needed occasionally in speaking and writing.

| Tense        | Future Perfect Progressive                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Form         | will + have + been + -ing verb (present participle)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Function     | Two actions will occur in the future. The first (long) action continues to the second (short) action.                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>by the time</li> <li>when</li> <li>before</li> </ul> <p>(Note that <i>for</i> is also commonly used to indicate the duration of the first action.)</p>                                                                                                        |
| Examples     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>We <b>will have been negotiating</b> for three weeks by the time we reach an agreement.</li> <li>When he resigns, he <b>will have been working</b> here for 18 years.</li> <li>I <b>will have been studying</b> for two hours before she calls me.</li> </ul> |

#### Note #1

In English, the future form is almost never used twice in a sentence. The independent clause takes the future form, and the dependent clause takes the **simple present** (even though the meaning is still a future time). In fact, with the future perfect and the future perfect progressive tenses, the simple present verb is *even further* in the future!

Remember that the dependent clause can come before or after the independent clause. When it comes before the independent clause, a comma is needed.

- She will have been talking for two hours **by the time he needs the phone.**
- **By the time he needs the phone,** she will have been talking for two hours.

## Grammar Notes cont.

### A. The Future Perfect Progressive cont.

#### Note #2

Sometimes the dependent clause is just an adverb phrase of time and not a complete sentence with a present verb. Because these phrases indicate a future time, they are often used with the future perfect progressive. Examples of typical phrases include *by this time next month*, *by July 2028*, *by 6:00 tomorrow*, etc.

- **By this time next month**, I will have been working on this project for 11 months.
- **By the year 2030**, she will have been living there for a long, long time.
- **By 10:00 am on Friday**, they will have been mulling over the problem for 48 hours.

#### Note #3

This verb tense has four parts to it! Here's how it is formed:

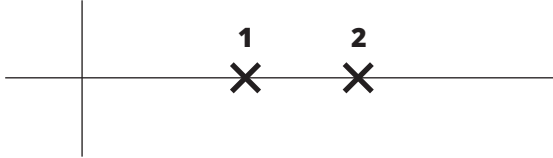
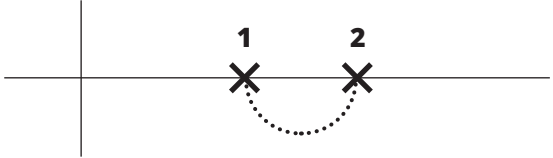
1. **Future Perfect** = will + have + past participle (e.g., *will have studied*)
2. **Progressive** = be + -ing verb (e.g., *be studying*)
3. **The Past Participle of Be** (the first part of the progressive form) = been
4. **Final Result** = will + have + been + -ing verb

|                                   |                            |        |                 |           |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------|--------|-----------------|-----------|
| <b>Future Perfect</b>             | will +                     | have + | past participle |           |
| <b>Progressive</b>                | ↓                          | ↓      | be +            | -ing verb |
| <b>Future Perfect Progressive</b> | will +                     | have + | been +          | -ing verb |
| <b>Example</b>                    | I will have been studying. |        |                 |           |

## Grammar Notes cont.

### B. The Future Perfect Vs. The Future Perfect Progressive

How can we tell when the future perfect tense is required instead of the future perfect progressive? With the future perfect, two future actions happen at different times in the future. The first action is finished before the second one occurs. Compare these two tenses in the chart below.

| Tense        | Future Perfect                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Future Perfect Progressive                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Form         | will + have + past participle                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | will + have + been + -ing verb                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Function     | The first future action will <b>finish</b> before the second future action.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | The first future action will <b>continue</b> until the second future action.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>by the time</li> <li>when</li> <li>before</li> </ul> (Note: The typical future markers <i>next</i> and <i>tomorrow</i> are often additionally used.)                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>by the time</li> <li>when</li> <li>before</li> </ul> (Note: The typical progressive marker <i>for</i> is also commonly used.)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Examples     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>will have finished</b> dinner by the time she calls me tonight.</li> <li>By the time my teacher quizzes us tomorrow, I <b>will have memorized</b> all the facts.</li> <li>That student <b>will have graduated</b> before he gets his essay back next week.</li> <li>You <b>will already have left</b> when he gets home from his trip.</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>will have been studying</b> for two hours by the time she calls me tonight.</li> <li>By the time she comes over, my kids <b>will have been sleeping</b> for an hour.</li> <li>When I move to Vancouver next July, my best friend <b>will have been living</b> there for two years already.</li> <li>They <b>will have been hanging out</b> at the bar for hours before I join them.</li> </ul> |

## Exercise 1

### FILL IN THE BLANKS

Write the future perfect progressive form of the verbs in parentheses.

Ex. By the time he arrives, I will have been cleaning for an hour.  
(clean)

1. She \_\_\_\_\_ for weeks before she feels confident about next month's test.  
(study)
2. They \_\_\_\_\_ for nine hours by 8:00 am tomorrow.  
(sleep)
3. By the time you call, I \_\_\_\_\_ all afternoon.  
(bake)
4. We \_\_\_\_\_ for 45 minutes when you join us.  
(jog)
5. \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ all day by the time I come over?  
(prepare)
6. My coworker \_\_\_\_\_ here for six years by July 2021.  
(work)
7. By the time she gets back, her parents \_\_\_\_\_ about her for days.  
(worry)
8. By 5:00 pm, we \_\_\_\_\_ for three hours.  
(negotiate)
9. By the time he gets organized, they \_\_\_\_\_ around for ages.  
(wait)
10. When my boss finally hires someone new, I \_\_\_\_\_ two jobs for at least six months.  
(do)

## Exercise 2

### FIND THE ERROR

Find one error in each sentence and correct it on the line below.

Ex. By 7:00, we will have studying for 90 minutes.

*By 7:00, we will have been studying for 90 minutes.*

---

1. By the time the meeting over, they will have been sitting since 9:00 am.

---

2. Christina will have been traveling for two years before she will return home.

---

3. By this time next year, I will have learning English for five years.

---

4. He will has been watching TV all morning before his girlfriend arrives.

---

5. Keiko will have being listening to music for hours when I get home tonight.

---

6. My friend will have been practicing the guitar since 15 years by 2028.

---

7. By the time my neighbor come over, I will have been reading for half an hour.

---

8. We will have been driving around for hours before he will ask for directions.

---

## Exercise 3

### FUTURE PERFECT PROGRESSIVE SENTENCES

Write sentences using the future perfect progressive tense. The first sentence should start with a dependent clause, and the second should start with an independent clause. Watch your punctuation.

Ex. June 2026 / Maria / study / English / five years

*By June 2026, Maria will have been studying English for five years.*

*Maria will have been studying English for five years by June 2026.*

1. 8:00 pm / Michelle / wait / boyfriend / two hours

---

---

2. You / graduate / you / attend / university / four years

---

---

3. Next Monday / Sergio / practice / his speech / 11 days

---

---

4. She / go / the interview / she / look / new job / three weeks

---

---

5. Our band / perform / we / rehearse / months

---

---

6. Next June / Phillip / practice / karate / ten years

---

---

## Exercise 4

### FUTURE PERFECT VS. FUTURE PERFECT PROGRESSIVE

Write the verbs in parentheses in the future perfect or future perfect progressive tense.

Ex. By the time you go to Europe, the package will have arrived.  
(arrive)

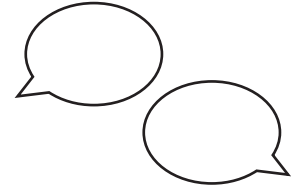
1. Before she leaves, I hope she \_\_\_\_\_ all my questions.  
(answer)
2. They \_\_\_\_\_ to get online for hours by the time the Wi-Fi is fixed.  
(try)
3. Mr. Smith \_\_\_\_\_ by the time I get back.  
(lock up)
4. Marco \_\_\_\_\_ sick for two days by the time his prescription comes in.  
(be)
5. My neighbor \_\_\_\_\_ all morning by the time I come home for lunch.  
(garden)
6. By the time they walk in, everything \_\_\_\_\_.  
(organize)
7. \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ eating when I come over?  
(finish)
8. By this time next month, our team \_\_\_\_\_ on the project for over a year.  
(work)
9. By the time the counselor sees me, I \_\_\_\_\_ here for over an hour.  
(sit)
10. They \_\_\_\_\_ the invitations by this time next week.  
(send)

## Exercise 5

### PAIR WORK

#### A. Role-Play

Imagine you and your partner are siblings. Your grandmother is coming over to visit next Friday. You find this very inconvenient because you are busy. Takes turns complaining to each other about what your grandma will be interrupting when she arrives (use future perfect progressive verbs). Then think of things you can get done before she comes over (use future perfect verbs).

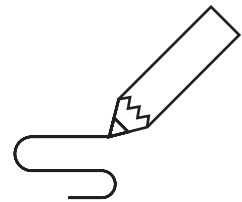


#### Examples:

- When Grandma arrives, I will only have been studying for an hour. That's not enough time to prepare for my test tomorrow!
- By the time Grandma arrives, I think I will have finished my homework. At least I won't have to worry about doing it after she leaves.

#### B. Write & Share

Now write down several of the ideas that you and your partner came up with. Then share them with the class.



---

---

---

---

---

---

---

## Exercise 6

### QUIZ

Circle the correct verb tense for each sentence.

1. By the time she \_\_\_\_\_ ,  
he will already have gone to bed.  
a) call  
b) calls  
c) will call  
d) will have called
2. By the time you wake me up,  
I \_\_\_\_\_ for nine hours.  
a) am sleeping  
b) will sleep  
c) will have been sleeping  
d) will have been slept
3. Andre \_\_\_\_\_ for an  
hour before his alarm goes off.  
a) will has worked out  
b) will worked out  
c) will has been working out  
d) will have been working out
4. We won't have signed the contracts  
by the time the meeting \_\_\_\_\_.  
a) ends  
b) is ending  
c) will end  
d) will have ended
5. My sister will have been helping our mother out  
for two weeks before it \_\_\_\_\_ my turn.  
a) will have been  
b) be  
c) is  
d) will be
6. By the time my son finishes all the  
food on his plate, it \_\_\_\_\_ cold.  
a) will have gone  
b) will been going  
c) will be going  
d) will have going
7. Before I send this email,  
she \_\_\_\_\_ every word.  
a) will have checked  
b) checks  
c) will checks  
d) will have been checking
8. By July 2025, you \_\_\_\_\_ French for 15 years.  
a) will study  
b) will have been studying  
c) will be studying  
d) study
9. They \_\_\_\_\_ before next summer.  
a) will have been graduating  
b) graduate  
c) is graduating  
d) will have graduated
10. The contest \_\_\_\_\_ over for days by  
the time he gets around to submitting his entry.  
a) will have being  
b) is  
c) will have been  
d) will have been being

## Answer Key

### LESSON DESCRIPTION:

In this lesson, students learn how and when to use the future perfect progressive tense in English. It also includes exercises that combine the future perfect and future perfect progressive tenses.

**LEVEL:** Adv

**TIME:** 2 hours

**TAGS:** future perfect, future perfect progressive, simple present, verbs, verb tenses, mixed tenses, grammar, grammar exercises

---

### Exercise 1

- |                              |                               |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1. will have been studying   | 6. will have been working     |
| 2. will have been sleeping   | 7. will have been worrying    |
| 3. will have been baking     | 8. will have been negotiating |
| 4. will have been jogging    | 9. will have been waiting     |
| 5. Will, have been preparing | 10. will have been doing      |

### Exercise 2

- By the time the meeting **is** over, they will have been sitting since 9:00 am.
- Christina will have been traveling for two years before she **returns** home.
- By this time next year, I will have **been** learning English for five years.
- He will **have** been watching TV all morning before his girlfriend arrives.
- Keiko will have **been** listening to music for hours when I get home tonight.
- My friend will have been practicing the guitar **for** 15 years by 2028.
- By the time my neighbor **comes** over, I will have been reading for half an hour.
- We will have been driving around for hours before he **asks** for directions.

### Exercise 3

Time markers may vary.

- By 8:00 pm, Michelle will have been waiting for her boyfriend for two hours. / Michelle will have been waiting for her boyfriend for two hours by 8:00 pm.
- Before you graduate, you will have been attending university for four years. / You will have been attending university for four years before you graduate.
- By next Monday, Sergio will have been practicing his speech for 11 days. / Sergio will have been practicing his speech for 11 days by next Monday.
- By the time she goes to the interview, she will have been looking for a new job for three weeks. / She will have been looking for a new job for three weeks by the time she goes to the interview.
- By the time our band performs, we will have been rehearsing for months. / We will have been rehearsing for months by the time our band performs.
- By next June, Phillip will have been practicing karate for ten years. / Phillip will have been practicing karate for ten years by next June.

*(continued on the next page...)*

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 4

- |                             |                               |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1. will have answered       | 6. will have been organized** |
| 2. will have been trying    | 7. Will, have finished        |
| 3. will have locked up      | 8. will have been working     |
| 4. will have been*          | 9. will have been sitting     |
| 5. will have been gardening | 10. will have sent            |

\*Remind students that non-action verbs like “be” almost never take a progressive form. For a review of non-action verbs, see our Grammar & Usage Resource: <https://esllibrary.com/resources/2329>

\*\*Point out that this is the future perfect **passive** form. For a review of the passive voice, try our Grammar Practice Worksheets lesson: <https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/1601>

### Exercise 5

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 6

1. b) calls
2. c) will have been sleeping
3. d) will have been working out
4. a) ends
5. c) is
6. a) will have gone
7. a) will have checked
8. b) will have been studying
9. d) will have graduated
10. c) will have been

### SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Traveling*, *Counselor*, *Neighbor*, and *Practice*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Travelling*, *Counsellor*, *Neighbour*, and *Practise* (as a verb; *Practice* as a noun). Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

### EDITOR'S NOTE:

If your students need more practice with the future perfect tense, try our Grammar Practice Worksheets lesson: <https://www.esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/1614>

# Future Progressive

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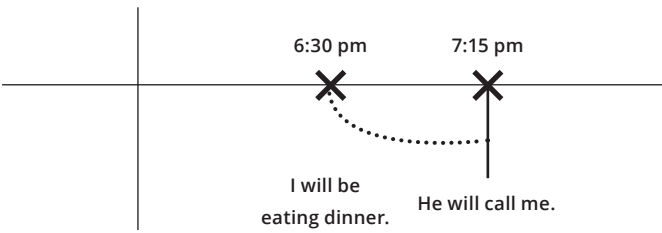
- 2      QUICK AND HANDY GRAMMAR REVIEW**  
The Future Progressive / Simple Future Vs. Future Progressive
  
- 6      EXERCISE 1**  
*Write the future progressive form of each verb.*
  
- 7      EXERCISE 2**  
*Interview your classmates about what they will be doing.*
  
- 8      EXERCISE 3**  
*Correct the errors in the future progressive sentences.*
  
- 9      EXERCISE 4**  
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- 10     EXERCISE 5**  
*Write a paragraph using the simple future and the future progressive.*
  
- 11     EXERCISE 6**  
*Find someone who...*
  
- 12     ANSWER KEY**

## Quick and Handy Grammar Review

### THE FUTURE PROGRESSIVE

#### A. Function 1

The main function of the future progressive (also called *the future continuous*) is to show a continuing (long) action getting interrupted by a short future action.

| Tense       | Future Progressive (Main Use)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram     |  <p>The diagram shows a horizontal timeline. A vertical line marks the start at 6:30 pm. A horizontal line extends to the right. A point on this line is marked with an 'X' at 6:30 pm. A curved dotted line starts from this point and ends at another point marked with an 'X' at 7:15 pm. Below the timeline, the text 'I will be eating dinner.' is written under the first point, and 'He will call me.' is written under the second point.</p> |
| Examples    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>will be eating</b> dinner when he <b>calls</b> me tomorrow night.</li> <li>When he <b>calls</b> me tomorrow night, I <b>will be eating</b> dinner.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Form        | will + be + -ing verb                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Function    | Two actions will occur in the future. The first (long) action is interrupted by the second (short) action.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Time Marker | when                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

### NOTES

- When forming the future progressive in English, the independent clause uses **will + be + -ing verb** and the dependent clause takes the **simple present**. Even though the verb in the dependent clause has a simple present structure, both clauses have a future meaning. Remember that the dependent clause can come before or after the independent clause. When it comes before the independent clause, a comma is needed.
  - We will be playing soccer** when the storm hits.
  - When the storm hits, **we will be playing soccer**.
- Some verbs are common as short actions, and knowing them will help you identify if a sentence needs the future progressive. These verbs include *call, ring, arrive, come, land, hit, and go out*.
  - They **will be studying** when the bell **rings**.
  - She **will be sleeping** when his plane **lands** tonight.

## Quick and Handy Grammar Review cont.

### A. Function 1 cont.

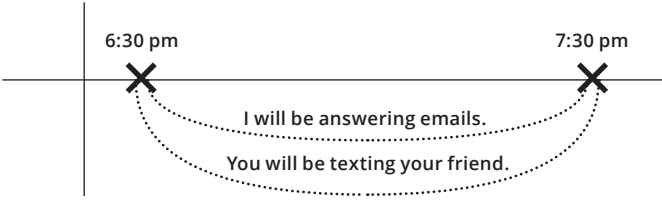
#### NOTES CONT.

3. The short action in a future progressive sentence can be expressed simply by a time reference instead of a full clause. If a time reference comes before the independent clause, the comma is optional because time references are very short.
  - Mr. Ferguson will be collecting the tests **at 3:00 pm**.
  - They will still be arguing **at noon tomorrow**.
  - **At Christmastime** many people will be shopping for gifts.
  - **At 11:00 pm tonight**, I will still be playing the guitar.
4. *Will* is often contracted to *'ll* in speaking and informal writing.
  - You'**ll be doing** the dishes when I get home from work.
  - When I get home from work, you'**ll be doing** the dishes.
5. It is possible to use *be going to + be + -ing verb* to form the future progressive. Because it is such a long verb tense, *will + be + -ing verb* is more common. Note that though we can use the *present progressive* to indicate a simple future tense, we can never use it with the future progressive.
  - ✗ She **is being studying** when I call her.
  - ✓ She **is going to be studying** when I call her.
  - ✓ She **will be studying** when I call her. (*the most common form*)

## Quick and Handy Grammar Review cont.

### B. Function 2

The secondary function of the future progressive is to emphasize that two long, continuing actions will happen at the same time.

| Tense        | Future Progressive (Secondary Use)                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |                                                                                                                                       |
| Examples     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• I <b>will be answering</b> emails and you <b>will be texting</b> your friend.</li> <li>• You'll <b>be texting</b> your friend, and I'll <b>be answering</b> emails.</li> </ul> |
| Form         | will + be + -ing verb                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Function     | Two long actions will occur at the same time in the future.                                                                                                                                                             |
| Time Markers | The adverb "while" is possible, but the conjunction "and" is more common.                                                                                                                                               |

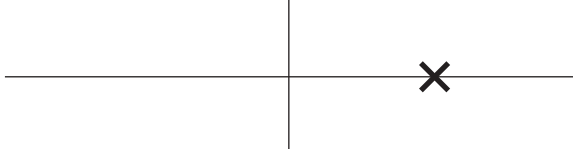
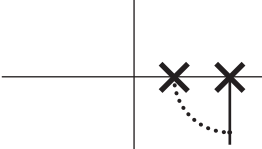
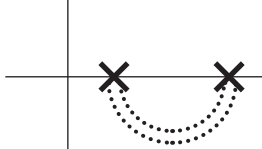
### NOTES

- It is also possible to use the future progressive to emphasize only one long future action.
  - We **will be studying** all night.
  - The audience **will be begging** for more.
- Remember that non-action verbs (*be, have, feelings, states, the five senses, etc.*) almost never take a progressive form.
  - ✗ She **will be having** a new puppy next month.
  - ✓ She **will have** a new puppy next month.
  - ✗ They **will be liking** the performance tonight.
  - ✓ They **will like** the performance tonight.
- The future progressive can also be used to ask politely about someone's intentions.
  - **Will he be bringing** his girlfriend to the party tonight?
  - **Will you be coming** home right after work?
- Note that though two future progressive verbs are possible, it is more common to use two simple future verbs unless you really want to emphasize the long action.
  - ✓ I **will be answering** emails and you **will be texting** your friend.
  - ✓ I **will answer** emails and you **will text** your friend. (*more common*)

## Quick and Handy Grammar Review cont.

### C. The Simple Future Vs. The Future Progressive

The simple future is used to show a future action.  
Compare the two tenses using the diagram below:

| Tense        | Simple Future                                                                                                                                                                                   | Future Progressive                                                                 |                                                                                     |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |                                                                                                                |  |  |
| Form         | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>will + base verb</li> <li>be going to + base verb</li> <li>be + -ing verb</li> </ol>                                                                     | will + be + -ing verb                                                              |                                                                                     |
| Function     | Used to show a future action.                                                                                                                                                                   | A long future action will be interrupted by a short future action.                 | Two long actions will occur at the same time in the future.                         |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>tomorrow</li> <li>the day after tomorrow</li> <li>next</li> <li>from now</li> <li>when</li> </ul>                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>when</li> </ul>                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>and</li> <li>while</li> </ul>                |
| Example      | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>will call</b> you tomorrow night.</li> <li>I <b>am going to call</b> you tomorrow night.</li> <li>I'm <b>calling</b> you tomorrow night.</li> </ol> | I <b>will be sleeping</b> when the girls <b>get</b> home.                          | I <b>will be studying</b> and you <b>will be watching</b> TV.                       |

## Exercise 1

Form the future progressive of the verbs in brackets.

1. The sun will be shining when the kids wake up tomorrow morning.  
(shine)
2. At 3:00 am, she \_\_\_\_\_ .  
(sleep)
3. He \_\_\_\_\_ through Europe next summer.  
(travel)
4. \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ the ceremony tomorrow?  
(attend)
5. When we are in Brazil, we \_\_\_\_\_ with friends.  
(stay)
6. Peter \_\_\_\_\_ and Sarah will be cleaning before the party.  
(cook)
7. I \_\_\_\_\_ still \_\_\_\_\_ at 7:00 pm, so I'll be late for dinner.  
(work)
8. It \_\_\_\_\_ when you leave the office tonight.  
(rain)
9. His band \_\_\_\_\_ at the club tonight.  
(perform)
10. When the bell rings, the students \_\_\_\_\_ outside.  
(play)
11. They \_\_\_\_\_ dinner at 8:00 pm, so don't call then.  
(eat)
12. The party \_\_\_\_\_ still \_\_\_\_\_ at 2:00 am.  
(go)

## Exercise 2

### CLASS SURVEY

Interview the classmates in your group. Find out what they will be doing at the specific times mentioned, and complete the chart below.

| Time                              | Classmate #1 | Classmate #2 | Classmate #3 | You |
|-----------------------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|-----|
| 11:00 pm tonight                  |              |              |              |     |
| 6:00 am<br>tomorrow morning       |              |              |              |     |
| 7:30 am<br>tomorrow morning       |              |              |              |     |
| 10:00 am<br>tomorrow morning      |              |              |              |     |
| 3:00 pm<br>tomorrow afternoon     |              |              |              |     |
| 6:00 pm<br>tomorrow evening       |              |              |              |     |
| 8:30 pm<br>tomorrow night         |              |              |              |     |
| 1:00 pm the day<br>after tomorrow |              |              |              |     |
| next weekend                      |              |              |              |     |

## Exercise 3

### CORRECT THE ERRORS

Find one error in each sentence and correct it on the line below.

1. When my friend get to my house, I will be watching TV.

When my friend gets to my house, I will be watching TV.

2. Michael will living in Russia next summer.

\_\_\_\_\_

3. John will be playing the guitar and Lisa sings.

\_\_\_\_\_

4. She will be sleep when I finish work.

\_\_\_\_\_

5. My sister will being wearing a beautiful dress to the concert.

\_\_\_\_\_

6. The band will be playing their favorite song when he propose.

\_\_\_\_\_

7. He be reading all weekend long.

\_\_\_\_\_

8. When you will be arriving at the restaurant, I will be waiting inside.

\_\_\_\_\_

9. I going to Disneyland on my birthday.

\_\_\_\_\_

10. Tomorrow morning, her dad reads the newspaper and she will be studying.

\_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 4

Decide if these sentences should be in the simple future or future progressive tense, and complete them using the appropriate verb form. Remember to use the simple present form when necessary.

1. My friends will be walking to school when they see the new statue.  
(walk)
2. When the lights \_\_\_\_\_, we will already be sleeping.  
(go out)
3. I'm sure I \_\_\_\_\_ the book you recommended.  
(love)
4. She \_\_\_\_\_ for me at the hotel when the train arrives.  
(wait)
5. My son will be studying when his girlfriend \_\_\_\_\_ him.  
(call)
6. He \_\_\_\_\_ the piano and I will be playing the flute.  
(play)
7. My cat will be napping when I \_\_\_\_\_ home.  
(get)
8. Maria \_\_\_\_\_ happy when she starts her new job.  
(be)
9. My lazy coworker will be daydreaming during the meeting and the rest of us \_\_\_\_\_ hard.  
(work)
10. When my friend \_\_\_\_\_ me tomorrow night, I will be watching a movie.  
(text)

## WRITING

**Example:**

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

## Exercise 6

### FIND SOMEONE WHO

Walk around the class and interview your classmates. If a classmate answers "yes" to a question, write his or her name in the chart.

| #  | Find someone...                                                                | Name |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| 1  | who will be sleeping at 10:00 pm tonight.                                      |      |
| 2  | who will be daydreaming during class tomorrow                                  |      |
| 3  | who will be doing their homework at 7:30 pm tonight.                           |      |
| 4  | who will be playing sports next weekend.                                       |      |
| 5  | who will be watching TV tomorrow night.                                        |      |
| 6  | who will be talking to someone from their country this week.                   |      |
| 7  | who will be going shopping after class today.                                  |      |
| 8  | who will be napping on the way to school tomorrow.                             |      |
| 9  | who will be cooking a big dinner for the next major hoilday.                   |      |
| 10 | who will be wearing fancy clothes on the day he/she graduates from this class. |      |

## Answer Key

### Exercise 1

#### B. SENTENCES

- |                       |                       |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| 1. will be shining    | 7. will, be working   |
| 2. will be sleeping   | 8. will be raining    |
| 3. will be traveling  | 9. will be performing |
| 4. Will, be attending | 10. will be playing   |
| 5. will be staying    | 11. will be eating    |
| 6. will be cooking    | 12. will, be going    |

### Exercise 2

Answers will vary. Monitor students for correct future progressive use. You may wish to write this example on the board: *What will you be doing at 11:00 pm tonight? I will be sleeping at 11:00 pm tonight.*

### Exercise 3

- When my friend **gets** to my house, I will be watching TV.
- Michael will **be** living in Russia next summer.
- John will be playing the guitar and Lisa **will be singing**.
- She will be **sleeping** when I finish work.
- My sister will **be** wearing a beautiful dress to the concert.
- The band will be playing their favorite song when he **proposes**.
- He **will** be reading all weekend long.
- When you **arrive** at the restaurant, I will be waiting inside.
- I **will be** going to Disneyland on my birthday.
- Tomorrow morning, her dad **will be reading** the newspaper and she will be studying.

### Exercise 4

- |                    |                    |
|--------------------|--------------------|
| 1. will be walking | 6. will be playing |
| 2. go out          | 7. get             |
| 3. will love       | 8. will be         |
| 4. will be waiting | 9. will be working |
| 5. calls           | 10. texts          |

### Exercise 5

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 6

Answers will vary.

#### SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Traveling* and *Favorite*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Travelling* and *Favourite*. Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

#### EDITOR'S NOTE:

If your students need more practice with future tenses, try our [Grammar Practice Worksheet lessons](#) on the Simple Future, the Future Perfect, and the Future Perfect Progressive. We also have a simple future / future progressive exercise in our Simple Tense Review: Verb Tense Review 1 lesson.

# Past Perfect

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# Grammar Notes

## PAST PERFECT

### A. Introduction

The past perfect is used for two actions that occurred at different times in the past. In a past perfect sentence, the first past action (further in the past) uses the *past perfect*, and the second past action (more recent) uses the *simple past*.

| Past Perfect |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      | <div style="display: flex; align-items: center;"> <div style="text-align: center; margin-right: 20px;"> <p>6:00 pm</p> <p><b>1</b></p> <p><b>X</b></p> <p>She ate dinner.</p> </div> <div style="text-align: center; margin-right: 20px;"> <p>8:00 pm</p> <p><b>2</b></p> <p><b>X</b></p> <p>I called her.</p> </div> <div style="border-left: 1px solid black; padding-left: 20px;"> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• She <b>had eaten</b> dinner by the time I called her.</li> <li>• By the time I called her, she <b>had eaten</b> dinner.</li> </ul> </div> </div> |
| Form         | had + past participle                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Function     | one past action happened before another past action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• by the time</li> <li>• when</li> <li>• before</li> </ul> <p>(Note that other time markers such as <i>yesterday</i>, <i>last</i>, <i>ago</i>, <i>already</i>, <i>just</i>, <i>still</i>, and <i>yet</i> are often additionally used.)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Examples     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Everyone <b>had left</b> by the time I locked up.</li> <li>• I <b>had</b> already <b>sent</b> email about the missing stop sign before they fixed it.</li> <li>• By the time my girlfriend woke up, the movie <b>had ended</b>.</li> <li>• <b>Had</b> you already <b>heard</b> the news when I texted you?</li> <li>• They couldn't hand in their group project because one member <b>hadn't finished</b> her section yet.</li> </ul>                                                                                                  |

## Grammar Notes cont.

### B. Notes

#### Note #1

When the dependent (time) clause begins the sentence, we usually use a comma. We don't need a comma when the independent clause begins the sentence. There is no change in meaning.

- **By the time I graduated**, I had made many new business contacts.
- I had made many new business contacts **by the time I graduated**.

#### Note #2

Instead of a dependent clause, we can use an adverb phrase of time (note that a phrase has no subject or past verb). Examples of typical phrases include *by July 2010*, *by 6:00 last night*, *by the weekend*, etc.

- **By August 2017**, they had completed the additions to the building.
- She had already left the office **by 2:00 pm yesterday**.

#### Note #3

The past perfect action can be repeated, or there could be multiple actions before the final one.

- **I had texted my son five times** before he got back to me.
- **He had cleaned his room, made dinner, and done his homework** by the time I got home.

#### Note #4

The past perfect is not as common as the simple past. In fact, we can use the simple past instead of the past perfect, especially in informal situations (mostly when a time marker other than "by the time" is used). There is no change in meaning.

- I **had shut down** my computer before I left the house.
- I **shut down** my computer before I left the house. (*more common*)

#### Bonus:

Can you figure out the meaning of this sentence?

All the faith he had had had had no effect on the outcome of his life.

## Exercise 1

### MATCHING

Match the first part of the sentence on the left with the correct ending on the right.

- |          |                                                        |                                        |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <u>g</u> | 1. Her plants died because...                          | a) she had lost her doll.              |
| _____    | 2. He couldn't buy the new computer because...         | b) she had left her purse at home.     |
| _____    | 3. The kids couldn't fall asleep last night because... | c) she had already left the office.    |
| _____    | 4. The little girl was crying because...               | d) he hadn't studied at all.           |
| _____    | 5. I didn't have to buy groceries because...           | e) he had spent all his money.         |
| _____    | 6. He failed his exam because...                       | f) she had forgotten to set the alarm. |
| _____    | 7. The man bought a new camera because...              | g) she hadn't watered them.            |
| _____    | 8. My sister couldn't pay for lunch because...         | h) they had watched a scary movie.     |
| _____    | 9. The woman slept late because...                     | i) I had gone shopping the day before. |
| _____    | 10. I couldn't speak to the boss because...            | j) he had lost his old one.            |

## Exercise 2

### FILL IN THE BLANKS

Write the past perfect tense of the verbs below the blanks.

Ex. The teacher had already corrected all the students' tests.  
(correct)

1. When I got to the house, Mary wasn't there. She \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_.  
(leave)
2. I didn't recognize my old classmate because she \_\_\_\_\_ so much.  
(change)
3. We missed the beginning of the movie. When we got to the theater, it \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_.  
(start)
4. I was very nervous for my first plane trip because I \_\_\_\_\_ never \_\_\_\_\_ before.  
(fly)
5. I couldn't eat much dinner last night because I \_\_\_\_\_ such a big lunch.  
(have)
6. I couldn't make dinner yesterday. When I got to the supermarket, it \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_.  
(close)
7. Last week, our teacher gave back the essays we \_\_\_\_\_ the week before.  
(write)
8. The house was quiet when he got home. Everyone \_\_\_\_\_ to bed several hours earlier.  
(go)
9. They got to school late yesterday. The bell \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_.  
(ring)
10. Aisha couldn't come to my house last night because she \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_ other plans.  
(make)
11. We couldn't find the house. It was clear that he \_\_\_\_\_ us the wrong address.  
(give)
12. Annie didn't want to come to the movie with us because she \_\_\_\_\_ it the week before.  
(see)
13. By the time the police arrived at the bank, the robber \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_.  
(escape)
14. I couldn't get into my house last night because I \_\_\_\_\_ my key.  
(forget)
15. They \_\_\_\_\_ just \_\_\_\_\_ at the resort when they heard about the incoming hurricane.  
(arrive)

## Exercise 3

### BY THE TIME

Use the prompts to make a past perfect sentence with “by the time” and “already.”

Ex. I missed my plane. (airport / plane take off)

*By the time I got to the airport, the plane had already taken off.*

---

1. I missed the show. (theater / movie start)

---

2. I couldn't get my prescription. (drugstore / close)

---

3. I couldn't say goodbye to my friends. (call their house / they leave)

---

4. I didn't get the job. (I apply / they hire someone else)

---

5. We couldn't buy the house. (we see / someone else make an offer)

---

6. The house was destroyed. (the firemen arrive / house burn down)

---

7. I didn't get to taste her chocolate cake. (I arrive / her children eat whole cake)

---

8. I didn't see her when she was sick. (I go hospital / she go home)

---

9. I didn't see the game. (I turn on TV / game finish)

---

10. I missed my daughter's performance. (I arrive concert / my daughter finish her song)

---

## Exercise 4

### NEGATIVE SENTENCES

Complete the negative sentences using the past perfect tense.

Ex. My house was very dirty when she came over because I hadn't cleaned it for weeks.  
(I / not clean / for weeks)

1. Joe had to study hard for yesterday's test because \_\_\_\_\_  
(he / not do well / the week before)

2. I was worried when she didn't arrive on time because \_\_\_\_\_  
(she / not be / late / before)

3. Cala didn't want to go on the school ski trip because \_\_\_\_\_  
(she / not ski / before)

4. I didn't recognize Ellen at the party because \_\_\_\_\_  
(I / not see / for years)

5. Franco didn't catch the bus because \_\_\_\_\_  
(he / not leave / the house / on time)

6. Andy ate a huge supper last night because \_\_\_\_\_  
(he / not eat / all day)

7. The farmers' fields were very dry because \_\_\_\_\_  
(it / not rain / for weeks)

8. Roberta's hair looked messy last night because \_\_\_\_\_  
(she / not comb / all day)

9. Talitha was exhausted yesterday because \_\_\_\_\_  
(she / not sleep / well / for several days)

10. I was so happy when I got to the theater because \_\_\_\_\_  
(the movie / not start / yet)

## Exercise 5

### PAIR WORK

#### A. Speaking

Fill in the schedule with things you did yesterday. Then, with a partner, take turns asking and answering past perfect questions with *already* and *yet*.

#### Example:

- A:** What had you already done by 3:00 pm yesterday?
- B:** I had already gone for a jog by 3:00 pm yesterday.  
By 7:00 pm yesterday, what hadn't you done yet?
- A:** By 7:00 pm yesterday, I hadn't finished my homework yet.

| Schedule |  |
|----------|--|
| 7:00 am  |  |
| 9:00 am  |  |
| 11:00 am |  |
| 12:00 pm |  |
| 1:00 pm  |  |
| 3:00 pm  |  |
| 5:00 pm  |  |
| 7:00 pm  |  |
| 9:00 pm  |  |
| 11:00 pm |  |

## Exercise 5 cont.

### B. Writing

Write your partner's answers in the spaces below using the past perfect tense.

1. \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
4. \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
5. \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
6. \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
7. \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
8. \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
9. \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
10. \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 6

## WRITING

Write a few paragraphs on the goals you have and haven't accomplished in your life so far. Use the past perfect tense as often as possible.

### Example:

When I was young, I wanted to be a journalist. By the time I was 12 years old, I had already had a paper route for two years. By my thirteenth birthday, I had read countless newspaper articles, but I hadn't written any stories of my own yet...

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

## Exercise 7

### REVIEW

Complete the following sentences using the correct form and tense of the verb provided. Use the past perfect, present perfect, or simple past tense.

Ex. Vicky didn't get to class on time yesterday.  
(get)

By the time she arrived, the class had started.  
(arrive) (start)

1. I was disappointed when I \_\_\_\_\_ at the party last night,  
(arrive)  
because most of my friends \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_ home.  
(go)
2. I \_\_\_\_\_ never \_\_\_\_\_ to France, but I would love to go.  
(be)
3. I \_\_\_\_\_ some friends to come for dinner last night,  
(invite)  
but they couldn't come because they \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_ other plans.  
(make)
4. It is still snowing. It \_\_\_\_\_ to snow last night and it \_\_\_\_\_ yet.  
(start) (not, stop)
5. I \_\_\_\_\_ to a concert last night.  
(go)  
I \_\_\_\_\_ it so much because \_\_\_\_\_ to a concert for several years.  
(enjoy) (not, go)
6. I \_\_\_\_\_ home quite late last night. My children \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_ asleep.  
(get) (fall)
7. I know the new neighbors. I \_\_\_\_\_ them last week.  
(meet)
8. Last night, I \_\_\_\_\_ the evening with my friends.  
(spend)  
I wanted to go bowling because I \_\_\_\_\_ never \_\_\_\_\_ bowling before.  
(go)
9. Dalia is still sick. She \_\_\_\_\_ a bad cold for over a week.  
(have)
10. Eduardo wants to buy a new car. He \_\_\_\_\_ this one for 12 years.  
(own)

# Answer Key

## LESSON DESCRIPTION:

Students learn how and when to use the past perfect tense in English. This lesson includes an exercise that combines the past perfect, simple past, and present perfect tenses.

**LEVEL:** High Int – Adv

**TIME:** 2 hours

**TAGS:** past perfect, simple past, present perfect, verbs, verb tenses, grammar, grammar exercises

## Grammar Notes

### B. NOTES

#### Bonus answer:

See if your students can figure out this sentence that went viral on the Internet a while back. If they can't, try explaining it to them this way:

*Think of the first part of the sentence like this: He had had a lot of faith by the time he was an old man. Think of the second part of the sentence like this: His faith had had no effect on the outcome of his life by the time he was an old man. If you join them together, and the context of age is implied, then you can get this result: All the faith he had had [subject] had had [main verb] no effect [object] on the outcome of his life.*

## Exercise 1

- |      |      |      |      |       |
|------|------|------|------|-------|
| 1. g | 3. h | 5. i | 7. j | 9. f  |
| 2. e | 4. a | 6. d | 8. b | 10. c |

## Exercise 2

- |                        |                      |
|------------------------|----------------------|
| 1. had already left    | 9. had already rung  |
| 2. had changed         | 10. had already made |
| 3. had already started | 11. had given        |
| 4. had never flown     | 12. had seen         |
| 5. had had             | 13. had escaped      |
| 6. had already closed  | 14. had forgotten    |
| 7. had written         | 15. had just arrived |
| 8. had gone            |                      |

## Exercise 3

- By the time I got to the theater, the movie had already started.
- By the time I got to the drugstore, it had already closed.
- By the time I called their house, they had already left.
- By the time I applied, they had already hired someone else.
- By the time we saw the house, someone had already made an offer.
- By the time the firemen arrived, the house had already burned down.
- By the time I arrived, her children had already eaten the whole cake.
- By the time I got to the hospital, she had already gone home.
- By the time I turned on the TV, the game had already finished.
- By the time I arrived at the concert, my daughter had already finished her song.

## Exercise 4

- ...he hadn't done well the week before.
- ...she hadn't been late before.
- ...she hadn't skied before.
- ...I hadn't seen her for years.
- ...he hadn't left the house on time.
- ...he hadn't eaten all day.
- ...it hadn't rained for weeks.
- ...she hadn't combed it all day.
- ...she hadn't slept well for several days.
- ...the movie hadn't started yet.

(continued on the next page...)

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 5

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 6

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 7

1. arrived, had already gone
2. have never been
3. invited, had already made
4. started, hasn't stopped
5. went, enjoyed, had not gone
6. got, had already fallen
7. met
8. spent, had never gone
9. has had
10. has owned

#### SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Theater* and *Neighbors*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Theatre* and *Neighbours*. Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

#### EDITOR'S NOTE:

For practice comparing the past perfect with the past perfect progressive tense, please see our past perfect progressive lesson: <https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/1993>

# Past Perfect Progressive

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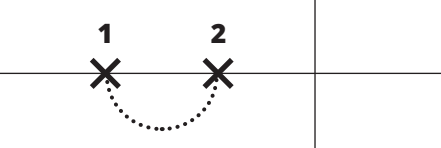
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## Grammar Notes

### A. The Past Perfect Progressive

The past perfect progressive (also called the *past perfect continuous*) is used for discussing two past actions, where the first action continues to the second action.

The past perfect progressive is not that common in English, but it is needed occasionally in formal speaking and writing.

| Tense        | Past Perfect Progressive                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Form         | had + been + -ing verb                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Function     | Two actions occurred in the past. The first (long) action continued to the second (short) action.                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>by the time</li> <li>when</li> <li>before</li> </ul> <p>(Note that <i>for</i> and <i>since</i> are also commonly used to indicate the duration of the first action.)</p>                                                                                                           |
| Examples     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>had been studying</b> for two hours by the time he called me last night.</li> <li>We <b>had been waiting</b> for more than three weeks when the package finally arrived.</li> <li>Before I completed the presentation, I <b>had been talking</b> for over an hour.</li> </ul> |

#### Note #1

When forming the past perfect in English, the independent clause uses **had + been + -ing verb** and the dependent clause takes the **simple past**.

Remember that the dependent clause can come before or after the independent clause. When it comes before the independent clause, use a comma.

- She had been talking for two hours **by the time he asked to use the phone.**
- By the time he asked to use the phone,** she had been talking for two hours.

## Grammar Notes cont.

### A. The Past Perfect Progressive cont.

#### Note #2

Sometimes the dependent clause is just an adverb phrase of time and not a complete sentence with a past verb. Examples of typical phrases include *by July 2010*, *by 6:00 last night*, etc.

- **By August 1998**, she had been living in California for eight years.
- They had been preparing for the meeting for 24 hours **by 10:00 am yesterday**.

#### Note #3

The past perfect progressive is quite formal. Often, in informal speaking and writing, the past progressive can be used instead with the same meaning.

- We **had been waiting** for two hours when he arrived. (*formal*)
- We **were waiting** for two hours when he arrived. (*informal*)

#### Note #4

This verb tense has three parts to it! Here's how it is formed:

**Past Perfect** = had + past participle (e.g., *had studied*)

**Progressive** = be + -ing verb (e.g., *be studying*)

**The Past Participle of Be** (the first part of the progressive form) = been

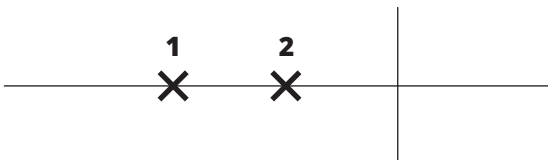
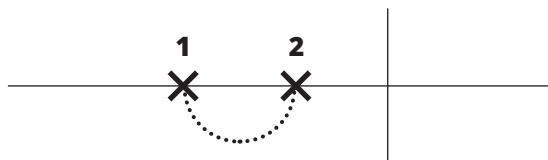
**Final Result** = had + been + -ing verb

|                                 |                      |                 |           |
|---------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------|-----------|
| <b>Past Perfect</b>             | had +                | past participle |           |
| <b>Progressive</b>              | ↓                    | be +            | -ing verb |
| <b>Past Perfect Progressive</b> | had +                | been +          | -ing verb |
| <b>Example</b>                  | I had been studying. |                 |           |

## Grammar Notes cont.

### B. The Past Perfect Vs. The Past Perfect Progressive

How can we tell when the past perfect tense is needed instead of the past perfect progressive? With the past perfect, two past actions happen at different times. The first action was finished before the second one occurred. Compare these two tenses in the chart below.

| Tense        | Past Perfect                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Past Perfect Progressive                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Form         | had + past participle                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | had + been + -ing verb                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Function     | The first past action <b>finished</b> before the second past action.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | The first past action <b>continued</b> until the second past action.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>by the time</li> <li>when</li> <li>before</li> <li>after</li> </ul> (Note: The typical past markers <i>last</i> , <i>yesterday</i> , and <i>ago</i> are often additionally used.)                                                                                                                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>by the time</li> <li>when</li> <li>before</li> </ul> (Note: The typical progressive markers <i>for</i> and <i>since</i> are often additionally used.)                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Examples     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>My friend <b>had texted</b> me five times before I answered.</li> <li>I <b>had finished</b> dinner by the time he called me last night.</li> <li>By the time she got home, someone <b>had fixed</b> the door.</li> <li><b>Had</b> you already <b>made</b> plans when I invited you for coffee yesterday?</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>My sister <b>had been studying</b> English for 11 years before she entered university.</li> <li>We <b>had been waiting</b> since 5:00 pm when she finally arrived two hours later.</li> <li>When he called me at midnight, I <b>hadn't been sleeping</b> for very long.</li> <li><b>Had</b> you <b>been traveling</b> all night by the time you got to your hotel?</li> </ul> |

## Exercise 1

### FILL IN THE BLANKS

Write the past perfect progressive form of the verbs in parentheses.

Ex. By the time she called me, I had been doing my homework for three hours.  
(do)

1. She \_\_\_\_\_ university for six years before she graduated.  
(attend)
2. He \_\_\_\_\_ for nine hours by 8:00 am.  
(sleep)
3. By the time she got to my house, I \_\_\_\_\_ for ages.  
(clean)
4. We \_\_\_\_\_ for 45 minutes before you joined us.  
(hang out)
5. I \_\_\_\_\_ here long before I moved to a new apartment.  
(live, not)
6. My friend \_\_\_\_\_ at our company for eight years before he quit.  
(work)
7. The security guard \_\_\_\_\_ the building all night by the time I got to the office.  
(patrol)
8. By 11:00 pm last night, we \_\_\_\_\_ for only an hour.  
(sleep)
9. \_\_\_\_\_ he \_\_\_\_\_ long when she finally arrived?  
(wait)
10. \_\_\_\_\_ the children \_\_\_\_\_ quietly before their mother got home?  
(play)

## Exercise 2

### FIND THE ERROR

Find one error in each sentence and correct it on the line below.

Ex. By the time my friend arrive, I had been watching TV for two and a half hours.

By the time my friend arrived, I had been watching TV for two and a half hours.

1. My parents had traveling for six months when their motor home broke down.

\_\_\_\_\_

2. By the time John had been getting home, his roommates had been watching the game for an hour.

\_\_\_\_\_

3. She had been studied English for ten years when she graduated.

\_\_\_\_\_

4. You have been playing the drums for eight years by the time you turned 18.

\_\_\_\_\_

5. Jacob had been living in China for five months before he returns home.

\_\_\_\_\_

6. I had been reading for half an hour by time she came over.

\_\_\_\_\_

7. By the time my daughter turned 19, I had been teaching her to drive since three years.

\_\_\_\_\_

8. The staff members have been working for nine hours straight by the time their manager got back to the office.

\_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 3

### PAST PERFECT PROGRESSIVE SENTENCES

Write sentences using the past perfect progressive tense. The first sentence should start with a dependent clause, and the second should start with an independent clause. Watch your punctuation.

Ex. We / go / on vacation / it / rain / two weeks

*By the time we went on vacation, it had been raining for two weeks.*

*It had been raining for two weeks by the time we went on vacation.*

1. They / ask / directions / they / drive around / hours

---

---

2. This time last week / Lisa / lie / in bed with the flu / six days

---

---

3. She / 25 / she / speak / three languages / for a decade

---

---

4. He / get hired / my brother / look for a job / seven months

---

---

5. They / reach / an agreement / the rival companies / negotiate / 72 hours

---

---

6. She / get / black belt / my daughter / take / karate lessons / 2011

---

---

## Exercise 4

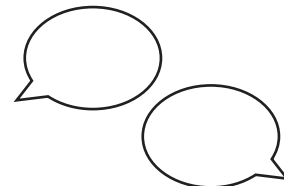
### PAST PERFECT VS. PAST PERFECT PROGRESSIVE

Write the verbs in parentheses in the past perfect or past perfect progressive tense.

- Ex. By the time my coworker bought a new car, she had been taking the bus for 11 years.  
(take)
1. My friends \_\_\_\_\_ to the party by the time I got home.  
(go)
  2. They \_\_\_\_\_ for months when their moving day finally arrived.  
(pack)
  3. Everyone \_\_\_\_\_ the office by the time I finished work.  
(leave)
  4. My son \_\_\_\_\_ at home for 18 years by the time he left for university.  
(live)
  5. When the doctor finally saw me, I \_\_\_\_\_ for an hour and a half.  
(wait)
  6. By this time last month, she \_\_\_\_\_ at this company for 12 years.  
(work)
  7. My neighbor \_\_\_\_\_ his deck for a week before I complained about the noise.  
(renovate)
  8. \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ eating before they came over?  
(finish)
  9. By the time the ceremony was over, we \_\_\_\_\_ that we wouldn't go again next year.  
(decide)
  10. \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ here long before the meeting started?  
(sit)

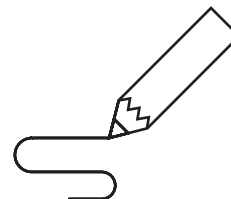
## PAIR WORK

Think back on your life so far. What had you accomplished at age 10, 15, 16, 19, 20, etc.? Tell your partner about some of the things you'd done at certain ages. Use the past perfect and the past perfect progressive.



- When I graduated from high school, I had been studying English for five years.
- I had traveled to Europe twice by the time I was 15.

Now write down several of the accomplishments that your partner told you about.



- By the time my partner was 30, she had been going to the gym for six years.

[illegible]

## Exercise 6

### QUIZ

Circle the correct verb tense for each sentence.

1. Mark \_\_\_\_\_ sick for an hour before his boss sent him home.
  - a) had been feeling
  - b) had been feel
  - c) had being feeling
  - d) had be feel
2. By the time our kids finished their homework, the sun \_\_\_\_\_.
  - a) had been setting
  - b) setting
  - c) set
  - d) had set
3. By the time she \_\_\_\_\_, he had already left.
  - a) calls
  - b) called
  - c) had called
  - d) had been calling
4. They \_\_\_\_\_ shopping by the time the mall closed.
  - a) hadn't finished
  - b) hadn't been finishing
  - c) are not finished
  - d) are not finishing
5. My friend had been helping me with my homework all night before she \_\_\_\_\_ asleep.
  - a) felt
  - b) falling
  - c) fell
  - d) fall
6. By the time you \_\_\_\_\_ me up, I had been sleeping for nine hours.
  - a) wake
  - b) woken
  - c) had woken
  - d) woke
7. Before I finished my report, I \_\_\_\_\_ it for over a week.
  - a) wrote
  - b) had written
  - c) am writing
  - d) had been writing
8. She \_\_\_\_\_ to get an appointment for days by the time a spot opened up.
  - a) had been trying
  - b) had tried
  - c) had trying
  - d) tried
9. They were happy that they \_\_\_\_\_ their house before the end of the year.
  - a) had selling
  - b) had sold
  - c) were sold
  - d) had been selling
10. Her dog \_\_\_\_\_ for two days by the time she took it to the vet.
  - a) hadn't be eating
  - b) had been eating
  - c) hadn't been eating
  - d) had be eating

# Answer Key

### LESSON DESCRIPTION:

In this lesson, students learn how and when to use the past perfect progressive tense in English. It also includes exercises that combine the past perfect and past perfect progressive tenses.

**LEVEL:** Adv

**TIME:** 2 hours

**TAGS:** past perfect, past perfect progressive, simple past, verbs, verb tenses, mixed tenses, grammar, grammar exercises

## Exercise 1

- |                         |                        |
|-------------------------|------------------------|
| 1. had been attending   | 6. had been working    |
| 2. had been sleeping    | 7. had been patrolling |
| 3. had been cleaning    | 8. had been sleeping   |
| 4. had been hanging out | 9. Had, been waiting   |
| 5. hadn't been living   | 10. Had, been playing  |

## Exercise 2

1. My parents had **been** traveling for six months when their motor home broke down.
2. By the time John **got** home, his roommates had been watching the game for an hour.
3. She had been **studying** English for ten years when she graduated.
4. You **had** been playing the drums for eight years by the time you turned 18.
5. Jacob had been living in China for five months before he **returned** home.
6. I had been reading for half an hour by **the** time she came over.
7. By the time my daughter turned 19, I had been teaching her to drive **for** three years.
8. The staff members **had** been working for nine hours straight by the time their manager got back to the office.

## Exercise 3

Time markers may vary.

1. By the time they asked for directions, they had been driving around for hours. / They had been driving around for hours by the time they asked for directions.
2. By this time last week, Lisa had been lying in bed with the flu for six days. / Lisa had been lying in bed with the flu for six days by this time last week.
3. By the time she was 25, she had been speaking three languages for a decade. / She had been speaking three languages for a decade by the time she was 25.
4. By the time he got hired, my brother had been looking for a job for seven months. / My brother had been looking for a job for seven months by the time he got hired.
5. By the time they reached an agreement, the rival companies had been negotiating for 72 hours. / The rival companies had been negotiating for 72 hours by the time they reached an agreement.
6. By the time she got her black belt, my daughter had been taking karate lessons since 2011. / My daughter had been taking karate lessons since 2011 by the time she got her black belt.

*(continued on the next page...)*

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 4

- |                     |                        |
|---------------------|------------------------|
| 1. had gone         | 6. had been working    |
| 2. had been packing | 7. had been renovating |
| 3. had left         | 8. Had, finished       |
| 4. had been living  | 9. had decided         |
| 5. had been waiting | 10. Had, been sitting  |

### Exercise 5

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 6

- |                        |                           |
|------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1. a) had been feeling | 6. d) woke                |
| 2. d) had set          | 7. d) had been writing    |
| 3. b) called           | 8. a) had been trying     |
| 4. a) hadn't finished  | 9. b) had sold            |
| 5. c) fell             | 10. c) hadn't been eating |

#### SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Traveled*, *Traveling*, and *Neighbor*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Travelled*, *Travelling*, and *Neighbour*. Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

#### EDITOR'S NOTE:

If your students need more practice, try our Grammar Practice Worksheets lesson on the Past Perfect: <https://www.esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/1599>

You may also want to point out that the simple past is often substituted for (and is much more common than) the past perfect. The past progressive can replace the past perfect progressive as well. Advanced students should be able to recognize and understand these advanced verb tenses, and they may use them occasionally in formal writing, but they should probably use the simpler verb tenses in most other cases.

- I had finished eating before you came over.
- I finished eating before you came over.
- I had been studying for two hours when you called me.
- I was studying for two hours when you called me.

# Past Progressive

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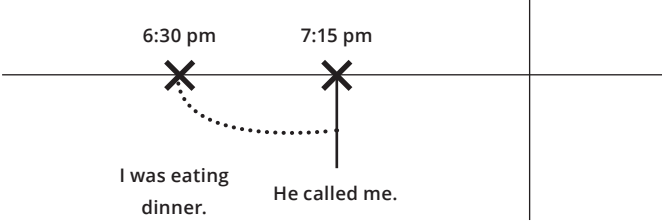
- 2      QUICK AND HANDY GRAMMAR REVIEW**  
**The Past Progressive**
  
- 5      EXERCISE 1**  
*Complete the sentences about the Andersons' busy day.*
  
- 7      EXERCISE 2**  
*Interview your classmates about what they were doing.*
  
- 8      EXERCISE 3**  
*Make sentences using the past progressive and simple past.*
  
- 9      EXERCISE 4**  
*Complete the sentences using past progressive verbs.*
  
- 10     EXERCISE 5**  
*Answer the questions using the past progressive and simple past.*
  
- 12     EXERCISE 6**  
*Complete the sentences using past progressive or simple past verbs.*
  
- 14     EXERCISE 7**  
*Find someone who...*
  
- 15     ANSWER KEY**

# Quick and Handy Grammar Review

## THE PAST PROGRESSIVE

### A. Function 1

The main function of the past progressive (also called *the past continuous*) is to show a continuing (long) action getting interrupted by a short past action.

| Tense        | Past Progressive (Main Use)                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |                                                                                                           |
| Examples     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>was eating</b> dinner when he <b>called</b> me last night.</li> <li>When he <b>called</b> me last night, I <b>was eating</b> dinner.</li> </ul> |
| Form         | was / were + -ing verb                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Function     | Two actions occurred in the past.<br>The first (long) action is interrupted by the second (short) action.                                                                                   |
| Time Markers | when, while                                                                                                                                                                                 |

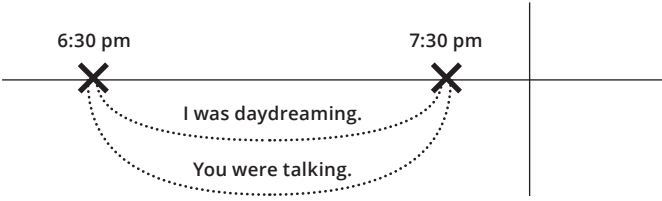
## NOTES

- When forming the past progressive in English, the independent clause uses **was / were + -ing verb** and the dependent clause takes **the simple past**. Remember that the dependent clause can come before or after the independent clause. When a sentence begins with a dependent clause, use a comma.
  - We were playing soccer** when the storm hit.
  - When the storm hit, **we were playing soccer**.
- Some verbs are common as short actions, and knowing them will help you identify if a sentence needs the past progressive. These verbs include *called, rang, arrived, came, landed, hit, and went out*.
  - They were studying when the bell **rang**.
  - She was driving when she **hit** a tree.

## Quick and Handy Grammar Review cont.

### B. Function 2

A secondary function of the past progressive is to emphasize that two long, continuing actions happened at the same time.

|                     |                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tense</b>        | <b>Past Progressive (Secondary Use)</b>                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Diagram</b>      |                                                                                              |
| <b>Examples</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• I <b>was daydreaming</b> while you <b>were talking</b>.</li> <li>• You <b>were talking</b> while I <b>was daydreaming</b>.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Form</b>         | was / were + -ing verb                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Function</b>     | Two long actions occurred at the same time in the past.                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Time Markers</b> | when, while                                                                                                                                                                    |

### NOTE

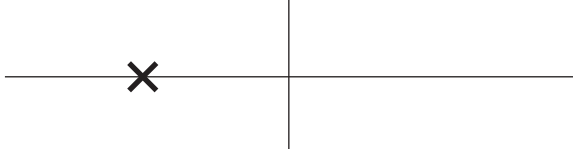
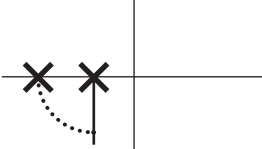
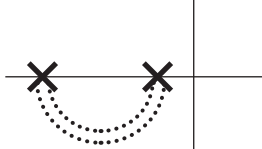
It is also possible to use the past progressive to emphasize only one long past action.

- We **were studying** all night.
- The children **were crying** loudly.
- I **was sitting** on the edge of my seat during the movie.
- He **was** still **playing** the guitar at 11:00 pm.
- At 8:00 pm my brothers **were doing** their homework.

## Quick and Handy Grammar Review cont.

### C. The Simple Past Vs. The Past Progressive

The simple past is used to show a finished past action.  
Compare the two tenses using the diagram below.

| Tense        | Simple Past                                                                                                                            | Past Progressive                                                                   |                                                                                     |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |                                                       |  |  |
| Form         | <b>REGULAR VERBS:</b> verb + -ed<br><b>IRREGULAR VERBS:</b> various changes                                                            | was / were + -ing verb                                                             |                                                                                     |
| Function     | A defined past action<br>(you know when the action occurred)                                                                           | A long past action<br>interrupted by a<br>short past action                        | Two long past<br>actions occurring<br>at the same time                              |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>yesterday</li> <li>the day before yesterday</li> <li>last</li> <li>ago</li> <li>when</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>when</li> <li>while</li> </ul>              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>when</li> <li>while</li> </ul>               |
| Example      | I <b>studied</b> for the test last night.                                                                                              | She <b>was brushing</b> her teeth when the power <b>went out</b> .                 | They <b>were listening</b> to music when they <b>were driving</b> .                 |

## Exercise 1

### THE ANDERSONS' VERY FULL DAY

The Andersons had a very busy day yesterday. Look at the schedule below and then complete the sentences in Part B.

#### A. Schedule

| Time         | Mr. Anderson              | Mrs. Anderson         |
|--------------|---------------------------|-----------------------|
| 7:00 – 7:15  | showered                  | got ready for work    |
| 7:15 – 7:20  | made breakfast for kids   |                       |
| 8:00 – 8:30  | ate breakfast             | ate breakfast at work |
| 9:00 – 12:00 | wrote emails              | taught history class  |
| 12:00 – 1:00 | ate lunch in a restaurant | ate lunch at work     |
| 1:00 – 2:00  | met with boss             | taught math class     |
| 2:00 – 3:00  | met with sales manager    | met with principal    |
| 3:00 – 4:00  | wrote reports             | exercised at gym      |
| 4:00 – 5:00  | picked up kids            | bought groceries      |
| 5:30 – 6:00  | took kids to tennis       | made dinner           |
| 6:30 – 7:00  | ate dinner                | ate dinner            |
| 7:00 – 9:00  | cleaned apartment         | cleaned apartment     |
| 9:00 – 11:00 | watched a movie           | watched a movie       |
| 11:00        | fell asleep               | fell asleep           |

## Exercise 1 cont.

### B. Sentences

1. At 7:10 Mr. Anderson *was taking a shower* \_\_\_\_\_.
2. At 7:15 Mrs. Anderson \_\_\_\_\_.
3. At 8:15 Mr. and Mrs. Anderson \_\_\_\_\_.
4. At 10:00 Mr. Anderson \_\_\_\_\_.
5. At 11:00 Mrs. Anderson \_\_\_\_\_.
6. At 12:30 Mr. Anderson \_\_\_\_\_  
and Mrs. Anderson \_\_\_\_\_.
7. At 1:30 Mrs. Anderson \_\_\_\_\_.
8. At 3:30 Mrs. Anderson \_\_\_\_\_.
9. At 4:30 Mr. Anderson \_\_\_\_\_  
and Mrs. Anderson \_\_\_\_\_.
10. At 8:00 Mr. and Mrs. Anderson \_\_\_\_\_.
11. At 12:30 am Mr. and Mrs. Anderson \_\_\_\_\_.

## Exercise 2

### CLASS SURVEY

Interview the classmates in your group. Find out what they were doing at the specific times mentioned and complete the chart below.

| Time                   | Classmate #1 | Classmate #2 | Classmate #3 | You |
|------------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|-----|
| 4:00 pm yesterday      |              |              |              |     |
| 5:00 pm yesterday      |              |              |              |     |
| 6:00 yesterday evening |              |              |              |     |
| 8:00 last night        |              |              |              |     |
| 1:00 this morning      |              |              |              |     |
| 6:00 this morning      |              |              |              |     |
| 7:45 this morning      |              |              |              |     |
| 8:15 this morning      |              |              |              |     |
| 8:45 this morning      |              |              |              |     |

## Exercise 3

### THE PAST PROGRESSIVE AND THE SIMPLE PAST

Make sentences using past progressive and simple past to describe the situation below. Follow the example given.

- Yesterday, the students at Kelvin High School were all busy doing things when the fire alarm rang.

1. 12th grade boys / play basketball / in the gym

*The 12th grade boys were playing basketball in the gym when the fire alarm rang.*

---

2. school choir / practice for the concert

---

3. the 10th grade class / study Spanish

---

4. principal / meet / with group of parents

---

5. history teachers / discuss / final exam

---

6. custodian / clean / girls' locker room

---

7. the student council / discuss / graduation dance

---

8. actors / rehearse / school play

---

## Exercise 4

Complete the following sentences using the correct form of the past progressive tense of the verbs provided in brackets.

1. They were standing on the corner when I saw them.  
(stand)
2. The sun \_\_\_\_\_ when I woke up this morning.  
(shine)
3. It \_\_\_\_\_ when I left the office.  
(rain)
4. I \_\_\_\_\_ dinner when you called me.  
(eat)
5. She got very sick while she \_\_\_\_\_ overseas.  
(travel)
6. Martin \_\_\_\_\_ in the garden when it started to rain.  
(work)
7. I \_\_\_\_\_ dinner when the phone rang.  
(cook)
8. Mr. Johnson cut himself while he \_\_\_\_\_ .  
(shave)
9. She fell asleep while she \_\_\_\_\_ the movie.  
(watch)
10. Andrea broke her ankle when she \_\_\_\_\_ .  
(skate)
11. While I \_\_\_\_\_ home, I saw a bad accident.  
(drive)
12. She found a ten dollar bill while she \_\_\_\_\_ home.  
(walk)
13. They \_\_\_\_\_ when the accident happened.  
(speed)
14. The baby \_\_\_\_\_ when we got home from the party.  
(sleep)
15. She broke a plate while she \_\_\_\_\_ the dishes.  
(do)
16. When you called, I \_\_\_\_\_ a shower.  
(take)
17. David met his neighbors while he \_\_\_\_\_ into his new apartment.  
(move)

## Exercise 5

### PAST PROGRESSIVE VS. SIMPLE PAST

Read each situation below and answer the following questions.  
Use your imagination to answer the questions in the simple past.

#### A. Dan

Dan was walking to work when it started to rain.

1. What was Dan doing when it started to rain?

He was walking to work.

2. What did Dan do when it started to rain?

He opened his umbrella and ran to the bus stop.

#### B. Maryann

Maryann was writing a letter to her boyfriend when the lights went out.

1. What was Maryann doing when the lights went out?

\_\_\_\_\_

2. What did Maryann do when the lights went out?

\_\_\_\_\_

#### C. Brenda

Brenda was cooking dinner when she saw a mouse on the kitchen floor.

1. What was Brenda doing when she saw the mouse?

\_\_\_\_\_

2. What did Brenda do when she saw the mouse?

\_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 5 cont.

### D. Andrea

Last week Andrea was having coffee with her boyfriend when her boss walked into the café.

1. What was Andrea doing when her boss walked into the café?

---

2. What did Andrea do when her boss came into the café?

---

### E. Kevin

Kevin was painting the house when he fell off the ladder.

1. What was Kevin doing when he fell off the ladder?

---

2. What did Kevin do when he fell off the ladder?

---

### F. You

I was walking to work when I saw the car accident.

1. What were you doing when you saw the accident?

---

2. What did you do when you saw the accident?

---

## Exercise 6

### PAST PROGRESSIVE VS. SIMPLE PAST

Complete the following sentences using the correct form (past progressive or simple past) of the verbs provided in brackets.

1. He \_\_\_\_\_ off the ladder while he \_\_\_\_\_ the ceiling.  
(fall) (paint)
2. \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ when I \_\_\_\_\_ you last night?  
(study) (call)
3. They \_\_\_\_\_ very fast when the police officer \_\_\_\_\_ them.  
(drive) (stop)
4. While I \_\_\_\_\_ to work yesterday, I \_\_\_\_\_ an accident.  
(drive) (see)
5. I \_\_\_\_\_ a great book last week.  
(read)
6. My friends \_\_\_\_\_ for a visit while I \_\_\_\_\_ TV last night.  
(drop in) (watch)
7. I \_\_\_\_\_ Andrea at the party last night.  
(see)  
She \_\_\_\_\_ a beautiful dress.  
(wear)
8. The children \_\_\_\_\_ to bed at 9:00 last night. At 10:00, they \_\_\_\_\_.  
(go) (sleep)
9. We \_\_\_\_\_ dinner at a new restaurant last night. While we \_\_\_\_\_, one of the waiters \_\_\_\_\_ a tray on the floor.  
(have) (eat) (drop)

## Exercise 6 cont.

10. Monty \_\_\_\_\_ in his garage last night when he  
(work)  
\_\_\_\_\_ a loud noise. He \_\_\_\_\_  
(hear) (put)  
down his tools and \_\_\_\_\_ outside into the yard.  
(go)  
While he \_\_\_\_\_ around, someone \_\_\_\_\_  
(look) (run)  
out of his front door. Monty \_\_\_\_\_ the police.  
(call)  
He \_\_\_\_\_ the police that the robber  
(tell)  
\_\_\_\_\_ a black ski jacket and jeans.  
(wear)
11. When Sue \_\_\_\_\_ at the theater,  
(arrive)  
her friends \_\_\_\_\_ for her inside.  
(wait)
12. John \_\_\_\_\_ his leg while he \_\_\_\_\_ football.  
(break) (play)
13. Mr. Duncan \_\_\_\_\_ home last night while his wife  
(get)  
\_\_\_\_\_ dinner and the children \_\_\_\_\_ TV.  
(cook) (watch)
14. Paula \_\_\_\_\_ home yesterday because it \_\_\_\_\_ very heavily.  
(stay) (snow)

## Exercise 7

Write questions in the chart and interview your classmates.  
If a classmate answers “yes” to a question, write his or her name in the chart. Walk around the class and find someone...

| #  | Find someone...                                                         | Question | Classmate's Name |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------|
| 1  | who was sleeping at 10:00 last night.                                   |          |                  |
| 2  | who wasn't sleeping when his or her alarm clock rang this morning.      |          |                  |
| 3  | who was sitting in the classroom when the teacher came in this morning. |          |                  |
| 4  | who was eating dinner last night when someone phoned.                   |          |                  |
| 5  | who was wearing earrings yesterday.                                     |          |                  |
| 6  | who was chewing gum before class.                                       |          |                  |
| 7  | who was doing homework at 9:30 last night.                              |          |                  |
| 8  | who was taking a bath at 10:00 last night.                              |          |                  |
| 9  | who was playing a sport at 8:00 last night.                             |          |                  |
| 10 | who was standing in the hall when the class began this morning.         |          |                  |

# Answer Key

## Exercise 1

### B. SENTENCES

1. At 7:10 Mr. Anderson was taking a shower.
2. At 7:15 Mrs. Anderson was getting ready for work.
3. At 8:15 Mr. and Mrs. Anderson were eating breakfast.
4. At 10:00 Mr. Anderson was writing emails.
5. At 11:00 Mrs. Anderson was teaching history class.
6. At 12:30 Mr. Anderson was eating lunch in a restaurant and Mrs. Anderson was eating lunch at work.
7. At 1:30 Mrs. Anderson was teaching math class.
8. At 3:30 Mrs. Anderson was exercising at the gym.
9. At 4:30 Mr. Anderson was picking up the kids and Mrs. Anderson was buying groceries.
10. At 8:00 Mr. and Mrs. Anderson were cleaning the apartment.
11. At 12:30 am Mr. and Mrs. Anderson were sleeping.

## Exercise 2

Answers will vary.

## Exercise 3

1. The 12th grade boys were playing basketball in the gym when the fire alarm rang.
2. The school choir was practicing for the concert when the fire alarm rang.
3. The 10th grade class was studying Spanish when the fire alarm rang.
4. The principal was meeting with a group of parents when the fire alarm rang.
5. The history teachers were discussing the final exam when the fire alarm rang.
6. The custodian was cleaning the girls' locker room when the fire alarm rang.
7. The student council was discussing the graduation dance when the fire alarm rang.
8. The actors were rehearsing for the school play when the fire alarm rang.

## Exercise 4

- |                  |                 |                   |
|------------------|-----------------|-------------------|
| 1. were standing | 7. was cooking  | 13. were speeding |
| 2. was shining   | 8. was shaving  | 14. was sleeping  |
| 3. was raining   | 9. was watching | 15. was doing     |
| 4. was eating    | 10. was skating | 16. was taking    |
| 5. was traveling | 11. was driving | 17. was moving    |
| 6. was working   | 12. was walking |                   |

## Exercise 5

### A. DAN

1. He was walking to work.
2. He opened his umbrella and ran to the bus stop.

### B. MARYANN

1. She was writing a letter.
2. Individual answer.

### C. BRENDA

1. She was cooking dinner.
2. Individual answer.

### D. ANDREA

1. She was having coffee with her boyfriend.
2. Individual answer.

### E. KEVIN

1. He was painting the house.
2. Individual answer.

### F. YOU

1. I was walking to work.
2. Individual answer.

*(continued on the next page...)*

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 6

1. fell, was painting
2. Were (you) studying, called
3. were driving, stopped
4. was driving, saw
5. read
6. dropped in, was watching
7. saw, was wearing
8. went, were sleeping
9. had, were eating, dropped
10. was working, heard, put, went, was looking,  
ran, called, told, was wearing
11. arrived, were waiting
12. broke, was playing
13. got, was cooking, were watching
14. stayed, was snowing

### Exercise 7

Answers will vary.

#### SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Traveling*, *Neighbors*, *Theater*, and *Practice*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Travelling*, *Neighbours*, *Theatre*, and *Practise* (when used as a verb; *Practice* when used as a noun). Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

# Present Perfect

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| 5  | <b>EXERCISE 1: Past Participles</b><br>Complete the verb charts.                             | 15 | <b>EXERCISE 9: How Long?</b><br>Write questions and answers using <i>how long</i> , <i>since</i> , and <i>for</i> . |
| 6  | <b>EXERCISE 2: Fill in the Blanks</b><br>Choose the correct verbs to complete the sentences. | 16 | <b>EXERCISE 10: Scrambled Sentences</b><br>Put the words into the correct order.                                    |
| 7  | <b>EXERCISE 3: Negative Sentences</b><br>Choose the correct verbs to complete the sentences. | 17 | <b>EXERCISE 11: Writing</b><br>Write about your childhood.                                                          |
| 8  | <b>EXERCISE 4: Already, Still &amp; Yet</b><br>Make sentences about the schedules.           | 18 | <b>EXERCISE 12: Class Activity</b><br>Interview your classmates.                                                    |
| 10 | <b>EXERCISE 5: Ever &amp; Never</b><br>Ask and answer questions.                             | 19 | <b>EXERCISE 13: Quiz</b><br>Choose the correct answer.                                                              |
| 11 | <b>EXERCISE 6: Present Perfect Vs. Simple Past</b><br>Write the correct form of the verbs.   | 20 | <b>ANSWER KEY</b>                                                                                                   |
| 12 | <b>EXERCISE 7: Past Participle Bingo</b><br>Write the past participle form and play bingo.   | 23 | <b>VERB CARDS</b><br>Use these cards to review common irregular past participle forms.                              |

# Grammar Notes

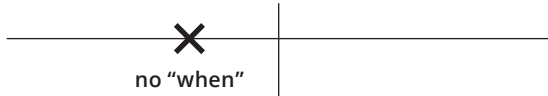
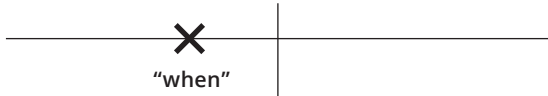
## A. Introduction

The present perfect tense is very common in English. It is unlike other verb tenses because it has two separate uses. One use is a finished past action and the other is a continuing action. Time markers (words that show a verb's tense) show if the verb has a finished or continuing meaning.

Let's look at the finished action use (Use 1) of the present perfect first and compare it with the simple past. Then we'll look at the continuing action use (Use 2).

## B. Use 1

### FINISHED ACTIONS

|                     | Present Perfect                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Simple Past                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pattern</b>      | have / has + p.p. (past participle)                                                                                                                                                                                    | verb + <i>-ed</i> (or irregular forms)                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Use</b>          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>shows a finished past action</li> <li>does <b>not</b> show when it occurred</li> </ul>                                                                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>shows a finished past action</li> <li>shows <b>when</b> it occurred</li> </ul>                                                                           |
| <b>Diagram</b>      |                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                             |
| <b>Time Markers</b> | No time marker is needed, but for emphasis it is possible to use: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>already</li> <li>yet</li> <li>still</li> <li>ever</li> <li>never</li> <li>recently</li> <li>lately</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>yesterday</li> <li>the day before yesterday</li> <li>last</li> <li>ago</li> <li>when (for joining two past sentences)</li> </ul>                         |
| <b>Examples</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>have seen</b> <i>Iron Man</i>.</li> <li>She <b>has</b> never <b>tried</b> frog legs.</li> <li>They've <b>bought</b> a new car.</li> </ul>                                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>saw</b> <i>Iron Man</i> last night.</li> <li>She <b>tried</b> frog legs last month.</li> <li>They <b>bought</b> a new car two weeks ago.</li> </ul> |



## Grammar Notes cont.

### B. Use 1 cont.

#### Time Markers for Emphasis

##### **Already**

*Already* emphasizes an action that has occurred in the past.

**have + already + p.p.**

- I have **already** read that book.

##### **Recently & Lately**

*Recently* and *lately* emphasize a recent past action.

**have + p.p. + O + recently / lately**

- Scientists have discovered a new species **recently**.
- Have you spoken to her **lately**?

##### **Yet & Still**

*Yet* and *still* emphasize the intention to do something.

**have + not + p.p. + O + yet**

- I haven't read that book **yet**.

**still + have + not + p.p.**

- I **still** haven't read that book.

##### **Ever & Never**

*Ever* and *never* emphasize an action that could have occurred at *any* time in the past.

**have + (not) ever / never + p.p.**

- Have you **ever** been to Europe?
- I haven't **ever** been to Europe.
- I have **never** been to Europe.

##### **Repeated Actions**



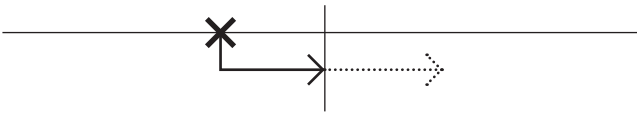
Use the present perfect even if a finished action happened more than once in the past.  
Do not mention **when** it occurred.

- I **have performed** onstage many times.
- We **have been** to Mexico twice.
- She **has given** a presentation five times in her life.

## Grammar Notes cont.

### C. Use 2

#### CONTINUING ACTIONS

|                     | <b>Present Perfect</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pattern</b>      | have / has + p.p.                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Use</b>          | shows an action that started in the past, continues to the present, and may continue into the future                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Diagram</b>      |                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Time Markers</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• for</li> <li>• since</li> <li>• all</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Examples</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• She <b>has worked</b> in this office for two years.</li> <li>• He <b>has lived</b> in the same house since he was a child.</li> <li>• I've <b>studied</b> English all my life.</li> </ul> |

#### **For, Since & All**

*For* and *all* show the **duration** of an action.

- He has taught math **for** 15 years.

*Since* shows the **starting point** of an action.

- We have lived in France **since** 2012.

## Exercise 1

### PAST PARTICIPLES

#### A. Simple Past and Past Participle

Write the simple past and past participle of the following verbs in the chart below.

| #  | Simple Form | Simple Past | Past Participle |
|----|-------------|-------------|-----------------|
| 1  | work        |             |                 |
| 2  | do          |             |                 |
| 3  | eat         |             |                 |
| 4  | call        |             |                 |
| 5  | begin       |             |                 |
| 6  | give        |             |                 |
| 7  | answer      |             |                 |
| 8  | see         |             |                 |
| 9  | have        |             |                 |
| 10 | go          |             |                 |
| 11 | study       |             |                 |
| 12 | teach       |             |                 |
| 13 | make        |             |                 |
| 14 | talk        |             |                 |

#### B. Complete the Chart

Complete the chart below with the correct forms of the verbs.

| #  | Simple Form | Simple Past | Past Participle |
|----|-------------|-------------|-----------------|
| 1  |             | knew        |                 |
| 2  |             |             | met             |
| 3  |             | was/were    |                 |
| 4  | fly         |             |                 |
| 5  |             | wrote       |                 |
| 6  |             |             | read            |
| 7  | live        |             |                 |
| 8  |             | fell        |                 |
| 9  | feel        |             |                 |
| 10 |             |             | taken           |
| 11 |             | drove       |                 |
| 12 | buy         |             |                 |
| 13 |             | danced      |                 |
| 14 |             |             | told            |

## Exercise 2

### FILL IN THE BLANKS

Choose the correct verb from the list to the right to complete the following sentences. Put the verb in the present perfect tense.

1. I met Barbara when we were in elementary school.  
We \_\_\_\_\_ each other for over 20 years.
2. We \_\_\_\_\_ many new words since we started this course.
3. That's a wonderful movie. I \_\_\_\_\_ it three times.
4. Mr. and Mrs. Tanner \_\_\_\_\_ married for ten years.
5. You are late! The class \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_.
6. Robert is my neighbor. He \_\_\_\_\_ next door to me for five years.
7. Mary \_\_\_\_\_ several emails to her parents since she left home.
8. We \_\_\_\_\_ in that restaurant a few times.
9. Our teacher \_\_\_\_\_ us a lot of help with the homework assignment.
10. She \_\_\_\_\_ to her landlord many times about the broken window.
11. We have a new camera. We \_\_\_\_\_ some beautiful pictures of the grandchildren.
12. They \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_ all their homework.
13. Mrs. Baxter \_\_\_\_\_ all her groceries for the week.
14. Tommy \_\_\_\_\_ a bad cold for two weeks.
15. Frank \_\_\_\_\_ for that company for many years.
16. After three months of looking, she \_\_\_\_\_ a beautiful apartment to rent.

**Word List:**

- take
- work
- find
- see
- speak
- know
- begin
- finish
- learn
- eat
- have
- write
- give
- live
- buy
- be

## Exercise 3

### NEGATIVE SENTENCES

#### A. Choose the Correct Word

Choose the correct verb from the list to the right to complete the following sentences. Put the verb in the negative form of the present perfect tense.

1. Matthew is waiting on the corner for his girlfriend, but she \_\_\_\_\_ yet.
2. My brother lives in a different country. I \_\_\_\_\_ him for two years.
3. Ellie and Bill got a divorce five years ago.  
They \_\_\_\_\_ to each other since then.
4. It is only 8:45. The class \_\_\_\_\_ yet.
5. It started to snow last night, and it still \_\_\_\_\_.
6. She has finally decided which car she wants, but she \_\_\_\_\_ it yet.
7. I heard that the movie at the Roxy Theater is great, but I \_\_\_\_\_ it yet.
8. I bought a newspaper today, but I still \_\_\_\_\_ it.
9. He took his car to the service station yesterday, but they \_\_\_\_\_ it yet.
10. The Andersons moved out of New York ten years ago,  
and they \_\_\_\_\_ back to the city since then.

**Word List:**

- fix
- begin
- arrive
- be
- see
- stop
- speak
- buy
- read
- visit

#### B. Matching

Match each question on the left with the correct answer on the right.

- |                                                   |                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| _____ 1. Has he finished university yet?          | a) No, he hasn't. He's still talking.           |
| _____ 2. Have you eaten breakfast yet?            | b) No, I haven't. My wife's still reading it.   |
| _____ 3. Have they gotten married yet?            | c) No, he hasn't graduated yet.                 |
| _____ 4. Has the president finished speaking yet? | d) No, it hasn't. The teacher isn't here yet.   |
| _____ 5. Has Mary watered the plants yet?         | e) No, they haven't finished yet.               |
| _____ 6. Has the doctor seen you yet?             | f) No, they haven't. They're still engaged.     |
| _____ 7. Has the sun come out yet?                | g) No, she hasn't. They are still dry.          |
| _____ 8. Have they finished their homework yet?   | h) No, I haven't. I'll eat in a few minutes.    |
| _____ 9. Has the class begun yet?                 | i) No, she hasn't. She is with another patient. |
| _____ 10. Have you read the paper yet?            | j) No, it hasn't. It's still raining.           |

## Exercise 4

### ALREADY, STILL & YET

#### A. Mrs. Tanner's School Day Schedule

Read the schedule below and make ten positive and negative sentences using *already*, *yet*, or *still* and the present perfect tense. Assume it is now 12:00 pm.

| Time  | Activity                            |
|-------|-------------------------------------|
| 8:30  | arrive at school                    |
| 9:00  | take attendance, teach French class |
| 10:00 | meet with the principal             |
| 11:00 | teach Spanish class                 |
| 11:30 | write report cards                  |

| Time  | Activity                     |
|-------|------------------------------|
| 12:15 | eat lunch, go for a walk     |
| 1:00  | meet with Joe's parents      |
| 2:00  | take students to the library |
| 3:00  | read students' essays        |
| 4:00  | go home                      |

Ex. *Mrs. Tanner has already taken attendance.*

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_
4. \_\_\_\_\_
5. \_\_\_\_\_
6. \_\_\_\_\_
7. \_\_\_\_\_
8. \_\_\_\_\_
9. \_\_\_\_\_
10. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 4 cont.

### B. Your Daily Schedule

Follow the example on the previous page. Fill in the schedule with your own activities, and then write full sentences below. Assume it is now 12:00 pm.

| Time  | Activity |
|-------|----------|
| 7:00  |          |
| 8:00  |          |
| 9:00  |          |
| 10:00 |          |
| 12:00 |          |

| Time  | Activity |
|-------|----------|
| 2:00  |          |
| 4:00  |          |
| 6:00  |          |
| 9:00  |          |
| 10:00 |          |

Ex. *I have already had breakfast, but I haven't had lunch yet.*

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_
4. \_\_\_\_\_
5. \_\_\_\_\_
6. \_\_\_\_\_
7. \_\_\_\_\_
8. \_\_\_\_\_
9. \_\_\_\_\_
10. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 5

### EVER & NEVER

Practice using the present perfect tense by asking questions beginning with "Have you ever...?" Use the words provided to make your questions. Then answer each question using either a positive or negative reply.

1. you / ever / be / to France

*Have you ever been to France? Yes, I have. I was there last year. / No, I haven't. I've never been there.*

---

2. the teacher / ever / be / late for class

---

3. the pilot / ever / fly / in a helicopter

---

4. your father / ever / make / dinner for your mother

---

5. you / ever / find / a lot of money on the street

---

6. the children / ever / go camping / in the forest

---

7. the baseball team / ever / win a championship game

---

8. the actress / ever / forget her lines

---

9. the police officer / ever / shoot anyone

---

10. the politicians / ever / break their promises

---

## Exercise 6

### PRESENT PERFECT VS. SIMPLE PAST

Complete the following sentences with the correct form of the verb provided (simple past or present perfect).

1. We \_\_\_\_\_ to Vancouver last year. We \_\_\_\_\_ there since April.  
(move) (live)
2. I \_\_\_\_\_ to every hockey game this season. I \_\_\_\_\_ to the game last night with my brother.  
(be) (go)
3. I \_\_\_\_\_ my house key last week and I still \_\_\_\_\_ it.  
(lose) (not/find)
4. "When \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ smoking?" "I \_\_\_\_\_ for over five years now."  
(quit) (not/smoke)
5. Nora \_\_\_\_\_ a lot of souvenirs yesterday.  
(buy)  
She \_\_\_\_\_ never \_\_\_\_\_ this many souvenirs on a vacation before.  
(buy)
6. "Would you like another cup of coffee?" "No thanks. I \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_ three cups."  
(have)
7. Frank \_\_\_\_\_ for ABC Electric from 1990 to 2002.  
(work)  
Now he owns his own business. He \_\_\_\_\_ it for six years.  
(have)
8. Grandma \_\_\_\_\_ and \_\_\_\_\_ her hip last week.  
(fall) (break)  
She \_\_\_\_\_ in the hospital since then.  
(be)
9. My previous teacher \_\_\_\_\_ Mr. Blair.  
(be)  
Now my teacher is Mrs. Carter. I \_\_\_\_\_ in her class for three months now.  
(be)
10. In my whole life, I \_\_\_\_\_ never \_\_\_\_\_ a famous person, but my  
(meet)  
brother \_\_\_\_\_ to three famous actors when he was in Hollywood last year.  
(speak)
11. Last year, we \_\_\_\_\_ through three Canadian provinces. Now we are traveling  
(drive)  
in Europe. We \_\_\_\_\_ already \_\_\_\_\_ through eight countries.  
(drive)
12. This French course \_\_\_\_\_ three months ago. We \_\_\_\_\_  
(start)  
already \_\_\_\_\_ several verb tenses and hundreds of new words.  
(learn)

## Exercise 7

### PAST PARTICIPLE BINGO

#### A. Write the Past Participle

Choose 24 words from the list below and write the past participle of each one in any space on your bingo card on the next page. Mix the verbs up. Do not write them in the same order as the list. Everyone should have a different card.

- |          |          |        |         |         |              |
|----------|----------|--------|---------|---------|--------------|
| • become | • dig    | • get  | • leave | • sell  | • swing      |
| • begin  | • do     | • give | • let   | • send  | • swim       |
| • bet    | • draw   | • go   | • lose  | • shake | • take       |
| • bite   | • drink  | • grow | • make  | • shoot | • teach      |
| • blow   | • drive  | • hang | • mean  | • shut  | • tell       |
| • break  | • eat    | • have | • meet  | • sink  | • think      |
| • bring  | • fall   | • hear | • pay   | • sit   | • throw      |
| • build  | • feel   | • hide | • quit  | • sleep | • wake       |
| • catch  | • fight  | • hit  | • ring  | • speak | • wear       |
| • choose | • find   | • hold | • read  | • spend | • win        |
| • come   | • fly    | • hurt | • ride  | • stand | • write      |
| • cost   | • forget | • keep | • run   | • stick | • understand |
| • cut    | • freeze | • know | • see   | • sweep |              |

#### B. Play Bingo!

Your teacher will call out certain past participles one by one. If you have that past participle on your board, cover it with a marker or draw an X on it. When you have one line in any direction covered, shout "Bingo!" (You must have the correct past participle form under each marker or X in order to win.)

## Exercise 7 cont.

### C. Bingo Card

|  |  |                       |  |  |
|--|--|-----------------------|--|--|
|  |  |                       |  |  |
|  |  |                       |  |  |
|  |  | <b>Free<br/>Space</b> |  |  |
|  |  |                       |  |  |
|  |  |                       |  |  |

## Exercise 8

### SINCE & FOR

Rewrite the following sentences using *since* or *for* and the verb provided.  
You may have to change some of the words, but keep the same meaning.

1. Bill and Rita got married 20 years ago. **(be)**

Bill and Rita have been married for 20 years.

2. Jordan moved into his apartment in 2005. **(live)**

\_\_\_\_\_

3. Ellen and Rose met each other 40 years ago. **(know)**

\_\_\_\_\_

4. The teacher came to school at 8:00 this morning. **(be)**

\_\_\_\_\_

5. Robbie grew a beard six months ago. **(have)**

\_\_\_\_\_

6. Dennis bought his car four years ago. **(own)**

\_\_\_\_\_

7. Maria started to wear glasses when she was five years old. **(wear)**

\_\_\_\_\_

8. David fell in love with Patricia when they were teenagers. **(be)**

\_\_\_\_\_

9. Mark started to work at the bank three years ago. **(work)**

\_\_\_\_\_

10. Sam learned how to swim three years ago. **(know)**

\_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 9

### HOW LONG?

Read the following sentences and write a *how long* question for each one. Then answer each question using *since*, *for*, or *all*.

1. I live in Toronto.

How long have you lived in Toronto?

I have lived in Toronto for 20 years.

2. Jane works at a travel agency.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

3. Bill wears glasses.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

4. Mark and Sharon are married.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

5. I know Ben very well.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

6. Margaret has a bad cold.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

7. John owns a Toyota.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

8. The teacher is in the classroom now.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

9. Daniel and Sara are on vacation now.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

10. Andrea speaks English very well.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

11. Kerry believes in ghosts.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

12. The boss is angry at his secretary.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

13. The fridge is empty.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

14. I feel sick.

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 10

### SCRAMBLED SENTENCES

Put the words below in the correct order to make grammatically correct sentences. Each sentence is in the present perfect tense.

1. finished they yet homework their haven't

*They haven't finished their homework yet.*

2. week I flu had the since have last

\_\_\_\_\_

3. time divorced she for been long a has

\_\_\_\_\_

4. been week absent all school from has he

\_\_\_\_\_

5. this city apartment lived since I in this have I moved to

\_\_\_\_\_

6. lesson already that has teacher taught the

\_\_\_\_\_

7. Edith child since glasses was a worn has she

\_\_\_\_\_

8. since she at broke work hasn't her been leg she

\_\_\_\_\_

9. new very happy the a children puppy they have since got been

\_\_\_\_\_

10. anxious we morning have all been

\_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 11

## WRITING

Write five to ten sentences about your childhood. Use the present perfect, the simple past, and some of the following time markers: *for, since, all, already, still, yet, ever, never*.

### Example

I traveled a lot when I was a child. I've been to Europe many times, but I haven't been to Africa yet. I have wanted to go to Africa since I was a child...

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, typical of notebook paper. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

## Exercise 12

### CLASS ACTIVITY

Interview your classmates. Use the words provided to ask questions with the present perfect tense. Write the name of the classmate who gives you a "yes" answer. Then follow up with another question using the simple past tense.

#### Example

**You:** Have you ever seen the Eiffel Tower?

**Mary:** Yes, I have.

**You:** When did you see it?

**Mary:** I saw it two years ago.

| #  | Words                                                     | Classmate |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 1  | ever / see / the Eiffel Tower                             | Mary      |
| 2  | move / to a new house or apartment / recently             |           |
| 3  | ever / have / a pet bird                                  |           |
| 4  | receive / a gift / in the past week                       |           |
| 5  | read / any good books / lately                            |           |
| 6  | ever / go to a hospital / in an ambulance                 |           |
| 7  | own / a car / for more than two years                     |           |
| 8  | ever / win / money / in a lottery                         |           |
| 9  | ever / sleep / in a tent                                  |           |
| 10 | have / more than one job / since you finished high school |           |
| 11 | ever / see / a ghost                                      |           |
| 12 | ever / lose / your wallet                                 |           |
| 13 | have / a cold / this month                                |           |
| 14 | ever / swim / in the ocean                                |           |
| 15 | wear / glasses / for more than ten years                  |           |
| 16 | ever / go fishing                                         |           |
| 17 | live / in this city / for more than five years            |           |

## Exercise 13

### QUIZ

Choose the correct answer.

1. The students \_\_\_\_\_ their assignments.
  - a) have not completed
  - b) hasn't completed
  - c) not have completed
2. \_\_\_\_\_ to the party last night?
  - a) Have you gone
  - b) Has you gone
  - c) Did you go
3. My neighbor \_\_\_\_\_ English for 15 years.
  - a) have taught
  - b) has taught
  - c) didn't taught
4. Our dogs \_\_\_\_\_ their food yet.
  - a) have finished
  - b) haven't finished
  - c) not finished
5. My coworker \_\_\_\_\_ about the out-of-date software all month.
  - a) have already complained
  - b) has complained
  - c) has already complained
6. The children \_\_\_\_\_ their dinner.
  - a) still haven't eaten
  - b) haven't still eaten
  - c) haven't eaten still
7. My brother \_\_\_\_\_ hockey since he was a child.
  - a) have loved
  - b) has loved
  - c) loved
8. He \_\_\_\_\_ for work.
  - a) already has left
  - b) already hasn't left
  - c) has already left
9. I \_\_\_\_\_ to that restaurant.
  - a) never has been
  - b) have never been
  - c) have been never
10. They \_\_\_\_\_ in the park yesterday.
  - a) have jogged
  - b) has jogged
  - c) jogged
11. The employees \_\_\_\_\_ on that report for three weeks.
  - a) have worked
  - b) have already worked
  - c) haven't worked yet
12. She \_\_\_\_\_ to many exotic places.
  - a) have already traveled
  - b) has traveled
  - c) hasn't traveled yet

# Answer Key

## Exercise 1

### A. SIMPLE PAST AND PAST PARTICIPLE

- |                       |                      |
|-----------------------|----------------------|
| 1. worked, worked     | 8. saw, seen         |
| 2. did, done          | 9. had, had          |
| 3. ate, eaten         | 10. went, gone       |
| 4. called, called     | 11. studied, studied |
| 5. began, begun       | 12. taught, taught   |
| 6. gave, given        | 13. made, made       |
| 7. answered, answered | 14. talked, talked   |

### B. COMPLETE THE CHART

| #  | Simple Form | Simple Past | Past Participle |
|----|-------------|-------------|-----------------|
| 1  | know        | knew        | known           |
| 2  | meet        | met         | met             |
| 3  | is          | was/were    | been            |
| 4  | fly         | flew        | flown           |
| 5  | write       | wrote       | written         |
| 6  | read        | read        | read            |
| 7  | live        | lived       | lived           |
| 8  | fall        | fell        | fallen          |
| 9  | feel        | felt        | felt            |
| 10 | take        | took        | taken           |
| 11 | drive       | drove       | driven          |
| 12 | buy         | bought      | bought          |
| 13 | dance       | danced      | danced          |
| 14 | tell        | told        | told            |

## Exercise 2

- |                 |                   |                |
|-----------------|-------------------|----------------|
| 1. have known   | 7. has written    | 13. has bought |
| 2. have learned | 8. have eaten     | 14. has had    |
| 3. have seen    | 9. has given      | 15. has worked |
| 4. have been    | 10. has spoken    | 16. has found  |
| 5. has/begun    | 11. have taken    |                |
| 6. has lived    | 12. have/finished |                |

## Exercise 3

### A. CHOOSE THE CORRECT WORD

- |                    |                  |
|--------------------|------------------|
| 1. hasn't arrived  | 6. hasn't bought |
| 2. haven't visited | 7. haven't seen  |
| 3. haven't spoken  | 8. haven't read  |
| 4. hasn't begun    | 9. haven't fixed |
| 5. hasn't stopped  | 10. haven't been |

### B. MATCHING

- |      |      |      |      |       |
|------|------|------|------|-------|
| 1. c | 3. f | 5. g | 7. j | 9. d  |
| 2. h | 4. a | 6. i | 8. e | 10. b |

## Exercise 4

Answers will vary.

## Exercise 5

Responses to questions will vary. You could also put students into pairs and have them write their partner's answers.

- Have you ever been to France?  
Yes, I have. I was there last year. /  
No, I haven't. I've never been there.
- Has the teacher ever been late for class?
- Has the pilot ever flown in a helicopter?
- Has your father ever made dinner for your mother?
- Have you ever found a lot of money on the street?
- Have the children ever gone camping in the forest?
- Has the baseball team ever won a championship game?
- Has the actress ever forgotten her lines?
- Has the police officer ever shot anyone?
- Have the politicians ever broken their promises?

(continued on the next page...)

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 6

- |                              |                            |
|------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1. moved, have lived         | 7. worked, has had         |
| 2. have been, went           | 8. fell, broke, has been   |
| 3. lost, haven't found       | 9. was, have been          |
| 4. did, quit, haven't smoked | 10. have, met, spoke       |
| 5. bought, has, bought       | 11. drove, have, driven    |
| 6. have, had                 | 12. started, have, learned |

### Exercise 7

#### A. WRITE THE PAST PARTICIPLE

|         |             |        |             |
|---------|-------------|--------|-------------|
| become  | felt        | let    | spoken      |
| begun   | fought      | lost   | spent       |
| bet     | found       | made   | stood       |
| bitten  | flown       | meant  | stuck       |
| blown   | forgotten   | met    | swept       |
| broken  | frozen      | paid   | swung       |
| brought | got/gotten  | quit   | swum        |
| built   | given       | rung   | taken       |
| caught  | gone        | read   | taught      |
| chosen  | grown       | ridden | told        |
| come    | hung/hanged | run    | thought     |
| cost    | had         | seen   | thrown      |
| cut     | heard       | sold   | woken/waked |
| dug     | hidden      | sent   | worn        |
| done    | hit         | shaken | won         |
| drawn   | held        | shot   | written     |
| drunk   | hurt        | shut   | understood  |
| driven  | kept        | sunk   |             |
| eaten   | known       | sat    |             |
| fallen  | left        | slept  |             |

### Exercise 8

- Bill and Rita have been married for 20 years.
- Jordan has lived in his apartment since 2005.
- Ellen and Rose have known each other for 40 years.
- The teacher has been at school since 8:00 this morning.
- Robbie has had a beard for six months.
- Dennis has owned his car for four years.
- Maria has worn glasses since she was five years old.
- David has been in love with Patricia since they were teenagers.
- Mark has worked at the bank for three years.
- Sam has known how to swim for three years.

### Exercise 9

Responses to questions will vary.

- How long have you lived in Toronto?  
I have lived in Toronto for 20 years.
- How long has Jane worked at a travel agency?
- How long has Bill worn glasses?
- How long have Mark and Sharon been married?
- How long have you known Ben?
- How long has Margaret had a bad cold?
- How long has John owned a Toyota?
- How long has the teacher been in the classroom?
- How long have Daniel and Sara been on vacation?
- How long has Andrea spoken English?
- How long has Kerry believed in ghosts?
- How long has the boss been angry at his secretary?
- How long has the fridge been empty?
- How long have you felt sick?

*(continued on the next page...)*

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 10

1. They haven't finished their homework yet.
2. I have had the flu since last week.
3. She has been divorced for a long time.
4. He has been absent from school all week.
5. I have lived in this apartment since I moved to this city.
6. The teacher has already taught that lesson.
7. Edith has worn glasses since she was a child.
8. She hasn't been at work since she broke her leg.
9. The children have been very happy since they got a new puppy.
10. We have been anxious all morning.

### Exercise 11

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 12

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 13

- |      |      |      |      |       |       |
|------|------|------|------|-------|-------|
| 1. a | 3. b | 5. b | 7. b | 9. b  | 11. a |
| 2. c | 4. b | 6. a | 8. c | 10. c | 12. b |

### Verb Cards

Cut up the cards on pages 23–27 for review and practice with past participle forms of irregular verbs. You can adapt the activities from the following blog post to the past participle form instead of the simple past form: <http://blog.esllibrary.com/2015/02/26/5-fun-activities-for-irregular-verbs/>

For a printable list of common irregular verbs, see our Grammar & Usage Resource: <https://esllibrary.com/resources/2275>

#### SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Neighbor*, *Theater*, *Traveling*, *Traveled*, and *Practice*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Neighbour*, *Theatre*, *Travelling*, *Travelled*, and *Practise* (when used as a verb; *Practice* when used as a noun). Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

#### EDITOR'S NOTE:

Find grammar charts and teaching tips for the Present Perfect on our blog: <http://blog.esllibrary.com/2016/11/03/present-perfect-two-uses/> and in our Resource section: <https://esllibrary.com/resources/2331>

## Verb Cards

### A. Base Verbs

|              |               |               |               |
|--------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
| <b>be</b>    | <b>become</b> | <b>begin</b>  | <b>break</b>  |
| <b>bring</b> | <b>buy</b>    | <b>catch</b>  | <b>choose</b> |
| <b>come</b>  | <b>cut</b>    | <b>do</b>     | <b>draw</b>   |
| <b>drive</b> | <b>drink</b>  | <b>eat</b>    | <b>fall</b>   |
| <b>feel</b>  | <b>find</b>   | <b>forget</b> | <b>get</b>    |
| <b>give</b>  | <b>go</b>     | <b>grow</b>   | <b>have</b>   |
| <b>hear</b>  | <b>hide</b>   | <b>hit</b>    | <b>hold</b>   |

## Verb Cards cont.

### A. Base Verbs cont.

|              |              |              |                   |
|--------------|--------------|--------------|-------------------|
| <b>keep</b>  | <b>lay</b>   | <b>lead</b>  | <b>leave</b>      |
| <b>let</b>   | <b>lie</b>   | <b>lose</b>  | <b>make</b>       |
| <b>meet</b>  | <b>pay</b>   | <b>put</b>   | <b>read</b>       |
| <b>ring</b>  | <b>run</b>   | <b>say</b>   | <b>see</b>        |
| <b>sell</b>  | <b>send</b>  | <b>shut</b>  | <b>sleep</b>      |
| <b>speak</b> | <b>spend</b> | <b>stand</b> | <b>take</b>       |
| <b>teach</b> | <b>tell</b>  | <b>throw</b> | <b>understand</b> |
| <b>wake</b>  | <b>wear</b>  | <b>win</b>   | <b>write</b>      |

## Verb Cards cont.

### B. Past Participle Irregular Verbs

|                |               |                  |                    |
|----------------|---------------|------------------|--------------------|
| <b>been</b>    | <b>become</b> | <b>begun</b>     | <b>broken</b>      |
| <b>brought</b> | <b>bought</b> | <b>caught</b>    | <b>chosen</b>      |
| <b>come</b>    | <b>cut</b>    | <b>done</b>      | <b>drawn</b>       |
| <b>driven</b>  | <b>drunk</b>  | <b>eaten</b>     | <b>fallen</b>      |
| <b>felt</b>    | <b>found</b>  | <b>forgotten</b> | <b>gotten, got</b> |
| <b>given</b>   | <b>gone</b>   | <b>grown</b>     | <b>had</b>         |
| <b>heard</b>   | <b>hidden</b> | <b>hit</b>       | <b>held</b>        |

## Verb Cards cont.

### B. Past Participle Irregular Verbs cont.

|               |              |               |                   |
|---------------|--------------|---------------|-------------------|
| <b>kept</b>   | <b>laid</b>  | <b>led</b>    | <b>left</b>       |
| <b>let</b>    | <b>lain</b>  | <b>lost</b>   | <b>made</b>       |
| <b>met</b>    | <b>paid</b>  | <b>put</b>    | <b>read</b>       |
| <b>rung</b>   | <b>run</b>   | <b>said</b>   | <b>seen</b>       |
| <b>sold</b>   | <b>sent</b>  | <b>shut</b>   | <b>slept</b>      |
| <b>spoken</b> | <b>spent</b> | <b>stood</b>  | <b>taken</b>      |
| <b>taught</b> | <b>told</b>  | <b>thrown</b> | <b>understood</b> |
| <b>woken</b>  | <b>worn</b>  | <b>won</b>    | <b>written</b>    |

## Verb Cards cont.

### C. Blank Cards

|  |  |  |  |
|--|--|--|--|
|  |  |  |  |
|  |  |  |  |
|  |  |  |  |
|  |  |  |  |
|  |  |  |  |
|  |  |  |  |
|  |  |  |  |
|  |  |  |  |

# Present Perfect Progressive

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| <b>8</b>  | <b>EXERCISE 4: Tell Me Why</b><br>Match the situations and write responses.                                   | <b>16</b> | <b>ANSWER KEY</b>                                                                                                                                      |
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## Grammar Notes

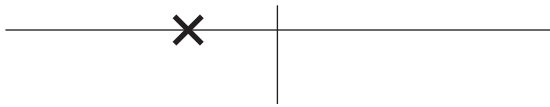
### A. Introduction

In English, we use the present perfect progressive (also known as the present perfect continuous) for continuing actions. These actions started in the past and will continue into the future.

To understand when to use this tense compared to the present perfect, let's look at two different time frames: shorter (within one day) and longer (days, weeks, months, or years).

### B. Finished Vs. Continuing Actions

#### SHORTER TIME FRAMES

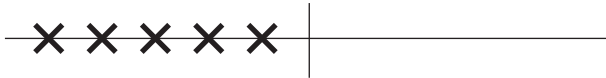
|                     | Present Perfect                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Present Perfect Progressive                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pattern</b>      | have / has + p.p. (past participle)                                                                                                                                                                             | have / has + been + -ing verb                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Use</b>          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>shows a finished past action</li> <li>does not show when it occurred</li> </ul>                                                                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>show a continuing action that started in the past, continues to the present, and will continue into the future</li> </ul>                                                                        |
| <b>Diagram</b>      |                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Time Markers</b> | No time marker is needed, but for emphasis it is possible to use: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>already</li> <li>yet</li> <li>still</li> <li>ever</li> <li>never</li> </ul>                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>for</li> <li>since</li> <li>ever since</li> <li>all</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Examples</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>have read</b> <i>The Hobbit</i>. (I have finished reading it.)</li> <li>She <b>has</b> already <b>written</b> her report. (She has finished writing it.)</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>have been reading</b> <i>The Hobbit</i> all night. (I will continue to read it.)</li> <li>She <b>has been writing</b> her report for two hours. (She will continue to write it.)</li> </ul> |



## Grammar Notes cont.

### B. Finished Vs. Continuing Actions cont.

#### Repeated Past Action



Use the present perfect even if a finished past action happened more than once.  
Do not mention **when** it occurred.

- I **have performed** onstage many times.
- We **have been** to Mexico twice.
- She **has given** a presentation five times in her life.

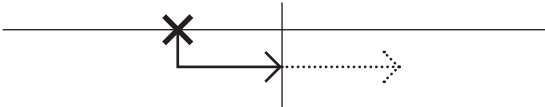
#### Shorter Time Frames

For shorter time frames (usually within one day), the present perfect progressive is the natural-sounding choice for a continuing action.

- My son **has been eating** for half an hour.
- They **have been writing** emails since 7:00 am.

### C. Continuing Actions

#### LONGER TIME FRAMES

|                     | Present Perfect                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Present Perfect Progressive                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pattern</b>      | have / has + p.p.                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | have / has + been + <i>-ing</i> verb                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Use</b>          | shows an action that started in the past, continues to the present, and <b>may</b> continue into the future                                                                                                                            | shows an action that started in the past, continues to the present, and <b>will</b> continue into the future                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Diagram</b>      |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Time Markers</b> | for, since, ever since, all                                                                                                                                                                                                            | for, since, ever since, all                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Examples</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• I <b>have studied</b> English for eight years.</li> <li>• He <b>has lived</b> in the same house since he was a child.</li> <li>• She <b>has talked</b> about her new job for days.</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• I <b>have been studying</b> English for eight years.</li> <li>• He <b>has been living</b> in the same house since he was a child.</li> <li>• She <b>has been talking</b> about her new job for days.</li> </ul> |



## Grammar Notes cont.

### C. Continuing Actions cont.

#### Longer Time Frames

For longer time frames, the present perfect and the present perfect progressive have the same meaning. To emphasize that the action will continue into the future, use the present perfect progressive.

- I **have studied** English for two years. (*emphasis on the past to the present*)
- I **have been studying** English for two years. (*emphasis also on the future*)
- I **have lived** in Tokyo for 12 years. (*emphasis on the past to the present*)
- I **have been living** in Tokyo for 12 years. (*emphasis also on the future*)

#### Non-Action Verbs

Remember that non-action verbs (states of being, possession, feelings, thought, and the five senses) can never take a progressive (-ing) form in English.

- ✓ She **has been here** for an hour.
- ✗ She **has been being** here for an hour.
- ✓ They **have loved** each other since they met.
- ✗ They **have been loving** each other since they met.

#### For, All, Since & Ever Since

These time markers are used to show *how long* an action has been continuing for. They are commonly used with the present perfect and present perfect progressive tenses.

*For* and *all* show the **duration** of an action. *For* is more common than *all*.

- We have lived on Main Street **for 30 years**.
- She has been studying other languages **all her life**.

*Since* and *ever since* show the **starting point** of an action. *Since* is more common, but *ever since* emphasizes the duration more than *since*.

- They have been waiting for the package **since Tuesday**.
- He has been singing in a choir **ever since he was a toddler**.

## Exercise 1

### FOR & SINCE

Read about each situation below, and write a sentence using the present perfect progressive tense and *for* or *since*.

1. The baby is crying. She started to cry 20 minutes ago.

The baby has been crying for 20 minutes.

2. It is snowing. It began to snow last night.

\_\_\_\_\_

3. The children are studying now. They started to study an hour ago.

\_\_\_\_\_

4. Willie smokes. He started to smoke when he was a teenager.

\_\_\_\_\_

5. Andrea works in a bank. She got her bank job last April.

\_\_\_\_\_

6. Mrs. Neville teaches French. She started to teach French 15 years ago.

\_\_\_\_\_

7. Sue and Joe are planning their vacation. They started planning last winter.

\_\_\_\_\_

8. The mechanic is fixing my car. He started working on it this morning.

\_\_\_\_\_

9. My classmates are taking a test. The test started two hours ago.

\_\_\_\_\_

10. The employees are writing their reports. They started writing at 9:00 am.

\_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 2

### FILL IN THE BLANKS

Choose the correct verb from the word list to complete the following sentences. Use the present perfect progressive tense.

1. Maria has been waiting at the coffee shop for her boyfriend for the past half hour, but he still hasn't arrived.
2. The students \_\_\_\_\_ Spanish since the semester began.
3. I \_\_\_\_\_ on this report for the past two days.
4. You should take your umbrella when you go out. It \_\_\_\_\_ all day.
5. Your children \_\_\_\_\_ television all evening.
6. John's back hurts. He \_\_\_\_\_ heavy boxes all morning.
7. The students \_\_\_\_\_ in the classroom for 20 minutes, but the teacher hasn't come yet.
8. The girls \_\_\_\_\_ on the telephone for over an hour.
9. Frank \_\_\_\_\_ the same car for almost 20 years.
10. Mr. and Mrs. Barnes are very excited about going to China next summer. They \_\_\_\_\_ this trip for over a year.
11. That mailman \_\_\_\_\_ the mail in our neighborhood for nearly 25 years. He is going to retire soon.
12. Rita and Carly are at the mall. They \_\_\_\_\_ since the stores opened this morning.
13. My eyes are getting tired. I \_\_\_\_\_ all day.
14. Bill hopes to find a new job soon. He \_\_\_\_\_ in the paper and on the Internet every day for the past month.
15. Andrea is planning to call the doctor this afternoon. She \_\_\_\_\_ sick for several days.
16. Claire's eyes are red. She \_\_\_\_\_ all morning.

**Word List:**

- talk
- look
- lift
- work
- ~~wait~~
- feel
- rain
- deliver
- shop
- cry
- plan
- read
- drive
- study
- sit
- watch

## Exercise 3

### NEGATIVE & AFFIRMATIVE

Write sentences (first in the negative and then in the affirmative)  
using the words provided and the present perfect progressive tense.  
Follow the example given below.

1. Terry / study French / study German

*Terry hasn't been studying French. He's been studying German.*

---

2. Barbara / knit a sweater / knit a scarf
- 

3. Ann / work overtime this week / go home early
- 

4. Kevin / study for his exam / watch TV all evening
- 

5. Jenny / send postcards to her friends / write emails
- 

6. Robert / drive to work this week / take the bus
- 

7. Lisa / feel well this week / cough a lot
- 

8. Mrs. Anderson / clean the house / talk on the phone all morning
- 

9. the children / do their homework / play cards
- 

10. the Smiths / save for a house / shop for new furniture instead
-

## Exercise 4

### TELL ME WHY

#### A. Matching

Match the situations on the left with the causes on the right.

- |               |                                               |                                               |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| <u>  e  </u>  | 1. Mary's eyes are very red.                  | a) She's been leaning against the blackboard. |
| <u>      </u> | 2. The streets are wet.                       | b) She's been exercising all month.           |
| <u>      </u> | 3. The children aren't hungry now.            | c) She's been dancing for hours.              |
| <u>      </u> | 4. He's out of breath.                        | d) It's been raining for hours.               |
| <u>      </u> | 5. Carol's pants are dirty.                   | e) She's been crying all night.               |
| <u>      </u> | 6. Both boys have black eyes.                 | f) He's been running for an hour.             |
| <u>      </u> | 7. The teacher's sweater is covered in chalk. | g) She's been working in the garden.          |
| <u>      </u> | 8. Andrew coughs all the time.                | h) They've been eating cookies all day.       |
| <u>      </u> | 9. Lily's feet are sore.                      | i) He's been smoking for years.               |
| <u>      </u> | 10. Donna feels great.                        | j) They've been fighting.                     |

#### B. Writing

Use the present perfect progressive tense and your own ideas to answer the following questions.

1. Why are you so tired?

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_ *all morning.*

2. Why did Daniel's teacher phone Daniel's parents?

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_ *for the past month.*

3. Why does it smell so good in the kitchen?

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_ *all afternoon.*

4. Why haven't you finished your homework yet?

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_ *since I got home.*

## Exercise 5

### QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Use the correct question word (who, what, where, why, how long) and the present perfect progressive tense to make information questions. The **bold** words are the answers to the questions.

1. *How long has Ben been working for that company?*

Ben has been working for that company **for 20 years**.

2. \_\_\_\_\_

She has been talking to **her mother** for the past hour.

3. \_\_\_\_\_

Ruth has been waiting for Sara **for over an hour**.

4. \_\_\_\_\_

The boys have been **playing tennis** all afternoon.

5. \_\_\_\_\_

Annie has been waiting **in the coffee shop** for Robbie.

6. \_\_\_\_\_

She's been cooking all day **because she's having a big party tonight**.

7. \_\_\_\_\_

He's been walking to work all week **because he wants to get some exercise**.

8. \_\_\_\_\_

It's been snowing **since last night**.

9. \_\_\_\_\_

**Mrs. Jones** has been living in our old apartment since we moved out.

10. \_\_\_\_\_

Maria and John have been practicing **in the studio** all month.

## Exercise 6

### SCRAMBLED SENTENCES

Put the words below in the correct order to make grammatically correct sentences. Use the present perfect progressive tense.

1. has that he been for company working years for ten

*He has been working for that company for ten years.*

---

2. piano lessons has she since taking a been was child she
- 

3. fishing since they the came have sun been up
- 

4. has an father he his been for arguing hour with
- 

5. have neighborhood we same in been since the living we were children
- 

6. Alex since he been came from business sleeping his has home trip
- 

7. been the since students doing they to came class have exercise this
- 

8. Peter hockey has the since it been game watching began
- 

9. Dan been Luke two playing have and for tennis hours
- 

10. morning been to we presentations all listening have
-

## Exercise 7

### EVER SINCE

Use the information provided below to make sentences with the present perfect progressive tense and *ever since*.

1. John finished his business degree. Then he started to work for a large international company.

*John has been working for a large international company ever since he finished his business degree.*

2. Bonnie got a very bad flu. After that, she began to take vitamins.

\_\_\_\_\_

3. Dave's car broke down. Then he began to walk to work.

\_\_\_\_\_

4. Ellen's doctor told her to lose weight. Then she began to diet.

\_\_\_\_\_

5. Mary's parents heard some bad news. Then they started to cry.

\_\_\_\_\_

6. Diane's husband died of cancer. Then Diane started to volunteer at the hospital.

\_\_\_\_\_

7. Ross got a new dog. Then he started to take long walks every day.

\_\_\_\_\_

8. Wayne got skates for his tenth birthday. Then he started to play hockey.

\_\_\_\_\_

9. Clara joined an exercise class. Then she started to lose weight.

\_\_\_\_\_

10. Bob and Lisa retired. Then they started traveling.

\_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 8

### CLASS ACTIVITY

Walk around the room and interview your classmates. Complete the chart.

| #  | Find someone who...                                                             | Name |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| 1  | ...has been living in this city for less than two years.                        |      |
| 2  | ...has been having trouble sleeping lately.                                     |      |
| 3  | ...hasn't been feeling well this week.                                          |      |
| 4  | ...has been taking music lessons for several years.                             |      |
| 5  | ...has been playing soccer since he/she was a young child.                      |      |
| 6  | ...has been studying English for a very short time.                             |      |
| 7  | ...has been planning a special trip for a long time.                            |      |
| 8  | ...has been dating the same person for more than six months.                    |      |
| 9  | ...has been waiting for an important phone call, letter, or email all week.     |      |
| 10 | ...has been watching the same TV series every week for the past several months. |      |
| 11 | ...has been sitting in the same seat every day since this course began.         |      |
| 12 | ...has been taking vitamins every day for many years.                           |      |
| 13 | ...has been exercising regularly for the past month.                            |      |
| 14 | ...hasn't been taking the bus to school this week.                              |      |
| 15 | ...has been wearing the same brand of lipstick for years.                       |      |
| 16 | ...has been driving the same car for over five years.                           |      |
| 17 | ...has been thinking about moving to a new place.                               |      |
| 18 | ...has been doing a lot of homework lately.                                     |      |
| 19 | ...has been reading a good book this week.                                      |      |
| 20 | ...has been looking forward to seeing friends this weekend.                     |      |

## WRITING

What are some of your future goals? Write three paragraphs about three goals and the steps you are currently taking to reach those goals. Use the present perfect progressive tense as often as possible.

One of my goals is to be a fluent English speaker. I have been studying English for eight years. I have been living in Canada since 2015, and I have been working for a Canadian company for two months. I want to keep working there for at least a year.

Another goal I have is to get in better shape. To reach this goal, I...

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

## Exercise 10

### PRESENT PERFECT & PRESENT PERFECT PROGRESSIVE

Read the information in the chart below, and then write at least two sentences about each person using the present perfect and present perfect progressive tenses.

| Person         | Time Now | Activity in Progress | Began              | Completed So Far                 |
|----------------|----------|----------------------|--------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Doris</b>   | 4:00 pm  | writing emails       | 1:00 pm            | 20 emails                        |
| <b>Judy</b>    | 4:00 pm  | meeting customers    | early this morning | 12 customers                     |
| <b>Wayne</b>   | 4:00 pm  | playing tennis       | 3:00 pm            | three games                      |
| <b>Michael</b> | 4:00 pm  | fixing computers     | 9:00 am            | six computers                    |
| <b>Bonnie</b>  | 4:00 pm  | baking               | 12:30 pm           | two cakes and four dozen cookies |

1. Doris

*Doris has been writing emails for three hours.*

*Doris has been writing emails since 1:00.*

*She has written 20 emails so far.*

2. Judy

---



---



---

3. Wayne

---



---



---

4. Michael

---



---



---

5. Bonnie

---



---



---

## Exercise 11

### PRESENT PERFECT VS. PRESENT PERFECT PROGRESSIVE

Complete the following sentences with the correct form of the verb in brackets (present perfect or present perfect progressive).

1. I have been writing emails since 10:00 this morning. So far, I have finished about 20.  
(write) (finish)
2. I love that restaurant. I \_\_\_\_\_ there many times.  
(eat)
3. Go and wake your father up. He \_\_\_\_\_ all afternoon.  
(sleep)
4. Laura is at the mall. She \_\_\_\_\_ all morning.  
(shop)  
She \_\_\_\_\_ three pairs of shoes, two dresses, and a coat.  
(buy)
5. They \_\_\_\_\_ that office tower for almost two years.  
(build)  
So far, it \_\_\_\_\_ over \$200 million dollars.  
(cost)
6. The boys \_\_\_\_\_ all afternoon. They \_\_\_\_\_ ten fish so far.  
(fish) (catch)
7. Let's sit down. I'm tired. We \_\_\_\_\_ for hours.  
(dance)
8. Kelly is standing on the corner. She \_\_\_\_\_ for her boyfriend for the past 20 minutes.  
(wait)
9. There is a police car parked on the street across from my house.  
I \_\_\_\_\_ it for over an hour, but nothing \_\_\_\_\_ yet.  
(watch) (happen)
10. Please answer the phone. It \_\_\_\_\_ for the past five minutes.  
(ring)
11. Anna \_\_\_\_\_ in the hospital for over a month. She may come home next week.  
(be)
12. A: Sorry I'm late. B: That's okay. I \_\_\_\_\_ very long.  
(not / wait)
13. It \_\_\_\_\_ steadily for the past two days.  
(rain)

## Answer Key

### Exercise 1

1. The baby has been crying for 20 minutes.
2. It has been snowing since last night.
3. The children have been studying for an hour.
4. Willie has been smoking since he was a teenager.
5. Andrea has been working in a bank since last April.
6. Mrs. Neville has been teaching French for 15 years.
7. Sue and Joe have been planning their vacation since last winter.
8. The mechanic has been working on my car since this morning.
9. My classmates have been taking a test for two hours.
10. The employees have been writing their reports since 9:00 am.

### Exercise 2

- |                       |                         |
|-----------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. has been waiting   | 9. has been driving     |
| 2. have been studying | 10. have been planning  |
| 3. have been working  | 11. has been delivering |
| 4. has been raining   | 12. have been shopping  |
| 5. have been watching | 13. have been reading   |
| 6. has been lifting   | 14. has been looking    |
| 7. have been sitting  | 15. has been feeling    |
| 8. have been talking  | 16. has been crying     |

### Exercise 3

Encourage your students to use contractions for all or at least some of their answers.

1. Terry hasn't been studying French.  
He's been studying German.
2. Barbara hasn't been knitting a sweater.  
She's been knitting a scarf.
3. Ann hasn't been working overtime this week.  
She's been going home early.
4. Kevin hasn't been studying for his exam.  
He's been watching TV all evening.
5. Jenny hasn't been sending postcards to her friends.  
She's been writing emails.
6. Robert hasn't been driving to work this week.  
He's been taking the bus.

7. Lisa hasn't been feeling well this week.  
She's been coughing a lot.
8. Mrs. Anderson hasn't been cleaning the house.  
She's been talking on the phone all morning.
9. The children haven't been doing their homework.  
They've been playing cards.
10. The Smiths haven't been saving for a house.  
They've been shopping for new furniture instead.

### Exercise 4

#### A. MATCHING

- |      |      |      |      |       |
|------|------|------|------|-------|
| 1. e | 3. h | 5. g | 7. a | 9. c  |
| 2. d | 4. f | 6. j | 8. i | 10. b |

#### B. WRITING

Individual answers.

### Exercise 5

1. How long has Ben been working for that company?
2. Who has she been talking to for the past hour?
3. How long has Ruth been waiting for Sara?
4. What have the boys been doing/playing all afternoon?
5. Where has Annie been waiting all day?
6. Why has she been cooking all day?
7. Why has he been walking to work all week?
8. How long has it been snowing?
9. Who has been living in our old apartment since we moved out?
10. Where have Maria and John been practicing all month?

*(continued on the next page...)*

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 6

1. He has been working for that company for ten years.
2. She has been taking piano lessons since she was a child.
3. They have been fishing since the sun came up.
4. He has been arguing with his father for an hour.
5. We have been living in the same neighborhood since we were children.
6. Alex has been sleeping since he came home from his business trip.
7. The students have been doing this exercise since they came to class.
8. Peter has been watching the hockey game since it began.
9. Dan and Luke have been playing tennis for two hours.
10. We have been listening to presentations all morning.

### Exercise 7

1. John has been working for a large international company ever since he finished his business degree.
2. Bonnie has been taking vitamins ever since she got a very bad flu.
3. Dave has been walking to work ever since his car broke down.
4. Ellen has been dieting ever since her doctor told her to lose weight.
5. Mary's parents have been crying ever since they heard some bad news.
6. Diane has been volunteering at the hospital ever since her husband died of cancer.
7. Ross has been taking long walks every day ever since he got a new dog.
8. Wayne has been playing hockey ever since he got skates for his tenth birthday.
9. Clara has been losing weight ever since she joined an exercise class.
10. They have been traveling ever since they retired.

### Exercise 8

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 9

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 10

Answers may vary.

1. Doris has been writing emails for three hours. /  
Doris has been writing emails since 1:00. /  
She has written 20 emails so far.
2. Judy has been meeting customers since early this morning. /  
She has met 12 customers so far.
3. Wayne has been playing tennis for an hour. /  
Wayne has been playing tennis since 3:00. /  
Wayne has played three games of tennis so far.
4. Michael has been fixing computers for seven hours. /  
Michael has been fixing computers since 9:00. /  
He has fixed six computers so far.
5. Bonnie has been baking for three and a half hours. /  
Bonnie has been baking since 12:30. /  
She has baked two cakes and four dozen cookies so far.

*(continued on the next page...)*

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 11

1. have been writing, have finished
2. have eaten
3. has been sleeping
4. has been shopping, has (already) bought
5. have been building, has cost
6. have been fishing, have caught
7. have been dancing
8. has been waiting
9. have been watching, has happened
10. has been ringing
11. has been
12. haven't been waiting
13. has been raining

### SPELLING NOTES:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Neighborhood*, *Traveling*, and *Practice*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Neighbourhood*, *Travelling*, and *Practise* (when used as a verb; *Practice* when used as a noun). Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

### EDITOR'S NOTES:

1. Find more practice on the Present Perfect in our Grammar Practice Worksheets lesson: <https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/1597>
2. Find past participle lists and cards in our Grammar & Usage resources: <https://esllibrary.com/resources>
3. For more information on Non-Action Verbs, see our Grammar & Usage resource: <https://esllibrary.com/resources/2329>

# Simple Future

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## Grammar Notes

### THE SIMPLE FUTURE: THREE FORMS

There are three ways to express a future time in English:

**will + base verb**, **be going to + base verb**, or **be + -ing verb**.

How and when do we use these forms?

#### A. Will + Base Verb

This form is used when you are deciding future plans *at the moment*.

For example, if someone invited you to go to a party next Friday, you could answer, "*Sure, I will go with you.*"

*Will + base verb* is the most **formal** way of forming the future tense.

##### Examples:

- A: Do you two want to go to the movies later?  
B: Sure, we **will go**.
- She **will do** whatever her mother tells her to do.
- When you enter the room on Monday, you **will see** a sign-up sheet on the table.

#### B. Be Going To + Base Verb

This form is used when plans *have already been made in advance*.

For example, if you have plans to go camping next weekend and someone asks you what you are going to do, you could answer, "*I'm going to go camping next weekend.*"

*Be going to + base verb* is more **casual** than *will + base verb*. It is also more common than *be + -ing verb*.

##### Examples:

- He **is going to study** all night for his test.
- They **are going to go** to Disneyland next spring.
- I **am** definitely **going to call** you tomorrow.

##### Note:

The *be* verb is conjugated according to the subject (*am, are, is*).

##### Pronunciation Note:

*Going to* sounds like *gonna*. Use *gonna* when speaking, but never write *gonna*!

## Grammar Notes cont.

### C. Be + -ing Verb

Sometimes English speakers use the present progressive form (*be + -ing verb*) to express a future action. It is used the same way as *be going to* (when plans are already made). For example, if you have plans to go camping next weekend and someone asks you what you are going to do, you could answer, "*I'm going camping next weekend.*"

*Be + -ing verb* is a **casual** way of forming the future tense. It is most often used for the near future (tonight, tomorrow, next weekend, etc.).

#### Examples:

- My roommate **is going** to Hawaii next weekend.
- We **are planning** to discuss this at the next meeting.
- I **am calling** him back tomorrow after class.

#### Note:

The *be* verb is conjugated according to the subject (*am, are, is*).

### D. Did You Know?

#### Note #1:

##### WHAT ARE SOME COMMON FUTURE TIME MARKERS IN ENGLISH?

*Time markers* are words that show the time (past, present, or future) of a sentence in English. Common time markers for the future include:

- **tomorrow**
- **the day after tomorrow**
- **next** (next week, next month, next year, etc.)
- **from now** (two days from now, three weeks from now, etc.)
- **in** (in four days, in two months, etc.)
- **when** (when two future sentences are joined together—see note #2)

#### Note #2:

##### WHAT HAPPENS WHEN WE USE TWO FUTURE VERBS IN THE SAME SENTENCE?

1. English does NOT use a future form twice in most sentences! The **simple future** form is used in the **independent clause** and the **simple present** is used in the **dependent clause**.
2. The order of the clauses can change in a sentence with no difference in meaning, so the best way to know which clause is dependent (and requires a present verb) is to look for the *adverb of time* (when, while, etc.). When a sentence begins with a dependent clause, a **comma** must be used.
3. The verb in the dependent clause is in the simple present tense, so third person singular subjects take a verb ending in **-s**.

#### Examples:

- He **will call** you when he **arrives** in Las Vegas tomorrow. / When he **arrives** in Las Vegas tomorrow, he **will call** you.
- We **are going to study** for the final exam when my friends **come** over next weekend. / When my friends **come** over next weekend, we **are going to study** for the final exam.
- She **is going to apply** to university when she **graduates**. / When she **graduates**, she **is going to apply** to university.

## Grammar Notes cont.

### E. Quick Review

|                          | <b>Will + base verb</b>                                                                                      | <b>Be going to + base verb</b>                                                                                     | <b>Be + -ing verb (present progressive form)</b>                                   |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Use</b>               | Use when deciding future plans <i>at the moment</i>                                                          | Use when future plans <i>have already been made</i>                                                                | Use when future plans <i>have already been made</i>                                |
| <b>Notes</b>             | Formal future form<br>(preferred in writing; it may be used formally even when plans have already been made) | Casual future form<br>(preferred in speaking; most common form; <i>going to</i> is often reduced to <i>gonna</i> ) | Casual future form<br>(preferred in speaking; used especially for the near future) |
| <b>Example Statement</b> | Yes, I <b>will go</b> to the movies with you tonight.                                                        | He <b>is going to study</b> all weekend for his test.                                                              | She <b>is giving</b> her presentation tomorrow.                                    |
| <b>Example Negative</b>  | No, I <b>will not be</b> ready to go at 5:00.                                                                | They <b>are not going to go</b> to the party because they have school tomorrow.                                    | We <b>are not leaving</b> until we get an answer.                                  |
| <b>Example Question</b>  | <b>Will</b> you <b>call</b> me later?                                                                        | <b>Is</b> she <b>going to read</b> that entire book tonight?                                                       | <b>Are</b> they <b>coming</b> over for dinner on Friday?                           |

## Exercise 1

### FILL IN THE BLANKS (WILL)

#### A. Long Form

Write the verb in the future tense with *will* or *will not*.

Ex. My neighbor is sick, so he will not go to work tomorrow morning.  
(go, not)

1. It's a beautiful day, so we \_\_\_\_\_ inside.  
(stay)

2. My mom \_\_\_\_\_ the lights off at 9:00 pm.  
(turn)

3. I think I \_\_\_\_\_ home today.  
(walk)

4. Their kids \_\_\_\_\_ in the park after dark.  
(play, not)

5. Our teacher \_\_\_\_\_ us a quiz next Thursday.  
(give)

6. My husband \_\_\_\_\_ you back after he gets out of the shower.  
(call)

7. The movie \_\_\_\_\_ at 8:00 pm.  
(start)

8. He \_\_\_\_\_ to college next month.  
(apply)

9. Her parents \_\_\_\_\_ her. They \_\_\_\_\_ her instead.  
(text, not) (call)

10. They \_\_\_\_\_ the bus after school. Their mother \_\_\_\_\_ them home instead.  
(take, not) (drive)

## Exercise 1 cont.

### B. Short Form

Now try using contractions.

Use *'ll* instead of *will* and *won't* instead of *will not*.

Ex. My friend won't go to the doctor's next week because she is feeling better.  
(go, not)

1. My coworker \_\_\_\_\_ in the office tomorrow because she is on holidays.  
(be, not)

2. I \_\_\_\_\_ some coffee, please.  
(have)

3. He \_\_\_\_\_ video games after school.  
(play)

4. The children \_\_\_\_\_ books that are too difficult.  
(read, not)

5. We \_\_\_\_\_ dinner at 7:00 pm.  
(eat)

6. I \_\_\_\_\_ for my test tonight because I'm sick.  
(study, not)

7. She \_\_\_\_\_ the guitar on Saturday morning.  
(practice)

8. She \_\_\_\_\_ the flowers in a few minutes.  
(water)

9. You \_\_\_\_\_ me back. You never do.  
(call, not)

10. They \_\_\_\_\_ on their presentation after school.  
(work)

#### Did You Know?

The abbreviation *'ll* is common with pronouns (*I'll, you'll, he'll, she'll, it'll, we'll, they'll*). The abbreviation *won't* is common with all pronouns and nouns.

## Exercise 2

### FORTUNE-TELLING (WILL)

#### A. Write Fortunes

Write five fortunes with *will* and five with *won't*.

Ex. *You will live until you're 100 years old.*

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_
4. \_\_\_\_\_
5. \_\_\_\_\_

Ex. *You won't break any bones this year.*

6. \_\_\_\_\_
7. \_\_\_\_\_
8. \_\_\_\_\_
9. \_\_\_\_\_
10. \_\_\_\_\_

#### B. Be a Fortune-Teller

Next, ask a classmate to choose a number between 1 and 10. Read out the fortune you wrote in Part A for that number, and then pick a number and listen to your classmate's fortune for you! Repeat with all your classmates.

#### Example:

A: Choose a number between 1 and 10.

B: Number 8.

A: You won't eat vegetables for dinner.

B: Oh, good. I don't like vegetables! Now you can choose a number.

A: Number 3.

B: You will win the lottery!

A: Awesome!

## Exercise 3

### CHOOSE THE VERB (BE GOING TO)

#### A. Long Form

Choose the correct word from the list on the right to complete the following sentences. Use the correct form of the future tense with *be going to*. Use *am*, *are*, or *is*. Do not use contractions in this exercise.

#### Word List:

- |                    |            |          |         |
|--------------------|------------|----------|---------|
| • wear             | • give     | • change | • clean |
| <del>• email</del> | • practice | • hang   |         |

Ex. My brother sent me an email yesterday. I am going to email him back tomorrow.

1. My house is very dirty. I \_\_\_\_\_ it tomorrow.
2. Miriam is going to a party next Saturday. She \_\_\_\_\_ her new red dress.
3. Robert bought a new painting at the art show. He \_\_\_\_\_ it over the sofa in his living room.
4. The hockey championship is next month. The boys \_\_\_\_\_ every night next week.
5. It's our parents' anniversary tomorrow. We \_\_\_\_\_ them a gift certificate to a popular restaurant.
6. My car has a flat tire. My brother \_\_\_\_\_ it later today.

#### B. Short Form

Choose the correct verb from the list on the right to complete the following sentences. Use the contracted form of the future tense with *be going to*. Use *'m*, *'re*, or *'s*.

#### Word List:

- |         |        |            |                    |
|---------|--------|------------|--------------------|
| • get   | • take | • ask      | <del>• study</del> |
| • visit | • quit | • exchange |                    |

Ex. We have a math exam in three days. We 're going to study very hard for it.

1. It's very cold and rainy outside. I \_\_\_\_\_ a nice, hot bath as soon as I get home from this soccer game.
2. Ellie has a hair appointment this afternoon. She \_\_\_\_\_ her hair cut and colored.
3. Jack hates his job. He \_\_\_\_\_ next week.
4. Sue got a sweater from her mother-in-law for her birthday. It didn't fit, so she \_\_\_\_\_ it for a larger size.
5. Sam just got his driver's license. He \_\_\_\_\_ his father to let him borrow the car next weekend.
6. Their grandmother is in the hospital. They \_\_\_\_\_ her next weekend.

## Exercise 4

### WHAT'S GOING TO HAPPEN? (BE GOING TO)

Read the following sentences and add another one using your own ideas.  
Try to write some positive sentences using *be + going + to + verb* and some  
negative sentences using *be + not + going + to + verb*. Use contractions.

Ex. She has a bad toothache.

*She's going to call the dentist. OR She's not going to eat an apple.*

---

1. He doesn't understand the meaning of that word.

---

2. She wants to see that new movie but doesn't know what time it starts.

---

3. Bill doesn't want to change jobs.

---

4. Grandma feels very tired.

---

5. Carla is baking a cake and just ran out of sugar.

---

6. John doesn't need to go to work today.

---

7. Rhonda and Murray are thinking about taking a holiday but don't know where to go.

---

8. Someone stole our car last night.

---

9. Margaret gained 10 pounds in the past month.

---

## Exercise 5

### GOAL-SETTING (BE GOING TO)

#### A. My Goals

What are some goals that you have? Get into small groups. First, write down five personal goals, and then share them with your group members.

Ex. 1. *I'm going to be a pilot.*

Ex. 2. *I'm going to learn how to skateboard.*

Ex. 3. *I'm going to travel to Europe next summer.*

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_
4. \_\_\_\_\_
5. \_\_\_\_\_

#### B. My Group's Goals

Now write down one interesting goal from each member of your group.

| Classmate | Goal                                  |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|
| Michelle  | <i>She's going to learn Japanese.</i> |
|           |                                       |
|           |                                       |
|           |                                       |
|           |                                       |
|           |                                       |
|           |                                       |

## Exercise 6

### QUESTIONS & ANSWERS (WILL, BE GOING TO & BE + -ING)

#### A. Reference

| <b>will</b>                      |                      |                 |
|----------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Questions</b>                 | <b>Short Answers</b> |                 |
| Will you pass the test?          | Yes, I will.         | No, I won't.    |
| Will he do his homework tonight? | Yes, he will.        | No, he won't.   |
| Will they finish school on time? | Yes, they will.      | No, they won't. |

| <b>be going to</b>                             |                      |                                        |
|------------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>Questions</b>                               | <b>Short Answers</b> |                                        |
| Are you going to clean your room this weekend? | Yes, I am.           | No, I'm not.                           |
| Is she going to go to the park after school?   | Yes, she is.         | No, she isn't. /<br>No, she's not.     |
| Are they going to buy a new car?               | Yes, they are.       | No, they aren't. /<br>No, they're not. |

| <b>be + -ing</b>                          |                      |                                        |
|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>Questions</b>                          | <b>Short Answers</b> |                                        |
| Are you going to Spain next fall?         | Yes, I am.           | No, I'm not.                           |
| Is he visiting his grandparents tomorrow? | Yes, he is.          | No, he's not. /<br>No, he isn't.       |
| Are they getting a new pet?               | Yes, they are.       | No, they aren't. /<br>No, they're not. |

## Exercise 6 cont.

### B. Short Answers

Write a short answer for each question using the word in parentheses.

Ex. Are you going snowboarding next weekend? **(no)**

*No, I'm not.*

1. Is she going to call you tonight? **(no)**

\_\_\_\_\_

2. Will you be ready for the quiz tomorrow morning? **(yes)**

\_\_\_\_\_

3. Are they going to go to that new restaurant? **(no)**

\_\_\_\_\_

4. Is he planning to see a movie on Friday? **(yes)**

\_\_\_\_\_

5. Will he join us for dinner? **(no)**

\_\_\_\_\_

6. Will we finish our project on time? **(yes)**

\_\_\_\_\_

7. Are you going to wash your car soon? **(yes)**

\_\_\_\_\_

8. Are you going to the beach after school? **(no)**

\_\_\_\_\_

### C. Questions

Write six future questions to ask your partner using *will*, *be going to*, and *be + -ing*.

| # | Prompt      | Sentence |
|---|-------------|----------|
| 1 | will        |          |
| 2 | be going to |          |
| 3 | be + -ing   |          |
| 4 | will        |          |
| 5 | be going to |          |
| 6 | be + -ing   |          |

## Exercise 6 cont.

### D. Questions & Answers

Practice making questions and giving short answers.

Ex. I'm going to buy a new car.

*Are you going to buy a new car?*

*Yes, I am.*

1. They won't be at school tomorrow.

---

---

2. I'm not going to call him back this afternoon.

---

---

3. We're going to visit our aunt next summer.

---

---

4. He's not going to Hawaii next month.

---

---

5. She is going to graduate next spring.

---

---

6. They will bring their notes to the meeting tomorrow morning.

---

---

7. He's having a party on Friday.

---

---

8. I'll let you know as soon as possible.

---

---

## Exercise 7 (Student A)

### PAIR WORK (BE GOING TO)

#### A. Sarah's Schedule

Here is your friend Sarah's schedule, but it is missing some information. Ask your partner about the missing plans and fill in the schedule. Practice saying "gonna" instead of "going to."

#### Example:

A: What is Sarah going to do on Monday evening?

B: She is going to go to a movie with Dave.

| Time      | Monday                     | Tuesday         | Wednesday | Thursday          | Friday             | Saturday        | Sunday                 |
|-----------|----------------------------|-----------------|-----------|-------------------|--------------------|-----------------|------------------------|
| morning   |                            | meet with boss  |           | attend conference |                    | clean apartment |                        |
| afternoon | buy groceries for the week |                 | go to gym |                   | buy food for party |                 | take nephew to the zoo |
| evening   | movie with Dave            | do work reports |           | do the ironing    |                    | party           |                        |

#### B. My Schedule

Now answer the questions about yourself in complete sentences with *be going to*.

1. What are you going to do next Monday afternoon?

---

2. What are you going to do next Wednesday evening?

---

3. What are you going to do next Friday morning?

---

4. What are you going to do next Saturday evening?

---

5. What are you going to do next Sunday morning?

---

## Exercise 7 (Student B)

### PAIR WORK (BE GOING TO)

#### A. Sarah's Schedule

Here is your friend Sarah's schedule, but it is missing some information. Ask your partner about the missing plans and fill in the schedule. Practice saying "gonna" instead of "going to."

#### Example:

A: What is Sarah going to do on Monday evening?

B: She is going to go to a movie with Dave.

| Time      | Monday               | Tuesday   | Wednesday               | Thursday          | Friday              | Saturday                | Sunday            |
|-----------|----------------------|-----------|-------------------------|-------------------|---------------------|-------------------------|-------------------|
| morning   | doctor's appointment |           | return library books    |                   | go to gym           |                         | visit grandmother |
| afternoon |                      | go to gym |                         | attend conference |                     | cook, prepare for party |                   |
| evening   | movie with Dave      |           | dinner with girlfriends |                   | dinner with parents |                         | relax at home     |

#### B. My Schedule

Now answer the questions about yourself in complete sentences with *be going to*.

1. What are you going to do next Monday afternoon?

---

2. What are you going to do next Wednesday evening?

---

3. What are you going to do next Friday morning?

---

4. What are you going to do next Saturday evening?

---

5. What are you going to do next Sunday morning?

---

## Exercise 8

## WILL OR BE GOING TO? (WILL & BE GOING TO)

Complete the following sentences using the correct form of *will* or *be going to* with the verb provided. Use contractions whenever possible. Be prepared to explain the reason for your choice.

Ex. 1. A: Can you come to my party tomorrow?  
B: Sure, I                     'll come                     !

*"Will" is used when making a decision at the moment.*

Ex. 2. Next summer, she 's going to go to Japan.

*"Be going to" is used when plans are already made.*

1. Sam feels sick. He knows that he \_\_\_\_\_ home from work tomorrow.  
(stay)

2. I can't go out for dinner because I \_\_\_\_\_ my homework.  
(finish)

3. A: I left my wallet at home.  
B: That's okay. I \_\_\_\_\_ you some money.  
(lend)

4. I don't think I \_\_\_\_\_ able to come to your party.  
(be)

5. Frank \_\_\_\_\_ a two-week holiday next year.  
(take)

6. That box looks very heavy. I \_\_\_\_\_ you carry it.  
(help)

7. I bought some paint because I \_\_\_\_\_ my apartment.  
(paint)

8. He \_\_\_\_\_ a black tuxedo to the wedding. What \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ ?  
(wear) (wear)

9. A: Why did you take the sugar out of the cupboard?  
B: I \_\_\_\_\_ a cake.  
(bake)

10. They took money out of the bank because they \_\_\_\_\_ a new TV for their daughter.  
(buy)

## Exercise 8 cont.

11. It's very hot in here. I \_\_\_\_\_ the window for you.  
(open)
12. The weatherman says it \_\_\_\_\_ a beautiful day tomorrow,  
(be)  
so I think I \_\_\_\_\_ to the beach.  
(go)
13. We probably \_\_\_\_\_ to the party next weekend.  
(not/go)
14. A: Can I please talk to the manager?  
B: He \_\_\_\_\_ with you in a moment.  
(be)
15. The Andersons went to the travel agency yesterday. They \_\_\_\_\_ their tickets tomorrow.  
(buy)
16. We \_\_\_\_\_ that new movie tonight. Do you want to come with us?  
(see)
17. Allan \_\_\_\_\_ up early tomorrow so that he can go fishing.  
(get)
18. Okay, I \_\_\_\_\_ you move tomorrow.  
(help)
19. A: Do you have any holiday plans?  
B: Yes. We \_\_\_\_\_ a Mediterranean cruise.  
(take)
20. A: Ronnie can't drive me to the airport.  
B: That's okay. I \_\_\_\_\_ you.  
(take)

## Exercise 9

### TRAVEL PLANS (WILL & BE GOING TO)

#### A. Fill in the Blanks

Complete the dialogue by writing in the correct future verb.  
Do not use contractions. Use *will* if someone is making the decision right now. Use *be going to* if the plans were already made before.

- Kate:** Hi, David! I heard you are going to go to Australia! When \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ ?  
1. go 2. leave
- David:** Hey, Kate! I \_\_\_\_\_ in two weeks.  
3. leave
- Kate:** Wow! You \_\_\_\_\_ an amazing experience.  
4. have
- David:** I hope so. I'm not sure if I should start packing now. What do you think?
- Kate:** I think it's better to get organized as soon as possible.
- David:** You're right. I \_\_\_\_\_ packing tonight.  
5. start
- Kate:** That's a good idea. So what \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ first?  
6. see
- David:** I \_\_\_\_\_ to the Sydney Opera House.  
7. stop by
- Kate:** Good idea!
- David:** Maybe I \_\_\_\_\_ the Harbour Bridge while I'm there.  
8. check out
- Kate:** Wow. I really want to go to Australia too.
- David:** Why don't you join me? Say you \_\_\_\_\_ !  
9. come
- Kate:** Really? Okay! Maybe I \_\_\_\_\_ with you!  
10. go

#### B. Pair Work 1

Read the dialogue aloud with a partner.  
Change the verbs into contractions (the short form) whenever possible. Remember to pronounce "going to" as "gonna."

#### C. Pair Work 2

Now choose any place in the world and imagine you are going there. Where will you go? What are you going to do while you're there? Discuss your travel plans with a partner.

## Exercise 10

### FUTURE TIME CLAUSES (WILL & BE GOING TO)

#### Did You Know?

In future sentences with two clauses, both *will* and *be going to* are correct in the independent clause. *Will* is formal and *be going to* is casual. Try using both forms in this exercise.

#### Did You Remember?

You must use the simple future tense in the independent clause and the simple present tense in a dependent clause. Dependent clauses begin with words such as *when*, *before*, *after*, *as soon as*, and *until*.

#### Did You Remember?

If a sentence begins with a dependent clause, it must be followed by a comma.

Complete the following sentences with the correct future form of the verb provided. Underline the dependent clause in each sentence.

Ex. She will eat (eat) before she leaves (leave) for work.

- I'm going to eat lunch at 12:30. After I \_\_\_\_\_ (eat) lunch, I \_\_\_\_\_ (take) a nap.
- As soon as it \_\_\_\_\_ (stop) raining, I \_\_\_\_\_ (walk) to the store.
- I \_\_\_\_\_ (lend) you this book as soon as I \_\_\_\_\_ (finish) it.
- He \_\_\_\_\_ (finish) this letter before he \_\_\_\_\_ (buy) stamps.
- When the class \_\_\_\_\_ (be) over, Marilyn \_\_\_\_\_ (go) shopping.
- They \_\_\_\_\_ (visit) many museums when they \_\_\_\_\_ (go) to Europe.
- When the chairman \_\_\_\_\_ (arrive), everyone \_\_\_\_\_ (sit) down.
- After they \_\_\_\_\_ (do) their homework, they \_\_\_\_\_ (watch) TV.

## Exercise 10 cont.

9. She \_\_\_\_\_ a hot bath as soon as she \_\_\_\_\_ home.  
(take) (get)
10. I \_\_\_\_\_ you back the money I borrowed as soon as I \_\_\_\_\_ my paycheck.  
(pay) (get)
11. He \_\_\_\_\_ home until he \_\_\_\_\_ better.  
(stay) (feel)
12. We \_\_\_\_\_ birthday cake after we \_\_\_\_\_ dinner.  
(have) (finish)
13. As soon as she \_\_\_\_\_ here, we \_\_\_\_\_ dinner.  
(get) (eat)
14. She \_\_\_\_\_ the clothes after she \_\_\_\_\_ them.  
(iron) (wash)
15. I \_\_\_\_\_ you until I \_\_\_\_\_ .  
(love) (die)
16. I \_\_\_\_\_ for a new passport before I \_\_\_\_\_ a ticket.  
(apply) (buy)

## Exercise 11

### FIND SOMEONE WHO (WILL, BE GOING TO & BE + -ING)

Interview your classmates. Walk around the class and find someone...

| #  | Find someone...                                               | Classmate's name |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| 1  | who is going to visit a friend tonight.                       |                  |
| 2  | who will probably leave the city this weekend.                |                  |
| 3  | who isn't going to watch TV tonight.                          |                  |
| 4  | who's going to walk home from school today.                   |                  |
| 5  | who is getting a hair cut this week.                          |                  |
| 6  | who won't have a birthday next month.                         |                  |
| 7  | who thinks it'll be a nice day tomorrow.                      |                  |
| 8  | who is going to buy a present for someone this week.          |                  |
| 9  | who's buying groceries after school today.                    |                  |
| 10 | who will have something to eat as soon as the class finishes. |                  |

## Exercise 12

### QUIZ (WILL, BE GOING TO & BE + -ING)

Circle the correct answer.

1. The girl \_\_\_\_\_ to the mall after school.
  - a) is going to go
  - b) will goes
  - c) is going to going
2. My grandparents \_\_\_\_\_ us next weekend.
  - a) will visiting
  - b) are visiting
  - c) are going to visit
3. She \_\_\_\_\_ her dog to the vet today.
  - a) will taking
  - b) will take
  - c) will takes
4. I \_\_\_\_\_ for Disneyland in three days.
  - a) are leaving
  - b) is leaving
  - c) am leaving
5. He will go sightseeing when he \_\_\_\_\_ in Thailand.
  - a) will arrives
  - b) arrives
  - c) is going to arrive
6. There \_\_\_\_\_ a test on Friday.
  - a) is being
  - b) is being to be
  - c) will be
7. The kids \_\_\_\_\_ well after all that physical activity.
  - a) are going to sleep
  - b) is going to sleep
  - c) am going to sleep
8. They \_\_\_\_\_ their lunch because they aren't hungry.
  - a) won't eat
  - b) will eat not
  - c) is not eating
9. \_\_\_\_\_ join the game?
  - a) Are you
  - b) Are you going
  - c) Are you going to
10. When we \_\_\_\_\_ to a new city next month, we will meet new people.
  - a) will move
  - b) move
  - c) are move

# Answer Key

### LESSON DESCRIPTION:

This lesson reviews the three main ways to form the future tense (with *will*, *be going to*, and *be + ing*). Students will study the differences between these forms and practice using them through individual and group exercises.

**LEVEL:** Low Int – Int

**TIME:** 4 hours

**TAGS:** future, simple future, will, be going to, be + -ing, present progressive, verbs, verb tenses, grammar, grammar practice

## Exercise 1

### A. LONG FORM

- |                  |                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1. will not stay | 6. will call                  |
| 2. will turn     | 7. will start                 |
| 3. will walk     | 8. will apply                 |
| 4. will not play | 9. will not text, will call   |
| 5. will give     | 10. will not take, will drive |

### B. SHORT FORM

- |               |                 |
|---------------|-----------------|
| 1. won't be   | 6. won't study  |
| 2. 'll have   | 7. 'll practice |
| 3. 'll play   | 8. 'll water    |
| 4. won't read | 9. won't call   |
| 5. 'll eat    | 10. 'll work    |

## Exercise 2

Answers will vary.

## Exercise 3

### A. LONG FORM

- |                      |                          |
|----------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. am going to clean | 4. are going to practice |
| 2. is going to wear  | 5. is going to give      |
| 3. is going to hang  | 6. is going to change    |

### B. SHORT FORM

- |                     |                         |
|---------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. 'm going to take | 4. 's going to exchange |
| 2. 's going to get  | 5. 's going to ask      |
| 3. 's going to quit | 6. 're going to visit   |

## Exercise 4

Answers will vary. Make sure your students are using the contracted forms of *be going to*, and check that they are writing a mix of positive and negative sentences. As a follow-up, have students share their answers in small groups or as a class.

## Exercise 5

Answers will vary.

*(continued on the next page...)*

# Answer Key cont.

## Exercise 6

### B. SHORT ANSWERS

1. No, she isn't. / No, she's not.
2. Yes, I will.
3. No, they aren't. / No, they're not.
4. Yes, he is.
5. No, he won't.
6. Yes, we will.
7. Yes, I am.
8. No, I'm not.

### C. QUESTIONS

Answers will vary.

### D. QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

1. Will they be at school tomorrow? No, they won't.
2. Are you going to call him back this afternoon? No, I'm not.
3. Are we going to visit our aunt next summer? Yes, we are.
4. Is he going to Hawaii next month? No, he isn't. / No, he's not.
5. Is she going to graduate next spring? Yes, she is.
6. Will they bring their notes to the meeting tomorrow morning? Yes, they will.
7. Is he having a party on Friday? Yes, he is.
8. Will you let me know as soon as possible? Yes, I will.

## Exercise 7

### A. SARAH'S SCHEDULE

Monitor your students for correct question formation. When the pairs have completed Part A, have them compare charts to check their answers.

### B. MY SCHEDULE

Answers will vary.

## Exercise 8

The focus of Exercise 8 and 9 is to recognize when *will* or *be going to* is the more natural choice. An answer that differs from the ones below isn't incorrect, but we recommend encouraging students to think of why the answers listed here are the most suitable. You may choose to accept other answers as correct.

- |                       |                       |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| 1. 's going to stay   | 11. 'll open          |
| 2. 'm going to finish | 12. 's going to be,   |
| 3. 'll lend           | 'll go                |
| 4. 'll be             | 13. won't go          |
| 5. is going to take   | 14. 'll be            |
| 6. 'll help           | 15. 're going to buy  |
| 7. 'm going to paint  | 16. 're going to see  |
| 8. 's going to wear,  | 17. 's going to get   |
| are, going to wear    | 18. 'll help          |
| 9. 'm going to bake   | 19. 're going to take |
| 10. 're going to buy  | 20. 'll take          |

## Exercise 9

### A. FILL IN THE BLANKS

- |                        |                        |
|------------------------|------------------------|
| 1. are going to go     | 6. are, going to see   |
| 2. are, going to leave | 7. am going to stop by |
| 3. am going to leave   | 8. will check out      |
| 4. are going to have   | 9. will come           |
| 5. will start          | 10. will go            |

### B. PAIR WORK 1

Circulate to make sure students are using contractions and "gonna."

### C. PAIR WORK 2

Answers will vary.

(continued on the next page...)

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 10

The answers here are given with *will*, but any answer with *be going to* is also correct. Encourage students to use both forms. Also, the answers here are not contracted, but you may wish to assign students to do half with contractions and half without.

- |                      |                       |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| 1. eat, will take    | 9. will take, gets    |
| 2. stops, will walk  | 10. will pay, get     |
| 3. will lend, finish | 11. will stay, feels  |
| 4. will finish, buys | 12. will have, finish |
| 5. is, will go       | 13. gets, will eat    |
| 6. will visit, go    | 14. will iron, washes |
| 7. arrives, will sit | 15. will love, die    |
| 8. do, will watch    | 16. will apply, buy   |

### Exercise 11

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 12

- |      |      |      |      |       |
|------|------|------|------|-------|
| 1. a | 3. b | 5. b | 7. a | 9. c  |
| 2. c | 4. c | 6. c | 8. a | 10. b |

#### SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Neighbor*, *License*, *Colored*, and *Practice*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Neighbour*, *Licence*, *Coloured*, and *Practise* (when used as a verb; *Practice* when used as a noun). Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

#### EDITOR'S NOTE:

Because this is one of our longest lessons, you might want to consider one or more of these ways of saving paper if you're planning to print out this lesson:

- Print double-sided.
- Only print out the pages you plan on doing that day.
- Display some of the exercises on an overhead projector or SMART Board and have students write the answers in their notebooks.
- Give the instructions orally for the speaking and writing activities on pages 7 and 10.
- Assign some of the exercises as pair or group tasks and only print out one page per pair/group.

# Simple Past

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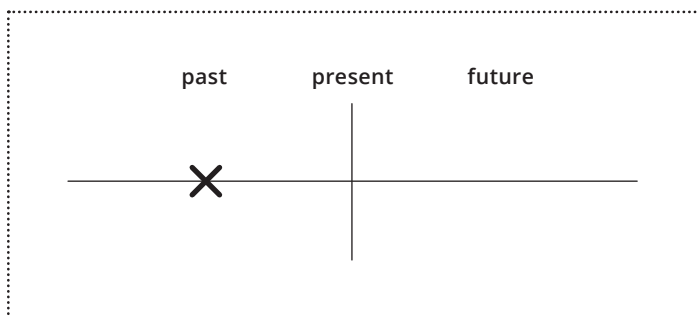
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## Grammar Notes

### SIMPLE PAST

#### A. Use

We use the **simple past** to talk about finished actions that happened in the past.



#### B. Time Markers

Words that show the time of an action are called "time markers."  
Common time markers for the simple past are *yesterday*, *last*, *ago*, and *when*.

| Time Marker      | Examples                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>yesterday</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I walked my dog <b>yesterday</b>.</li> <li>He called me <b>yesterday morning</b>.</li> </ul>                                                               |
| <b>last</b>      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>They went to the movies <b>last night</b>.</li> <li>Our company hired 20 new employees <b>last year</b>.</li> </ul>                                        |
| <b>ago</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>She got a new job <b>two months ago</b>.</li> <li><b>Six weeks ago</b>, we moved to New York.</li> </ul>                                                   |
| <b>when</b>      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>My brother learned to ride a bike <b>when he was four years old</b>.</li> <li><b>When I graduated from university</b>, I applied for many jobs.</li> </ul> |

## Grammar Notes cont.

### C. Form

A common way to form the simple past is to add *-ed* to the end of a verb.  
These verbs are called “**regular** verbs.”

Other verbs have many kinds of changes.  
They are called “**irregular** verbs.”

The **Be** verb is a special kind of irregular verb.  
It has two forms (*was* and *were*). It also has different sentence patterns.

Let’s look at regular verbs, irregular verbs, and the *Be* verb in more detail.

### D. Regular Verbs

To form the past tense of regular verbs, add *-ed* to the base verb.

| Type of Sentence    | Pattern                              | Examples                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Positive</b>     | base verb + <i>-ed</i>               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>talked</b> to my friends for hours yesterday.</li> <li>They <b>worked</b> until 7:00 pm last night.</li> <li>She <b>tried</b> to help me two weeks ago.</li> <li>My coworkers <b>completed</b> the project.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Negative</b>     | did not / didn't + base verb         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>He <b>did not study</b> French at school.</li> <li>My classmates <b>didn't like</b> my speech.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Question</b>     | did + subject + base verb            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><b>Did</b> you <b>call</b> me last night?</li> <li><b>Did</b> she <b>go</b> on a trip last year?</li> </ul>                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Wh- Question</b> | Wh- word + did + subject + base verb | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>When <b>did</b> you <b>leave</b>?</li> <li>How <b>did</b> they <b>know</b> about the test?</li> </ul>                                                                                                                       |



## Grammar Notes cont.

### D. Regular Verbs cont.

How do we spell regular past verbs? Follow these simple rules:

| # | Rule                                                                                                           | Examples                                                                                                           |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | If a verb ends in <i>-e</i> , add <i>-d</i> .                                                                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>like → liked</li> <li>arrive → arrived</li> <li>decide → decided</li> </ul> |
| 2 | If a verb ends in consonant + <i>-y</i> , change <i>-y</i> to <i>-i</i> and add <i>-ed</i> .                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>carry → carried</li> <li>try → tried</li> <li>study → studied</li> </ul>    |
| 3 | If a verb ends in vowel + <i>-y</i> , add <i>-ed</i> .*                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>play → played</li> <li>stay → stayed</li> <li>enjoy → enjoyed</li> </ul>    |
| 4 | If a verb ends in a consonant-vowel-consonant (CVC) pattern, double the final consonant and add <i>-ed</i> .** | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>hug → hugged</li> <li>plan → planned</li> <li>stop → stopped</li> </ul>     |
| 5 | For all other verbs, add <i>-ed</i> .                                                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>watch → watched</li> <li>ask → asked</li> <li>clean → cleaned</li> </ul>    |

#### \*Note:

There are some exceptions to this rule:

- pay → paid
- lay → laid

#### \*\*Note:

For verbs with more than one syllable, this rule is only true if the stress is on the **last** syllable. Notice the difference below:

- prefer → preferred
- visit → visited

## Grammar Notes cont.

### E. Irregular Verbs

To form the past tense of an irregular verb, we must make a change (in the middle or ending) to the verb.

| Type of Sentence    | Pattern                              | Examples                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Positive</b>     | various changes*                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>She <b>wrote</b> me a long email this morning.</li> <li>I <b>ate</b> an entire pizza on the weekend.</li> <li>The staff members <b>met</b> with the boss.</li> <li>They <b>rode</b> their bikes to school when they <b>were</b> young.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Negative</b>     | did not / didn't + base verb         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>He <b>did not read</b> the newspaper yesterday.</li> <li>My neighbors <b>didn't pay</b> their rent last month.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Question</b>     | did + subject + base verb            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><b>Did</b> you <b>tell</b> her about your accident?</li> <li><b>Did</b> they <b>go</b> shopping yesterday afternoon?</li> </ul>                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Wh- Question</b> | Wh- word + did + subject + base verb | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>When <b>did</b> you <b>catch</b> a cold?</li> <li>Why <b>did</b> you <b>sing</b> that song?</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                            |

#### \*Note:

For a complete list of irregular verbs, see page 23 in this lesson.

## Grammar Notes cont.

### F. Be Verb

To form the past tense of the Be verb, use the words *was* or *were*.

| Type of Sentence    | Pattern                                                        | Examples                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Positive</b>     | I / he / she / it / singular count noun / non-count noun + was | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I <b>was</b> happy when I <b>was</b> in Hawaii.</li> <li>The teacher <b>was</b> in the classroom.</li> </ul> |
|                     | you / we / they / plural count noun + were                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>We <b>were</b> sick last month.</li> <li>The children <b>were</b> at the park.</li> </ul>                    |
| <b>Negative</b>     | was not / wasn't                                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>He <b>was not</b> at home last night.</li> </ul>                                                             |
|                     | were not / weren't                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>We <b>weren't</b> at work yesterday.</li> </ul>                                                              |
| <b>Question</b>     | was / were + subject                                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><b>Were</b> you in trouble?</li> <li><b>Was</b> your sister at school yesterday?</li> </ul>                  |
| <b>Wh- Question</b> | Wh- word + was / were + subject                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Who <b>was</b> that?</li> <li>Where <b>were</b> you?</li> </ul>                                              |

## Exercise 1

### FILL IN THE BLANKS

Put the correct past tense form of *Be* in the blanks below.

Ex. Eva was sick yesterday.

1. We \_\_\_\_\_ in the same class last year.
2. I \_\_\_\_\_ tired after a long day at work.
3. The weather \_\_\_\_\_ beautiful yesterday.
4. My teachers \_\_\_\_\_ really good last semester.
5. The children \_\_\_\_\_ hungry after so much exercise.
6. The wind \_\_\_\_\_ very strong last night.
7. She \_\_\_\_\_ so happy last week.
8. They \_\_\_\_\_ nervous on the first day of school.
9. Luckily, the windows \_\_\_\_\_ closed during the rainstorm.
10. We \_\_\_\_\_ very happy to get your invitation last week.

## Exercise 2

### COMPLETE THE SENTENCES

Finish the following sentences using  
the negative form of *Be* in the past tense.

Ex. I am at work today, but I wasn't at work yesterday.

1. It is cold outside today, but \_\_\_\_\_
2. She is sick today, but \_\_\_\_\_
3. They are at school today, but \_\_\_\_\_
4. The TV show is good today, but \_\_\_\_\_
5. The peaches are sweet today, but \_\_\_\_\_
6. The class is interesting today, but \_\_\_\_\_
7. He is angry today, but \_\_\_\_\_
8. The door is locked today, but \_\_\_\_\_
9. The exercises are easy today, but \_\_\_\_\_
10. The children are tired today, but \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 3

### PAIR WORK

Write the questions using the prompt and the simple past tense.  
Then interview your partner. Write down your **partner's answers**.

| #  | Prompt                             | Question                            | Answer               |
|----|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Ex | at home / last night               | <i>Were you at home last night?</i> | <i>No, I wasn't.</i> |
| 1  | at school / yesterday              |                                     |                      |
| 2  | at the movies / last weekend       |                                     |                      |
| 3  | at the gym / last week             |                                     |                      |
| 4  | at the mall / last month           |                                     |                      |
| 5  | in another country / last year     |                                     |                      |
| 6  | tired / last night                 |                                     |                      |
| 7  | angry / last week                  |                                     |                      |
| 8  | sick / last month                  |                                     |                      |
| 9  | excited / about your last birthday |                                     |                      |
| 10 | happy / during your last vacation  |                                     |                      |

## Exercise 4

### VERB CHART (REGULAR VERBS)

Review the spelling rules on page 4.  
Then write the past forms of these regular verbs.

| #  | Base Form | Past Form    |
|----|-----------|--------------|
| Ex | ask       | <i>asked</i> |
| 1  | brush     |              |
| 2  | carry     |              |
| 3  | check     |              |
| 4  | clean     |              |
| 5  | cry       |              |
| 6  | dance     |              |
| 7  | decide    |              |
| 8  | hope      |              |
| 9  | hug       |              |

| #  | Base Form | Past Form |
|----|-----------|-----------|
| 10 | laugh     |           |
| 11 | learn     |           |
| 12 | like      |           |
| 13 | listen    |           |
| 14 | plan      |           |
| 15 | play      |           |
| 16 | study     |           |
| 17 | talk      |           |
| 18 | walk      |           |
| 19 | wash      |           |

## Exercise 5

### CHOOSE THE CORRECT VERB

Choose a verb from the list on the right to complete the following sentences. Write the verb in the past tense. Use each verb only once.

Ex. I \_\_\_\_\_ *visited* \_\_\_\_\_ my friend in the hospital last night.

1. The boys \_\_\_\_\_ baseball in the field behind the school.
2. Robert \_\_\_\_\_ his wife wash the dishes.
3. We \_\_\_\_\_ our living room a soft blue color.
4. Susan \_\_\_\_\_ TV for two hours last night.
5. We \_\_\_\_\_ planes on the way to New York.
6. She \_\_\_\_\_ for him for 20 minutes at the coffee shop.
7. He \_\_\_\_\_ how to swim when he was a child.
8. They \_\_\_\_\_ all around the country three years ago.
9. The students \_\_\_\_\_ late for class.
10. We \_\_\_\_\_ to the radio until midnight.

**Verb List:**

- change
- ~~visit~~
- paint
- travel
- listen
- help
- arrive
- learn
- watch
- play
- wait

## Exercise 6

### QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

#### A. Write the Answers

Answer the questions using the simple past tense and the prompt.

| #  | Question                            | Prompt | Answer                 |
|----|-------------------------------------|--------|------------------------|
| Ex | Did Anna bake a cake last weekend?  | no     | <i>No, she didn't.</i> |
| 1  | Did the boys play soccer yesterday? | yes    |                        |
| 2  | Did she call her mother last night? | no     |                        |
| 3  | Did you fix your TV yesterday?      | no     |                        |
| 4  | Did they play in a band together?   | yes    |                        |
| 5  | Did he study history at university? | yes    |                        |

#### B. Interview Your Partner

Now write five questions using any regular verbs from the list on page 10.  
Then ask your partner the questions and write his or her answers.

| #  | Question                            | Answer               |
|----|-------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Ex | <i>Did you watch TV last night?</i> | <i>Yes, she did.</i> |
| 1  |                                     |                      |
| 2  |                                     |                      |
| 3  |                                     |                      |
| 4  |                                     |                      |
| 5  |                                     |                      |

## Exercise 7

### VERB CHART (IRREGULAR VERBS)

Write the past forms of these irregular verbs.  
Refer to the list on page 23 if you need help.

| #  | Base Form | Past Form        |
|----|-----------|------------------|
| Ex | be        | <i>was, were</i> |
| 1  | begin     |                  |
| 2  | bring     |                  |
| 3  | catch     |                  |
| 4  | choose    |                  |
| 5  | do        |                  |
| 6  | fall      |                  |
| 7  | go        |                  |
| 8  | have      |                  |
| 9  | know      |                  |

| #  | Base Form | Past Form |
|----|-----------|-----------|
| 10 | make      |           |
| 11 | read      |           |
| 12 | run       |           |
| 13 | see       |           |
| 14 | sing      |           |
| 15 | sleep     |           |
| 16 | take      |           |
| 17 | teach     |           |
| 18 | think     |           |
| 19 | write     |           |

## Exercise 8

### CHOOSE THE CORRECT VERB

Choose a verb(s) from the list on the right to complete the following sentences. Write the verb(s) in the past tense. Use each verb only once.

Ex. She broke a plate when she was washing the dishes.

1. They \_\_\_\_\_ to Paris in a jumbo jet last week.

2. I \_\_\_\_\_ the alarm clock for 7:00 yesterday morning, but I  
\_\_\_\_\_ up an hour before the alarm clock \_\_\_\_\_.

3. I \_\_\_\_\_ an email to my friend back home.

4. He \_\_\_\_\_ a five-page essay last night.

5. His mother \_\_\_\_\_ care of him when he \_\_\_\_\_ sick.

6. The teacher \_\_\_\_\_ the mathematics class  
and then \_\_\_\_\_ the students three exercises to do for homework.

7. Matthew \_\_\_\_\_ his wallet on the way to work yesterday.

He \_\_\_\_\_ very upset.

8. Angie \_\_\_\_\_ a bad cold last week. She \_\_\_\_\_ in bed for three days.

9. The children \_\_\_\_\_ in the lake behind their house last summer.

10. We \_\_\_\_\_ a wonderful time at your party last night.

11. I \_\_\_\_\_ groceries on my way home yesterday and I \_\_\_\_\_ cash.

12. I \_\_\_\_\_ three friends at the cafe and  
we \_\_\_\_\_ several cups of coffee together.

#### Verb List:

- buy
- ring
- lie
- ~~break~~
- teach
- fly
- set
- send
- wake
- swim
- feel
- pay
- meet
- have
- write
- drink
- give
- get
- take
- catch
- lose

## Exercise 9

### IRREGULAR VERB BINGO

Choose any 24 verbs from the Irregular Verb List on page 23 and write the past tense forms in the squares. Then play Bingo! Draw an ✕ when you hear your teacher call out a matching verb.

|  |  |                       |  |  |
|--|--|-----------------------|--|--|
|  |  |                       |  |  |
|  |  |                       |  |  |
|  |  | <b>Free<br/>Space</b> |  |  |
|  |  |                       |  |  |
|  |  |                       |  |  |

## Exercise 10

### OPPOSITES

Write the opposite of each verb below. Make sure to use the past tense. There may be more than one possible opposite, but try to think of one that has an irregular past form.

| #  | Verb           | Opposite    |
|----|----------------|-------------|
| Ex | gave           | <i>took</i> |
| 1  | remembered     |             |
| 2  | bought         |             |
| 3  | found          |             |
| 4  | sat            |             |
| 5  | arrived        |             |
| 6  | opened         |             |
| 7  | rose (the sun) |             |
| 8  | learned        |             |
| 9  | floated        |             |
| 10 | saved (money)  |             |

## Exercise 11

### TIME MARKERS

Complete the following sentences using *yesterday*, *last*, or *ago*.

Ex. We went skiing a lot last winter.

1. She came to this country three years \_\_\_\_\_ .
2. The teacher canceled the class \_\_\_\_\_ Monday.
3. I spoke to him for ten minutes \_\_\_\_\_ .
4. We went dancing \_\_\_\_\_ night.
5. The boss was away \_\_\_\_\_ morning.
6. We began this class \_\_\_\_\_ fall.
7. The children ran around outside \_\_\_\_\_ afternoon.
8. She got married five years \_\_\_\_\_ .
9. We went shopping \_\_\_\_\_ .
10. He left five minutes \_\_\_\_\_ .

## Exercise 12

### POSITIVE & NEGATIVE

Read the example. Then complete the sentences below using the past tense. Make the first sentence negative and the second one positive.

Ex. Ben usually eats cereal for breakfast.

He didn't eat cereal yesterday.

He ate toast.

1. Ben usually gets up at 7:00.

He \_\_\_\_\_ at 7:00 yesterday.

He \_\_\_\_\_ at 8:00.

2. Ben usually takes a shower.

He \_\_\_\_\_ a shower yesterday.

He \_\_\_\_\_ a bath.

3. Ben usually reads the *Times* newspaper.

He \_\_\_\_\_ the *Times* yesterday.

He \_\_\_\_\_ the *Post*.

4. Ben usually leaves the house at 8:00.

He \_\_\_\_\_ the house at 8:00.

He \_\_\_\_\_ at 9:00.

5. Ben usually takes a bus to work.

He \_\_\_\_\_ a bus yesterday.

He \_\_\_\_\_ a taxi.

6. Ben usually meets his boss in the morning.

He \_\_\_\_\_ his boss in the morning.

He \_\_\_\_\_ him in the afternoon.

7. Ben usually writes ten emails in the morning.

He \_\_\_\_\_ ten emails yesterday.

He \_\_\_\_\_ five letters.

8. Ben usually eats lunch in the office.

He \_\_\_\_\_ lunch in the office today.

He \_\_\_\_\_ lunch in a restaurant.

9. Ben usually has a lot of appointments every day.

He \_\_\_\_\_ a lot of appointments yesterday.

He only \_\_\_\_\_ a few.

10. Ben usually gets home at 6:00.

He \_\_\_\_\_ home at 6:00 yesterday.

He \_\_\_\_\_ home at 7:00.

## Exercise 13

### WRITE THE QUESTIONS

Use the correct question word (*who, what, where, when, why, how many*) to make Wh- questions in the simple past tense. The **bold** words are the answers to the questions.

Ex. *Where did she buy that toy?*

She bought that toy **at Walmart**.

1. \_\_\_\_\_

They left the office **at 6:00**.

2. \_\_\_\_\_

She didn't go to work **because she was sick**.

3. \_\_\_\_\_

I spent **\$80.00** on groceries.

4. \_\_\_\_\_

Rosa spoke **to the boss**.\*

5. \_\_\_\_\_

**Rosa** spoke to the boss.\*

6. \_\_\_\_\_

She said **"hello"** to me.

7. \_\_\_\_\_

I felt **sick** yesterday.

8. \_\_\_\_\_

The sun rose **at 6:45 am** yesterday.

9. \_\_\_\_\_

She wore **a beautiful dress** to the party.

10. \_\_\_\_\_

The meeting took place in **Room 29**.

#### \*Note:

There is a difference between questions 4 and 5.  
Can you explain the grammar rule?

## Exercise 14

### FIND SOMEONE WHO

Walk around the classroom and ask your classmates questions. Write the questions in the spaces provided below, and write your classmate's name on the right if he/she answers "yes."

| #  | Find someone...                                    | Question                                  | Classmate |
|----|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 1  | who woke up late this morning.                     | <i>Did you wake up late this morning?</i> |           |
| 2  | who didn't take the bus to school this morning.    |                                           |           |
| 3  | who ate an egg for breakfast this morning.         |                                           |           |
| 4  | who saw a good movie on TV last night.             |                                           |           |
| 5  | who bought something expensive yesterday.          |                                           |           |
| 6  | who had a bad cold last week.                      |                                           |           |
| 7  | who won something last year.                       |                                           |           |
| 8  | who read a great book last month.                  |                                           |           |
| 9  | who heard some interesting gossip last week.       |                                           |           |
| 10 | who went on vacation to another country last year. |                                           |           |

## Exercise 15

## WRITING

Choose one of the topics below. Write a paragraph using regular and irregular past tense verbs.

### Topics:

- what you did yesterday
- what you did last weekend
- what you did during your last vacation

### Example:

I went on vacation to Amsterdam last year. It was spring. There were many tulips. I went to a lot of museums and saw a lot of beautiful art...

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

## Exercise 16

### QUIZ

Circle the correct answer.

1. Two weeks ago, I \_\_\_\_\_ a new car.  
a) bought  
b) buyed
2. Juan \_\_\_\_\_ at the store on his way home.  
a) stoped  
b) stopped
3. I was very tired \_\_\_\_\_ week.  
a) ago  
b) last
4. It \_\_\_\_\_ us two days to write the report.  
a) taked  
b) took
5. How \_\_\_\_\_ the weather last weekend?  
a) was  
b) were
6. Alyssa \_\_\_\_\_ to go to Spain.  
a) decideed  
b) decided
7. They left the city a month \_\_\_\_\_.  
a) ago  
b) last
8. She \_\_\_\_\_ a cold last week.  
a) cought  
b) caught
9. \_\_\_\_\_ your homework?  
a) Did you finish  
b) Did you finished
10. Maya and Louise \_\_\_\_\_ late for class.  
a) was  
b) were
11. They \_\_\_\_\_ to sell their house.  
a) tryed  
b) tried
12. Chang \_\_\_\_\_ to the party last night.  
a) didn't go  
b) didn't went

## Irregular Verb List

| Base Form | Past Form |
|-----------|-----------|
| be        | was, were |
| become    | became    |
| begin     | began     |
| break     | broke     |
| bring     | brought   |
| buy       | bought    |
| catch     | caught    |
| choose    | chose     |
| come      | came      |
| cost      | cost      |
| cut       | cut       |
| do        | did       |
| draw      | drew      |
| drink     | drank     |
| drive     | drove     |
| eat       | ate       |
| fall      | fell      |
| feel      | felt      |
| find      | found     |
| forget    | forgot    |
| freeze    | froze     |

| Base Form | Past Form |
|-----------|-----------|
| get       | got       |
| give      | gave      |
| go        | went      |
| grow      | grew      |
| have      | had       |
| hear      | heard     |
| hide      | hid       |
| hit       | hit       |
| hold      | held      |
| keep      | kept      |
| know      | knew      |
| lay       | laid      |
| lead      | led       |
| leave     | left      |
| let       | let       |
| lie       | lay       |
| lose      | lost      |
| make      | made      |
| meet      | met       |
| pay       | paid      |
| put       | put       |

| Base Form  | Past Form  |
|------------|------------|
| read       | read       |
| ring       | rang       |
| run        | ran        |
| say        | said       |
| see        | saw        |
| sell       | sold       |
| send       | sent       |
| shut       | shut       |
| sing       | sang       |
| sleep      | slept      |
| speak      | spoke      |
| spend      | spent      |
| stand      | stood      |
| take       | took       |
| teach      | taught     |
| tell       | told       |
| throw      | threw      |
| understand | understood |
| wake       | woke       |
| wear       | wore       |
| write      | wrote      |

## Answer Key

### LESSON DESCRIPTION:

This lesson covers the past tense of the *Be* verb, regular verbs, and irregular verbs. Through various individual and group activities, students will get plenty of written and oral practice with the affirmative, negative, and question forms of simple past verbs.

**LEVEL:** Beg – Low Int

**TIME:** 3–4 hours

**TAGS:** simple past, past, past tense, verbs, verb tenses, regular verbs, irregular verbs, Be, spelling, pronunciation, grammar

---

### Exercise 1

- |         |          |
|---------|----------|
| 1. were | 6. was   |
| 2. was  | 7. was   |
| 3. was  | 8. were  |
| 4. were | 9. were  |
| 5. were | 10. were |

### Exercise 2

1. ...it wasn't cold yesterday.
2. ...she wasn't sick yesterday.
3. ...they weren't at school yesterday.
4. ...it wasn't good yesterday.
5. ...they weren't sweet yesterday.
6. ...it wasn't interesting yesterday.
7. ...he wasn't angry yesterday.
8. ...it wasn't locked yesterday.
9. ...they weren't easy yesterday.
10. ...they weren't tired yesterday.

### Exercise 3

Partners' answers will vary. Make sure students write down their partner's answers and not their own. You can have them copy exactly what their partners say (*Yes, I was/No, I wasn't*) or have them report their partner's answers (*Yes, he/she was/No, he/she wasn't*).

1. Were you at school yesterday?
2. Were you at the movies last weekend?
3. Were you at the gym last week?
4. Were you at the mall last month?
5. Were you in another country last year?
6. Were you tired last night?
7. Were you angry last week?
8. Were you sick last month?
9. Were you excited about your last birthday?
10. Were you happy during your last vacation?

*(continued on the next page...)*

# Answer Key cont.

## Exercise 4

- |            |              |             |
|------------|--------------|-------------|
| 1. brushed | 8. hoped     | 15. played  |
| 2. carried | 9. hugged    | 16. studied |
| 3. checked | 10. laughed  | 17. talked  |
| 4. cleaned | 11. learned  | 18. walked  |
| 5. cried   | 12. liked    | 19. washed  |
| 6. danced  | 13. listened |             |
| 7. decided | 14. planned  |             |

Review the spelling rules on page 4 before starting this exercise.  
For further spelling practice when forming regular past verbs, try the worksheet in our Grammar & Usage Resource: <https://esllibrary.com/resources/2732>

For pronunciation practice, have students read the past forms out loud. Before that, you may want to hand out our pronunciation rules guide and exercise (with audio) in our Grammar & Usage Resources: <https://esllibrary.com/resources/2733>

## Exercise 5

- |            |              |
|------------|--------------|
| 1. played  | 6. waited    |
| 2. helped  | 7. learned   |
| 3. painted | 8. traveled  |
| 4. watched | 9. arrived   |
| 5. changed | 10. listened |

## Exercise 6

### A. WRITE THE ANSWERS

- Yes, they did.
- No, she didn't.
- No, I didn't.
- Yes, they did.
- Yes, he did.

### B. INTERVIEW YOUR PARTNER?

Questions and answers will vary.

## Exercise 7

- |            |          |             |
|------------|----------|-------------|
| 1. began   | 8. had   | 15. slept   |
| 2. brought | 9. knew  | 16. took    |
| 3. caught  | 10. made | 17. taught  |
| 4. chose   | 11. read | 18. thought |
| 5. did     | 12. ran  | 19. wrote   |
| 6. fell    | 13. saw  |             |
| 7. went    | 14. sang |             |

## Exercise 8

- |                    |                   |
|--------------------|-------------------|
| 1. flew            | 7. lost, felt/got |
| 2. set, woke, rang | 8. caught, lay    |
| 3. sent            | 9. swam           |
| 4. wrote           | 10. had           |
| 5. took, got/felt  | 11. bought, paid  |
| 6. taught, gave    | 12. met, drank    |

## Exercise 9

Make sure your students mix up the order of the verbs they copy down so that they all have a different card. Tell them you will call out the base/present verb and that they should draw an ✕ over the corresponding past form if they have it on their card. The first student to complete a line (horizontally, vertically, or diagonally) should shout "Bingo!" To make the game last longer, tell students they can only yell "Bingo!" when they have two completed lines instead of one.

*(continued on the next page...)*

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 10

Answers may vary. If this task is too difficult for your students, you could write the base forms of the following suggested answers on the board (in a random order).

- |           |                  |
|-----------|------------------|
| 1. forgot | 6. closed/shut   |
| 2. sold   | 7. set/went down |
| 3. lost   | 8. taught/forgot |
| 4. stood  | 9. sank          |
| 5. left   | 10. spent        |

### Exercise 11

- |              |              |
|--------------|--------------|
| 1. ago       | 6. last      |
| 2. last      | 7. yesterday |
| 3. yesterday | 8. ago       |
| 4. last      | 9. yesterday |
| 5. yesterday | 10. ago      |

### Exercise 12

- |                           |                         |
|---------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. didn't get up / got up | 6. didn't meet / met    |
| 2. didn't take / took     | 7. didn't write / wrote |
| 3. didn't read / read     | 8. didn't eat / ate     |
| 4. didn't leave / left    | 9. didn't have / had    |
| 5. didn't take / took     | 10. didn't get / got    |

### Exercise 13

- When did they leave the office?
- Why didn't she go to work?
- How much did you spend on groceries?
- Who did Rosa speak to?
- Who spoke to the boss?
- What did she say to you?
- How did you feel yesterday?
- When/What time did the sun rise yesterday?
- What did she wear to the party?
- Where did the meeting take place?

Note Answer: Question 4 is asking about the indirect object (who someone spoke to) and question 5 is asking about the subject (who spoke to someone).

### Exercise 14

Classmates' answers will vary.

- Did you wake up late this morning?
- Did you take the bus to school this morning?
- Did you eat an egg for breakfast this morning?
- Did you see a good movie on TV last night?
- Did you buy something expensive yesterday?
- Did you have a bad cold last week?
- Did you win something/anything last year?
- Did you read a great book last month?
- Did you hear some/any interesting gossip last week?
- Did you go on vacation to another country last year?

*(continued on the next page...)*

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 15

Answers will vary. Encourage your students to use both positive and negative, regular and irregular past verbs.

### Exercise 16

- |      |      |      |      |       |       |
|------|------|------|------|-------|-------|
| 1. a | 3. b | 5. a | 7. a | 9. a  | 11. b |
| 2. b | 4. b | 6. b | 8. b | 10. b | 12. a |

#### SPELLING NOTES:

1. This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Color, Neighbors, Canceled, and Traveled*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Colour, Neighbours, Cancelled, and Travelled*. Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.
2. Note that in the American spelling of words ending with the CVC pattern of **consonant + e + l**, the final l will usually not double in the most commonly accepted form (e.g., *travel* → *traveled*, *cancel* → *canceled*). Most other English-speaking countries prefer to double the final l (e.g., *travel* → *travelled*, *cancel* → *cancelled*).

#### EDITOR'S NOTES:

1. In our Verb Cards: Present, Past & Past Participle resource (available in our Grammar & Usage Resources section) you'll find cards on pages 1–4 that you can use in a variety of ways. Page 7 contains a blank card template so that you or your students can make your own. <https://esllibrary.com/resources/2247>

You could use these verb cards with some of the activities suggested in our 5 Fun Activities for Irregular Verbs blog post: <http://blog.esllibrary.com/2015/02/26/5-fun-activities-for-irregular-verbs/>

2. See our spelling rules and pronunciation guide for regular past verbs in our Grammar & Usage Resources section:
  - Spelling Rules: <https://esllibrary.com/resources/2732>
  - Pronunciation Rules: <https://esllibrary.com/resources/2733>

# Simple Present Vs. Present Progressive

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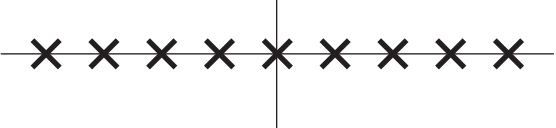
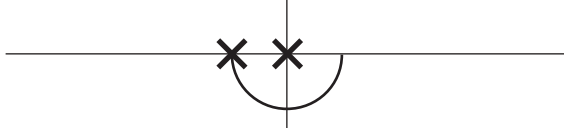
## Grammar Notes

### SIMPLE PRESENT VS. PRESENT PROGRESSIVE

#### A. Comparison Chart

There are two ways to show present time in English.

Use the **simple present** for repeated actions (actions that happen over and over). Use the **present progressive** (also called *present continuous*) for continuing actions (actions that are happening now).

|                     | Simple Present                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Present Progressive                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pattern</b>      | base verb (+ -s)<br>(ends in -s for <i>he, she, it</i> , singular count nouns, and non-count nouns)                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Be + -ing verb<br>(forms of Be: <i>am, are, is</i> )                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Use</b>          | repeated action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | continuing action                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Diagram</b>      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Time Markers</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• every<br/>(every day, every week, every month, every year, etc.)</li> <li>• once, twice, three times, etc.<br/>(once a week, twice a month, five times a year, etc.)</li> <li>• adverbs of frequency<br/>(always, almost always, often, usually, sometimes, never, etc.)</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• now</li> <li>• right now</li> <li>• these days</li> <li>• nowadays</li> <li>• today</li> <li>• at the moment</li> <li>• at this time</li> <li>• currently</li> <li>• presently</li> </ul>              |
| <b>Examples</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• My son always <b>brushes</b> his teeth.</li> <li>• They <b>walk</b> their dog every day.</li> <li>• I <b>don't call</b> my parents very often.</li> <li>• <b>Do</b> you usually <b>study</b> after school?</li> </ul>                                                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• The students <b>are reading</b> now.</li> <li>• At the moment, the boss <b>is talking</b>.</li> <li>• He <b>isn't doing</b> his homework.</li> <li>• <b>Are</b> you <b>listening</b> to me?</li> </ul> |

## Grammar Notes cont.

### B. Non-Action Verbs

Most English verbs involve an action (movement), but there are some verbs that have **no movement**. They are called **non-action** (or *stative*) verbs. Non-action verbs almost never take an *-ing* form.

Common non-action verbs can be grouped into five categories.

| Categories                  | Examples                                         |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>state</b>                | be, seem, appear, exist                          |
| <b>possession</b>           | have, own, possess                               |
| <b>feelings &amp; needs</b> | like, love, hate, feel, want, need, prefer, wish |
| <b>thought</b>              | think, believe, know, imagine, understand        |
| <b>the senses</b>           | see, hear, taste, smell                          |

Use the simple present with non-action verbs.  
Do not use the present progressive.

- |                                         |                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| ✓ I <b>am</b> a student.                | ✓ My sister <b>wants</b> a new car.                    |
| ✗ I <b>am being</b> a student.          | ✗ My sister <b>is wanting</b> a new car.               |
| ✓ He <b>has</b> a dog.                  | ✓ I <b>think</b> that winter is the best season.       |
| ✗ He <b>is having</b> a dog.            | ✗ I <b>am thinking</b> that winter is the best season. |
| ✓ The children <b>like</b> pizza.       | ✓ I <b>see</b> a stain on my shirt.                    |
| ✗ The children <b>are liking</b> pizza. | ✗ I <b>am seeing</b> a stain on my shirt.              |

## Grammar Notes cont.

### C. Notes

#### Note #1

The simple present is also used for true facts and schedules.

- The earth's temperature **increases** every year. (*true fact*)
- Most plants **grow** in the spring and summer. (*true fact*)
- The bus **leaves** at 5:00 am tomorrow morning. (*schedule*)
- My favorite TV show **starts** at 8:00 pm. (*schedule*)

#### Note #2

The present progressive can have a future meaning.

It is commonly used for the *near future* (actions that will happen soon).

- I **am going** to Australia next weekend.
- My friend **is moving** on Friday.
- The students **are graduating** in three days.
- We **are seeing** a movie tonight.\*

\*For movies and plays at a theater, it is common to use the non-action verb *see* instead of the action verb *watch* for future time.

#### Note #3

Some non-action verbs can take an *-ing* form, but the meaning of the verb usually changes.

- I **am having** pizza for dinner. (*having* = *eating*)
- We **are having** fun. (*having* = *experiencing*)
- My sister **is having** a baby. (*having* = *giving birth to*)
- **Are you seeing** anyone? (*seeing* = *dating*)
- I **am thinking** of buying a new car. (*thinking* = *deciding, planning*)

## Exercise 1

### COMPARING TENSES

Complete the following sentences using the simple present or the present progressive tense.

Ex. My team usually practices in the gym, but now we are practicing outside.  
(practice) (practice)

1. They usually \_\_\_\_\_ the local newspaper,  
(read)  
but they \_\_\_\_\_ a national newspaper at the moment.  
(read)
2. I \_\_\_\_\_ eggs for breakfast today, though I usually \_\_\_\_\_ cereal.  
(eat) (eat)
3. David always \_\_\_\_\_ to work, and he \_\_\_\_\_ in the rain at this time.  
(walk) (walk)
4. I \_\_\_\_\_ a shower now, though I normally \_\_\_\_\_ a bath.  
(take) (take)
5. Isabella \_\_\_\_\_ English every day. She \_\_\_\_\_ past tense verbs right now.  
(study) (study)
6. Sayid never \_\_\_\_\_ a tie to work,  
(wear)  
but he \_\_\_\_\_ one today because he has an important appointment.  
(wear)
7. Jin sometimes \_\_\_\_\_ work late,  
(leave)  
but he \_\_\_\_\_ early today because it is his wife's birthday.  
(leave)
8. We always \_\_\_\_\_ at A&B Market,  
(shop)  
and right now we \_\_\_\_\_ for food for a party.  
(shop)
9. Lee \_\_\_\_\_ a cake for his wife's birthday,  
(make)  
but he almost never \_\_\_\_\_ cakes.  
(make)
10. Fred and Rita never \_\_\_\_\_ wine, so they \_\_\_\_\_ water right now.  
(drink) (drink)

## Exercise 2

### TIME MARKERS

Complete the following sentences using the simple present or the present progressive tense.

Ex. He goes to the gym three times a week.  
(go)

1. Jack never \_\_\_\_\_ to class on time.  
(get)
2. The sun always \_\_\_\_\_ in the east and \_\_\_\_\_ in the west.  
(rise) (set)
3. Maya \_\_\_\_\_ TV now. She often \_\_\_\_\_ TV in the evenings.  
(watch) (watch)
4. Mr. Duncan \_\_\_\_\_ to New York on business very often.  
(travel, not)
5. My aunt usually \_\_\_\_\_ in a hotel when  
(stay)  
she comes to town, but tonight she \_\_\_\_\_ with us.  
(stay)
6. At this time, they \_\_\_\_\_ in Europe.  
(travel)
7. We \_\_\_\_\_ for coffee on Saturdays. We \_\_\_\_\_ on Sundays.  
(meet, not) (meet)
8. She sometimes \_\_\_\_\_ jeans to school, but today she \_\_\_\_\_ a skirt.  
(wear) (wear)
9. Right now, we \_\_\_\_\_ verb tenses.  
(review)
10. My husband \_\_\_\_\_ dinner at the moment. He \_\_\_\_\_ the dishes.  
(make, not) (wash)

## Exercise 3

### ACTION & NON-ACTION VERBS

Complete the following sentences using the simple present or the present progressive tense. Remember that non-action verbs don't usually take the progressive form.

Ex. Mi Jin is reading a new book now. She wants to finish the book tonight.  
(read) (want)

1. Billy                                  a bad cold today. He                                  in bed at the moment.  
(have) (lie)

2. Sara is at the park now. She                                  her dog.  
(walk)

She                                  her dog so much.  
(love)

3. I                                  to the store to buy a new computer.  
(go)

The computer                                  \$1500.  
(cost)

4. Yuka                                  her old, green dress, but she                                   
(hate) (wear)

it today because her mother                                  it.  
(like)

5. Lucas                                  a new car. He                                  to drive it around.  
(have) (love)

6. Juan and Mohammed                                  in the park right now.  
(jog)

A cat                                  them. I                                   
(follow) (think)

the cat                                  to Juan.  
(belong)



## Exercise 3 cont.

7. What's that noise? I \_\_\_\_\_ something outside the window.  
(hear)

I \_\_\_\_\_ scared!  
(be)

8. My brother and I \_\_\_\_\_ at home. We \_\_\_\_\_ a movie on TV.  
(be) (watch)

9. Marco usually \_\_\_\_\_ to work, but today  
(drive)

he \_\_\_\_\_ a bus because his car \_\_\_\_\_ a flat tire.  
(take) (have)

10. Slow down! You \_\_\_\_\_ too fast right now,  
(drive)

and I \_\_\_\_\_ a police car up ahead.  
(see)

## Exercise 4

## WRITING

Write about your school or work. Write 10 sentences using the simple present and present progressive tenses. Try to include some non-action verbs.

### Example:

I go to school three days a week. I take English classes. Right now, we are learning about adjectives. I don't like grammar very much, but I'm trying my best...

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

### Exercise 5

#### FIND SOMEONE WHO

Write questions in the simple present or present progressive tense.  
Then walk around the classroom and ask your classmates questions.  
Write your classmate's name on the right if he/she answers "yes."

| #  | Find someone...                             | Question                                  | Classmate |
|----|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 1  | who usually walks to class                  | <i>Do you usually walk to class?</i>      |           |
| 2  | who is wearing black socks today            | <i>Are you wearing black socks today?</i> |           |
| 3  | who has two siblings                        |                                           |           |
| 4  | who likes coffee                            |                                           |           |
| 5  | who is learning a third language these days |                                           |           |
| 6  | who lives in an apartment                   |                                           |           |
| 7  | who plays the guitar                        |                                           |           |
| 8  | who always eats breakfast                   |                                           |           |
| 9  | who is wearing contact lenses right now     |                                           |           |
| 10 | who loves his/her pet                       |                                           |           |

## Exercise 6

### QUIZ

Circle the correct answer.

1. Listen!  
Someone \_\_\_\_\_ at the door.  
a) knock  
b) knocks  
c) is knocking  
d) are knocking
2. It always \_\_\_\_\_  
in our city in April.  
a) rain  
b) rains  
c) is raining  
d) are raining
3. They \_\_\_\_\_ each other now.  
a) don't text  
b) doesn't text  
c) isn't texting  
d) aren't texting
4. The telephone \_\_\_\_\_.  
Can you please answer it?  
a) ring  
b) rings  
c) is ringing  
d) are ringing
5. My baby \_\_\_\_\_ from 2:00  
to 4:00 every afternoon.  
a) sleep  
b) sleeps  
c) is sleeping  
d) are sleeping
6. Mr. Jones \_\_\_\_\_ in his office at  
the moment.  
a) are  
b) isn't  
c) is being  
d) isn't being
7. \_\_\_\_\_ he \_\_\_\_\_  
his presentation now?  
a) Do, practice  
b) Does, practice  
c) Is, practicing  
d) Are, practicing
8. My neighbor \_\_\_\_\_  
the garden twice a day.  
a) water  
b) waters  
c) is watering  
d) are watering
9. The child \_\_\_\_\_  
ice cream right now.  
a) want  
b) wants  
c) is wanting  
d) are wanting
10. \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ your  
homework every day?  
a) Do, do  
b) Does, do  
c) Is, doing  
d) Are, doing
11. I can't talk right now.  
I \_\_\_\_\_ dinner.  
a) have  
b) has  
c) am having  
d) is having
12. It's a beautiful day today.  
The sun \_\_\_\_\_.  
a) shine  
b) shines  
c) is shining  
d) are shining

## Answer Key

**LESSON DESCRIPTION:**

In this lesson, students compare the different uses of the simple present and present progressive tenses. Various exercises that mix the tenses and include non-action verbs will demonstrate if they truly understand when to use each tense.

**LEVEL:** Beg – Low Int**TIME:** 2 hours**TAGS:** simple present, present progressive, present continuous, verbs, tense, verb tenses, mixed tenses, time markers, sentence patterns, non-action, stative, grammar

### Exercise 1

- |                         |                         |
|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. read, are reading    | 6. wears, is wearing    |
| 2. am eating, eat       | 7. leaves, is leaving   |
| 3. walks, is walking    | 8. shop, are shopping   |
| 4. am taking, take      | 9. is making, makes     |
| 5. studies, is studying | 10. drink, are drinking |

### Exercise 2

- |                         |                              |
|-------------------------|------------------------------|
| 1. gets                 | 6. are traveling             |
| 2. rises, sets          | 7. don't meet, meet          |
| 3. is watching, watches | 8. wears, is wearing         |
| 4. doesn't travel       | 9. are reviewing             |
| 5. stays, is staying    | 10. isn't making, is washing |

### Exercise 3

1. has, is lying
2. is walking, loves
3. am going, costs
4. hates, is wearing, likes
5. has, loves
6. are jogging, is following, think, belongs
7. hear, am
8. are, are watching
9. drives, is taking, has
10. are driving, see

### Exercise 4

Answers will vary.

*(continued on the next page...)*

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 5

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 6

- |      |      |      |      |       |       |
|------|------|------|------|-------|-------|
| 1. c | 3. d | 5. b | 7. c | 9. b  | 11. c |
| 2. b | 4. c | 6. b | 8. b | 10. a | 12. c |

#### SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Traveling*, *Neighbor*, *Favorite*, *Theater*, and *Practice*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Travelling*, *Neighbour*, *Favourite*, *Theatre*, and *Practise* (when used as a verb; *Practice* when used as a noun). Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

#### EDITOR'S NOTES:

This lesson should follow our Grammar Practice Worksheets lessons on the simple present and present progressive. For more grammar explanations and practice with these tenses, see:

- Simple Present – Be  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/1591>
- Simple Present  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/2403>
- Present Progressive  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/2464>

Also, for more examples of non-action verbs, see our Grammar & Usage Resource:

- Non-Action Verbs & Exceptions  
<https://esllibrary.com/resources/2329>

# Simple Present Vs. Present Progressive

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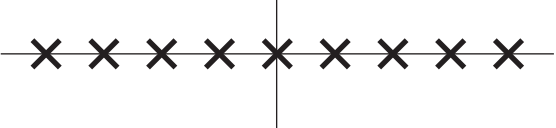
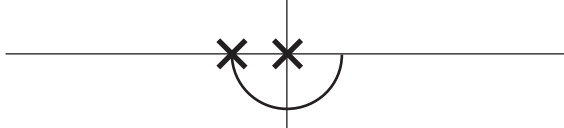
## Grammar Notes

### SIMPLE PRESENT VS. PRESENT PROGRESSIVE

#### A. Comparison Chart

There are two ways to show present time in English.

Use the **simple present** for repeated actions (actions that happen over and over). Use the **present progressive** (also called *present continuous*) for continuing actions (actions that are happening now).

|                     | Simple Present                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Present Progressive                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Pattern</b>      | base verb (+ -s)<br>(ends in -s for <i>he, she, it</i> , singular count nouns, and non-count nouns)                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Be + <i>-ing</i> verb<br>(forms of <i>Be</i> : <i>am, are, is</i> )                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Use</b>          | repeated action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | continuing action                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Diagram</b>      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Time Markers</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• every<br/>(every day, every week, every month, every year, etc.)</li> <li>• once, twice, three times, etc.<br/>(once a week, twice a month, five times a year, etc.)</li> <li>• adverbs of frequency<br/>(always, almost always, often, usually, sometimes, never, etc.)</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• now</li> <li>• right now</li> <li>• these days</li> <li>• nowadays</li> <li>• today</li> <li>• at the moment</li> <li>• at this time</li> <li>• currently</li> <li>• presently</li> </ul>              |
| <b>Examples</b>     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• My son always <b>brushes</b> his teeth.</li> <li>• They <b>walk</b> their dog every day.</li> <li>• I <b>don't call</b> my parents very often.</li> <li>• <b>Do</b> you usually <b>study</b> after school?</li> </ul>                                                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• The students <b>are reading</b> now.</li> <li>• At the moment, the boss <b>is talking</b>.</li> <li>• He <b>isn't doing</b> his homework.</li> <li>• <b>Are</b> you <b>listening</b> to me?</li> </ul> |

## Grammar Notes cont.

### B. Non-Action Verbs

Most English verbs involve an action (movement), but there are some verbs that have **no movement**. They are called **non-action** (or *stative*) verbs. Non-action verbs almost never take an *-ing* form.

Common non-action verbs can be grouped into five categories.

| Categories                  | Examples                                         |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
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| <b>possession</b>           | have, own, possess                               |
| <b>feelings &amp; needs</b> | like, love, hate, feel, want, need, prefer, wish |
| <b>thought</b>              | think, believe, know, imagine, understand        |
| <b>the senses</b>           | see, hear, taste, smell                          |

Use the simple present with non-action verbs.

Do not use the present progressive.

- |                                         |                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| ✓ I <b>am</b> a student.                | ✓ My sister <b>wants</b> a new car.                    |
| ✗ I <b>am being</b> a student.          | ✗ My sister <b>is wanting</b> a new car.               |
| ✓ He <b>has</b> a dog.                  | ✓ I <b>think</b> that winter is the best season.       |
| ✗ He <b>is having</b> a dog.            | ✗ I <b>am thinking</b> that winter is the best season. |
| ✓ The children <b>like</b> pizza.       | ✓ I <b>see</b> a stain on my shirt.                    |
| ✗ The children <b>are liking</b> pizza. | ✗ I <b>am seeing</b> a stain on my shirt.              |

## Grammar Notes cont.

### C. Notes

#### Note #1

The simple present is also used for true facts and schedules.

- The earth's temperature **increases** every year. (*true fact*)
- Most plants **grow** in the spring and summer. (*true fact*)
- The bus **leaves** at 5:00 am tomorrow morning. (*schedule*)
- My favorite TV show **starts** at 8:00 pm. (*schedule*)

#### Note #2

The present progressive can have a future meaning.

It is commonly used for the *near future* (actions that will happen soon).

- I **am going** to Australia next weekend.
- My friend **is moving** on Friday.
- The students **are graduating** in three days.
- We **are seeing** a movie tonight.\*

\*For movies and plays at a theater, it is common to use the non-action verb *see* instead of the action verb *watch* for future time.

#### Note #3

Some non-action verbs can take an *-ing* form, but the meaning of the verb usually changes.

- I **am having** pizza for dinner. (*having* = *eating*)
- We **are having** fun. (*having* = *experiencing*)
- My sister **is having** a baby. (*having* = *giving birth to*)
- **Are you seeing** anyone? (*seeing* = *dating*)
- I **am thinking** of buying a new car. (*thinking* = *deciding, planning*)

## Exercise 1

### COMPARING TENSES

Complete the following sentences using the simple present or the present progressive tense.

Ex. My team usually practices in the gym, but now we are practicing outside.  
(practice) (practice)

1. They usually \_\_\_\_\_ the local newspaper,  
(read)  
but they \_\_\_\_\_ a national newspaper at the moment.  
(read)
2. I \_\_\_\_\_ eggs for breakfast today, though I usually \_\_\_\_\_ cereal.  
(eat) (eat)
3. David always \_\_\_\_\_ to work, and he \_\_\_\_\_ in the rain at this time.  
(walk) (walk)
4. I \_\_\_\_\_ a shower now, though I normally \_\_\_\_\_ a bath.  
(take) (take)
5. Isabella \_\_\_\_\_ English every day. She \_\_\_\_\_ past tense verbs right now.  
(study) (study)
6. Sayid never \_\_\_\_\_ a tie to work,  
(wear)  
but he \_\_\_\_\_ one today because he has an important appointment.  
(wear)
7. Jin sometimes \_\_\_\_\_ work late,  
(leave)  
but he \_\_\_\_\_ early today because it is his wife's birthday.  
(leave)
8. We always \_\_\_\_\_ at A&B Market,  
(shop)  
and right now we \_\_\_\_\_ for food for a party.  
(shop)
9. Lee \_\_\_\_\_ a cake for his wife's birthday,  
(make)  
but he almost never \_\_\_\_\_ cakes.  
(make)
10. Fred and Rita never \_\_\_\_\_ wine, so they \_\_\_\_\_ water right now.  
(drink) (drink)

## Exercise 2

### TIME MARKERS

Complete the following sentences using the simple present or the present progressive tense.

Ex. He goes to the gym three times a week.  
(go)

1. Jack never \_\_\_\_\_ to class on time.  
(get)
2. The sun always \_\_\_\_\_ in the east and \_\_\_\_\_ in the west.  
(rise) (set)
3. Maya \_\_\_\_\_ TV now. She often \_\_\_\_\_ TV in the evenings.  
(watch) (watch)
4. Mr. Duncan \_\_\_\_\_ to New York on business very often.  
(travel, not)
5. My aunt usually \_\_\_\_\_ in a hotel when  
(stay)  
she comes to town, but tonight she \_\_\_\_\_ with us.  
(stay)
6. At this time, they \_\_\_\_\_ in Europe.  
(travel)
7. We \_\_\_\_\_ for coffee on Saturdays. We \_\_\_\_\_ on Sundays.  
(meet, not) (meet)
8. She sometimes \_\_\_\_\_ jeans to school, but today she \_\_\_\_\_ a skirt.  
(wear) (wear)
9. Right now, we \_\_\_\_\_ verb tenses.  
(review)
10. My husband \_\_\_\_\_ dinner at the moment. He \_\_\_\_\_ the dishes.  
(make, not) (wash)

## Exercise 3

### ACTION & NON-ACTION VERBS

Complete the following sentences using the simple present or the present progressive tense. Remember that non-action verbs don't usually take the progressive form.

Ex. Mi Jin is reading a new book now. She wants to finish the book tonight.  
(read) (want)

1. Billy                                  a bad cold today. He                                  in bed at the moment.  
(have) (lie)

2. Sara is at the park now. She                                  her dog.  
(walk)

She                                  her dog so much.  
(love)

3. I                                  to the store to buy a new computer.  
(go)

The computer                                  \$1500.  
(cost)

4. Yuka                                  her old, green dress, but she                                   
(hate) (wear)

it today because her mother                                  it.  
(like)

5. Lucas                                  a new car. He                                  to drive it around.  
(have) (love)

6. Juan and Mohammed                                  in the park right now.  
(jog)

A cat                                  them. I                                   
(follow) (think)

the cat                                  to Juan.  
(belong)



**Exercise 3 cont.**

7. What's that noise? I \_\_\_\_\_ something outside the window.  
(hear)

I \_\_\_\_\_ scared!  
(be)

8. My brother and I \_\_\_\_\_ at home. We \_\_\_\_\_ a movie on TV.  
(be) (watch)

9. Marco usually \_\_\_\_\_ to work, but today  
(drive)

he \_\_\_\_\_ a bus because his car \_\_\_\_\_ a flat tire.  
(take) (have)

10. Slow down! You \_\_\_\_\_ too fast right now,  
(drive)

and I \_\_\_\_\_ a police car up ahead.  
(see)

## Exercise 4

## WRITING

Write about your school or work. Write 10 sentences using the simple present and present progressive tenses. Try to include some non-action verbs.

### Example:

I go to school three days a week. I take English classes. Right now, we are learning about adjectives. I don't like grammar very much, but I'm trying my best...

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

## Exercise 5

### FIND SOMEONE WHO

Write questions in the simple present or present progressive tense.  
Then walk around the classroom and ask your classmates questions.  
Write your classmate's name on the right if he/she answers "yes."

| #  | Find someone...                             | Question                                  | Classmate |
|----|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 1  | who usually walks to class                  | <i>Do you usually walk to class?</i>      |           |
| 2  | who is wearing black socks today            | <i>Are you wearing black socks today?</i> |           |
| 3  | who has two siblings                        |                                           |           |
| 4  | who likes coffee                            |                                           |           |
| 5  | who is learning a third language these days |                                           |           |
| 6  | who lives in an apartment                   |                                           |           |
| 7  | who plays the guitar                        |                                           |           |
| 8  | who always eats breakfast                   |                                           |           |
| 9  | who is wearing contact lenses right now     |                                           |           |
| 10 | who loves his/her pet                       |                                           |           |

## Exercise 6

### QUIZ

Circle the correct answer.

1. Listen!  
Someone \_\_\_\_\_ at the door.  
a) knock  
b) knocks  
c) is knocking  
d) are knocking
2. It always \_\_\_\_\_  
in our city in April.  
a) rain  
b) rains  
c) is raining  
d) are raining
3. They \_\_\_\_\_ each other now.  
a) don't text  
b) doesn't text  
c) isn't texting  
d) aren't texting
4. The telephone \_\_\_\_\_.  
Can you please answer it?  
a) ring  
b) rings  
c) is ringing  
d) are ringing
5. My baby \_\_\_\_\_ from 2:00  
to 4:00 every afternoon.  
a) sleep  
b) sleeps  
c) is sleeping  
d) are sleeping
6. Mr. Jones \_\_\_\_\_ in his office at  
the moment.  
a) are  
b) isn't  
c) is being  
d) isn't being
7. \_\_\_\_\_ he \_\_\_\_\_  
his presentation now?  
a) Do, practice  
b) Does, practice  
c) Is, practicing  
d) Are, practicing
8. My neighbor \_\_\_\_\_  
the garden twice a day.  
a) water  
b) waters  
c) is watering  
d) are watering
9. The child \_\_\_\_\_  
ice cream right now.  
a) want  
b) wants  
c) is wanting  
d) are wanting
10. \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ your  
homework every day?  
a) Do, do  
b) Does, do  
c) Is, doing  
d) Are, doing
11. I can't talk right now.  
I \_\_\_\_\_ dinner.  
a) have  
b) has  
c) am having  
d) is having
12. It's a beautiful day today.  
The sun \_\_\_\_\_.  
a) shine  
b) shines  
c) is shining  
d) are shining

## Answer Key

**LESSON DESCRIPTION:**

In this lesson, students compare the different uses of the simple present and present progressive tenses. Various exercises that mix the tenses and include non-action verbs will demonstrate if they truly understand when to use each tense.

**LEVEL:** Beg – Low Int**TIME:** 2 hours**TAGS:** simple present, present progressive, present continuous, verbs, tense, verb tenses, mixed tenses, time markers, sentence patterns, non-action, stative, grammar

### Exercise 1

- |                         |                         |
|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. read, are reading    | 6. wears, is wearing    |
| 2. am eating, eat       | 7. leaves, is leaving   |
| 3. walks, is walking    | 8. shop, are shopping   |
| 4. am taking, take      | 9. is making, makes     |
| 5. studies, is studying | 10. drink, are drinking |

### Exercise 2

- |                         |                              |
|-------------------------|------------------------------|
| 1. gets                 | 6. are traveling             |
| 2. rises, sets          | 7. don't meet, meet          |
| 3. is watching, watches | 8. wears, is wearing         |
| 4. doesn't travel       | 9. are reviewing             |
| 5. stays, is staying    | 10. isn't making, is washing |

### Exercise 3

1. has, is lying
2. is walking, loves
3. am going, costs
4. hates, is wearing, likes
5. has, loves
6. are jogging, is following, think, belongs
7. hear, am
8. are, are watching
9. drives, is taking, has
10. are driving, see

### Exercise 4

Answers will vary.

*(continued on the next page...)*

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 5

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 6

- |      |      |      |      |       |       |
|------|------|------|------|-------|-------|
| 1. c | 3. d | 5. b | 7. c | 9. b  | 11. c |
| 2. b | 4. c | 6. b | 8. b | 10. a | 12. c |

#### SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Traveling*, *Neighbor*, *Favorite*, *Theater*, and *Practice*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Travelling*, *Neighbour*, *Favourite*, *Theatre*, and *Practise* (when used as a verb; *Practice* when used as a noun). Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

#### EDITOR'S NOTES:

This lesson should follow our Grammar Practice Worksheets lessons on the simple present and present progressive. For more grammar explanations and practice with these tenses, see:

- Simple Present – Be  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/1591>
- Simple Present  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/2403>
- Present Progressive  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/2464>

Also, for more examples of non-action verbs, see our Grammar & Usage Resource:

- Non-Action Verbs & Exceptions  
<https://esllibrary.com/resources/2329>

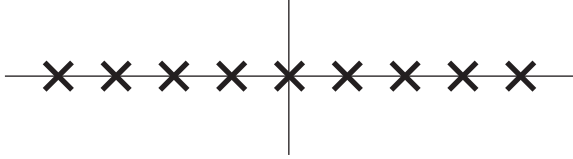
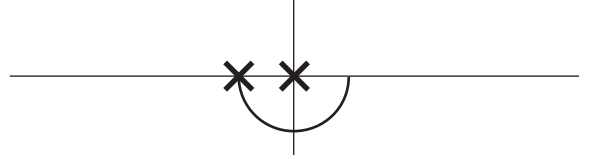
# Verb Tense Review 1 – The Simple Tenses

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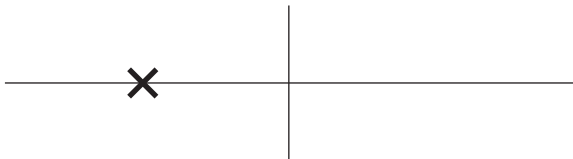
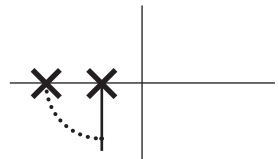
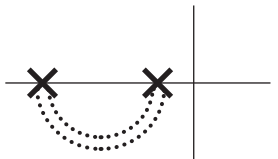
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| <b>8</b> | <b>Exercise 6</b><br>The Simple Present & the Present Progressive | <b>14</b> | <b>Answer Key</b>                                               |

# Grammar Notes

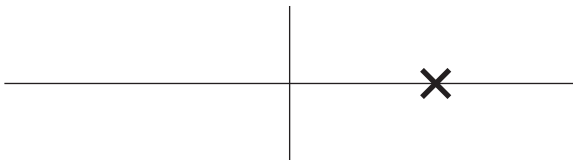
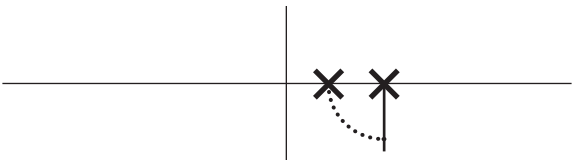
## THE 6 SIMPLE TENSES & THEIR TIME MARKERS

| Tense        | Simple Present                                                                                                                                                          | Present Progressive                                                                                                                                                                               |  |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| Diagram      |                                                                                        |                                                                                                                 |  |
| Form         | Base Verb (+ -s for third person singular)                                                                                                                              | Be + -ing Verb                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |
| Function     | A repeated action                                                                                                                                                       | A continuing present action                                                                                                                                                                       |  |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>adverbs of frequency (always, usually, sometimes, never, etc.)</li> <li>every</li> <li>once, twice, three times, etc.</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>now</li> <li>right now</li> <li>at the moment</li> <li>at this time</li> <li>nowadays</li> <li>these days</li> <li>currently</li> <li>presently</li> </ul> |  |
| Example      | I always eat breakfast.                                                                                                                                                 | I'm doing my homework now.                                                                                                                                                                        |  |

| Tense        | Simple Past                                                                                                                            | Past Progressive                                                                     |                                                                                       |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |                                                     |  |  |
| Form         | <b>REGULAR VERBS:</b> Verb + -ed<br><b>IRREGULAR VERBS:</b> Various changes                                                            | Was / Were + -ing Verb                                                               |                                                                                       |
| Function     | A defined past action (we know when the action occurred)                                                                               | A long past action interrupted by a short past action                                | Two long past actions occurring at the same time                                      |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>yesterday</li> <li>the day before yesterday</li> <li>last</li> <li>ago</li> <li>when</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>when</li> </ul>                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>when</li> <li>while</li> </ul>                 |
| Example      | I went to the gym last week.                                                                                                           | I was studying when the phone rang.                                                  | I was daydreaming while you were talking.                                             |

## Grammar Notes cont.

| Tense        | Simple Future                                                                                                                                                              | Future Progressive                                                                 |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |                                                                                           |  |
| Form         | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Will + Base Verb</li> <li>Be Going To + Base Verb</li> <li>Be + -ing Verb</li> </ol>                                                | Will + Be + -ing Verb                                                              |
| Function     | A future action                                                                                                                                                            | A long future action interrupted by a short future action                          |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>tomorrow</li> <li>the day after tomorrow</li> <li>from now</li> <li>next</li> <li>when</li> </ul>                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>when</li> </ul>                             |
| Example      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I will call you tomorrow night.</li> <li>I am going to call you tomorrow night.</li> <li>I'm calling you tomorrow night.</li> </ul> | I will be sleeping when the girls get home.                                        |

### Note #1

#### INDICATING TIME

There are other ways to indicate time in an English sentence besides using time markers.

#### Context

One way is to notice the **context**. For example, if someone is talking about last weekend, then all of the verbs will probably be in the simple past tense even though "last weekend" may only be mentioned in one sentence.

- I **went** to a great party last weekend.  
We **ate** lots of delicious food and **danced** until dawn.

#### Other Verbs

Another way is to notice the **other verbs** in the sentence. For example, if a verb is in the simple past tense, then the other verb is almost always in the past as well, even if no time markers are used.

- They **asked** for directions, but they still **got** lost.

## Grammar Notes cont.

### Note #2

#### FUTURE VERBS

For the simple future and the future progressive tenses, remember the rule “*No two wills.*” We can never use *will*, *be going to*, *be + -ing verb*, or *will + be + -ing verb* twice in a sentence. The rule is to use the future tense in the independent clause, and the simple present in the dependent clause. Remember that even though the simple present is used, the whole sentence still has a future meaning!

- I **will graduate** when I **finish** my exams.
- When I **finish** my exams, I **will graduate**.

### Note #3

#### NON-ACTION VERBS

Note that the present progressive tense is almost never used with non-action verbs. In English, the simple present is used with non-action verbs even when a present progressive time marker appears in the sentence. Non-action verbs include *be*, *have*, *feelings*, *thinking verbs*, and *the five senses*.

- ✓ She **is** hungry now.
- ✗ She **is being** hungry now.
- ✓ He **likes** horror movies nowadays.
- ✗ He **is liking** horror movies nowadays.

## Exercise 1

### THE SIMPLE PRESENT, PAST & FUTURE

Choose a word from the box, and use it to form the simple present, simple past, or simple future tense.

1. My dog jumped into the bathtub with me yesterday.
2. The choir \_\_\_\_\_ at the concert tomorrow night.
3. She always \_\_\_\_\_ on the track behind the school.
4. They \_\_\_\_\_ for their honeymoon tomorrow night.
5. He \_\_\_\_\_ beside me every day in class.
6. Last night I \_\_\_\_\_ to my boyfriend for hours.

#### Word List:

- jump
- leave
  - sing
  - run
  - talk
  - sit

## Exercise 2

### THE SIMPLE PRESENT, PAST & FUTURE

Choose a word from the box, and use it to form the simple present, simple past, or simple future tense. Use negative forms.

1. They probably won't go to the meeting tonight.
2. John usually \_\_\_\_\_ for his math tests.
3. The car swerved and \_\_\_\_\_ the tree.
4. The restaurant owner gets mad when his employees \_\_\_\_\_ their hands.
5. We \_\_\_\_\_ the game, but we had a great time.
6. She \_\_\_\_\_ her homework tomorrow.

#### Word List:

- wash
- hit
- finish
- go
- study
- win

## Exercise 3

### THE SIMPLE PRESENT, PAST & FUTURE

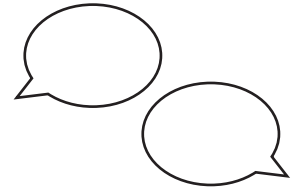
Use the words in parentheses to form the simple present, simple past, or simple future tense.

1. I bought a new dress last week.  
(buy)
2. My sister \_\_\_\_\_ breakfast every day.  
(eat)
3. Mr. Jones \_\_\_\_\_ never satisfied with his students' work.  
(be)
4. The pilot \_\_\_\_\_ at the airport until after 9:00.  
(arrive, not)
5. I \_\_\_\_\_ to your party if you really want me to.  
(come)
6. She \_\_\_\_\_ happy when she heard the bad news.  
(be, not)
7. \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ me the day after tomorrow?  
(call)
8. He \_\_\_\_\_ to school very often.  
(go, not)
9. \_\_\_\_\_ your brother \_\_\_\_\_ you two weeks ago?  
(visit)
10. \_\_\_\_\_ she usually \_\_\_\_\_ a dress to school?  
(wear)

## Exercise 4

### THE SIMPLE PAST & THE SIMPLE FUTURE

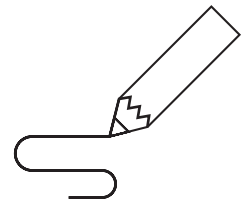
What did you do last weekend? What are you going to do next weekend? Get into pairs or small groups, and discuss your weekend plans. Use past and future verbs.



## Exercise 5

### THE SIMPLE PAST & THE SIMPLE FUTURE

Write two paragraphs about traveling. Write the first paragraph about a holiday you enjoyed (use past verbs). Write the second paragraph about a trip you want to take (use future verbs).



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## Exercise 6

### THE SIMPLE PRESENT & THE PRESENT PROGRESSIVE

Complete the story. Use the verbs provided to form sentences with the simple present or the present progressive tense.

Every Sunday my family \_\_\_\_\_ to the zoo. My little sister \_\_\_\_\_ the lions.  
1. go 2. love

We \_\_\_\_\_ at the zoo right now, and it \_\_\_\_\_ a beautiful day.  
3. be 4. be

We \_\_\_\_\_ the big cat show. The zookeeper \_\_\_\_\_ the lions.  
5. watch 6. feed

The lions always \_\_\_\_\_ excited at mealtime! They usually \_\_\_\_\_ over the meat,  
7. get 8. fight

and my sister \_\_\_\_\_ scared sometimes. But today she \_\_\_\_\_ afraid.  
9. get 10. feel, not

Today she \_\_\_\_\_ and \_\_\_\_\_ her hands.  
11. smile 12. clap

I \_\_\_\_\_ that she \_\_\_\_\_ to bring a lion home as a pet.  
13. think 14. want

Now she \_\_\_\_\_ out to the lions, "Here, kitty, kitty!"  
15. call

## Exercise 7

### THE SIMPLE PAST & THE PAST PROGRESSIVE

#### A. Matching

Work with a partner to make complete sentences. Take turns reading the completed sentences out loud. Do they all make sense?

- |                                                            |                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <u>  d  </u> 1. when my alarm clock rang                   | a) I was daydreaming              |
| <u>     </u> 2. when my car hit the tree                   | b) I was waiting for her          |
| <u>     </u> 3. when the phone rang                        | c) I was taking a shower          |
| <u>     </u> 4. when the teacher yelled at me              | d) I was sleeping                 |
| <u>     </u> 5. when my grandmother arrived at the airport | e) I was driving                  |
| <u>     </u> 6. when it was time to leave the office       | f) I was still writing the report |

#### B. Writing

Now write the complete sentences.  
Don't forget to add a comma when you begin your sentence with "when."

1. When my alarm clock rang, I was sleeping. / I was sleeping when my alarm clock rang.
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_
4. \_\_\_\_\_
5. \_\_\_\_\_
6. \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 8

### THE SIMPLE FUTURE & THE FUTURE PROGRESSIVE

Work with a small group. Imagine that you are hosting a big party for your friend's birthday. Now imagine what you and your guests will be doing at various times during the party. Share ideas and complete the sentences below together.

Ex. When the food is served, our guests will be starving.

1. When our friend arrives, \_\_\_\_\_

2. When it's time for presents, \_\_\_\_\_

3. When the dancing starts, \_\_\_\_\_

4. When the music stops, \_\_\_\_\_

5. When the cake is served, \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 9

### ALL TENSES

Rewrite the sentences by changing the verb tense.  
Change the time marker if necessary.

1. He doesn't feel good right now. (*past*)

---

2. The cat caught a bird. (*future*)

---

3. My neighbor was waiting for the package to arrive. (*present progressive*)

---

4. I watched TV for two hours last night. (*past progressive*)

---

5. The students are going to take a test next week. (*past*)

---

6. She is studying French nowadays. (*future*)

---

7. They went to the park a week ago. (*present progressive*)

---

8. I went swimming every day when I was a child. (*present*)

---

9. Mary was playing the guitar when the phone rang. (*future progressive*)

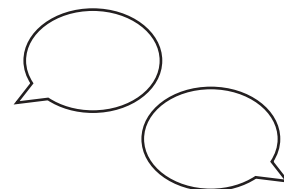
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10. Our teacher told us to be quiet. (*present progressive*)

---

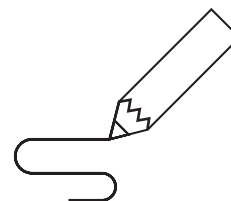
## ALL TENSES

Get into pairs or small groups and discuss your goals and dreams. When you were a child, what dreams did you have for the future (job, family, etc.)? What ambitions do you have for the future? What steps are you taking now to accomplish your goals? Try to use all six verb tenses as often as you can.



## ALL TENSES

Write a short story about something that affected you in the past. It can be real or made-up. Describe the past event, and explain how it affects you nowadays. Write about how you think it will affect you in the future, and what steps you will take to overcome or learn from it. Try to use all six verb tenses at least once.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

## Exercise 12

### ALL TENSES

Complete the story. Use the verbs provided to form sentences with the appropriate verb tense.

I \_\_\_\_\_ to travel. When I was young, I \_\_\_\_\_ to Paris.  
1. love 2. go

I \_\_\_\_\_ the day that I \_\_\_\_\_ the Eiffel Tower.  
3. remember 4. visit

People \_\_\_\_\_ to go to the top when someone suddenly \_\_\_\_\_ a gun.  
5. line up 6. fire

Everyone \_\_\_\_\_ really scared, and we left. But that \_\_\_\_\_ me from wanting  
7. be 8. stop, not

to go back to Paris. In fact, I \_\_\_\_\_ another trip now. I \_\_\_\_\_ back to Paris next  
9. plan 10. go

summer. I \_\_\_\_\_ so excited! Last time I only \_\_\_\_\_ for one week, so this time I  
11. be 12. go

\_\_\_\_\_ for three weeks. In my mind, I \_\_\_\_\_ on the Avenue des Champs-Élysées  
13. go 14. shop

already. I \_\_\_\_\_ time to visit the Louvre on my last trip, so this time I \_\_\_\_\_  
15. have 16. go

there for sure. Even though I \_\_\_\_\_ excited, sometimes I dream that people \_\_\_\_\_  
17. feel 18. line up

for the Eiffel Tower when a gunshot \_\_\_\_\_. But then I \_\_\_\_\_,  
19. go off 20. wake up

and I \_\_\_\_\_ that it probably \_\_\_\_\_ again.  
21. realize 22. happen, not

At the moment, I \_\_\_\_\_ the days!  
23. count down

# Answer Key

### NOTE:

When the simple future tense is required, answers using the form *will + base verb* are listed below, but other future forms (*be going to + verb* or *be + -ing verb*) may be possible.

### LESSON DESCRIPTION:

This review lesson offers exercises that combine two or more of the following tenses: the simple present, simple past, simple future, present progressive, past progressive, and future progressive. Students will also find handy tips about time markers so that they can recognize these tenses in context. Use this lesson as a review or quiz after studying the tenses separately.

**LEVEL:** Int

**TIME:** 2 hours

**TAGS:** simple present, simple past, simple future, present progressive, past progressive, future progressive, negative forms, time markers, mixed tenses, verbs, verb tenses, simple tenses, verb tense review

## Exercise 1

- |              |               |           |
|--------------|---------------|-----------|
| 1. jumped    | 3. runs       | 5. sits   |
| 2. will sing | 4. will leave | 6. talked |

## Exercise 2

- |                  |               |                 |
|------------------|---------------|-----------------|
| 1. won't go      | 3. didn't hit | 5. didn't win   |
| 2. doesn't study | 4. don't wash | 6. won't finish |

## Exercise 3

- |                 |                |
|-----------------|----------------|
| 1. bought       | 6. wasn't      |
| 2. eats         | 7. Will, call  |
| 3. is           | 8. doesn't go  |
| 4. won't arrive | 9. Did, visit  |
| 5. will come    | 10. Does, wear |

## Exercise 4

Answers will vary. You may choose to assign a group member to keep track of how many times each student uses the past and future forms.

## Exercise 5

Answers will vary.

## Exercise 6

- |                 |                  |                |
|-----------------|------------------|----------------|
| 1. goes         | 6. is feeding    | 11. is smiling |
| 2. loves        | 7. get           | 12. clapping   |
| 3. are          | 8. fight         | 13. think      |
| 4. is           | 9. gets          | 14. wants      |
| 5. are watching | 10. doesn't feel | 15. is calling |

(continued on the next page...)

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 7

#### A. MATCHING

1. d      2. e      3. c      4. a      5. b      6. f

#### B. WRITING

1. When my alarm clock rang, I was sleeping. /  
I was sleeping when my alarm clock rang.
2. When my car hit the tree, I was driving. /  
I was driving when my car hit the tree.
3. When the phone rang, I was taking a shower. /  
I was taking a shower when the phone rang.
4. When the teacher yelled at me, I was daydreaming. /  
I was daydreaming when the teacher yelled at me.
5. When my grandmother arrived at the airport, I was  
waiting for her. / I was waiting for my grandmother  
when she arrived at the airport.
6. When it was time to leave the office, I was still  
writing the report. / I was still writing the report  
when it was time to leave the office.

### Exercise 8

Answers will vary.

### Exercise 9

Time markers may vary.

1. He didn't feel good yesterday.
2. The cat will catch a bird.
3. My neighbor is waiting for the package to arrive.
4. I was watching TV for two hours last night.
5. The students took a test last week.
6. She will study French next month.
7. They are going to the park now.
8. I go swimming every day.
9. Mary will be playing the guitar when the phone rings.
10. Our teacher is telling us to be quiet.

### Exercise 10

Answers will vary. You may choose to assign a group member to keep track of how many times each student uses each verb tense.

### Exercise 11

Answers will vary.

*(continued on the next page...)*

## Answer Key cont.

### Exercise 12

- |                               |                       |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------|
| 1. love                       | 14. am shopping       |
| 2. went                       | 15. didn't have       |
| 3. remember                   | 16. am going to go /  |
| 4. visited / was visiting     | am going / will go    |
| 5. were lining up             | 17. feel              |
| 6. fired                      | 18. will be lining up |
| 7. was                        | 19. goes off          |
| 8. doesn't stop / didn't stop | 20. wake up           |
| 9. am planning                | 21. realize           |
| 10. am going to go /          | 22. won't happen /    |
| am going / will go            | isn't going to happen |
| 11. am                        | 23. am counting down  |
| 12. went                      |                       |
| 13. am going to go /          |                       |
| am going / will go            |                       |

### SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Traveling* and *Neighbor*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Travelling* and *Neighbour*. Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

### EDITOR'S NOTES:

This lesson should show you which tenses your students are still struggling with. Try the following sections for further practice:

- Grammar Practice Worksheets  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons>
- Basic Grammar Sentences  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/89/lessons>
- Grammar Stories  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/90/lessons>

For teaching tips, charts, and examples of the individual verb tenses, refer to our blog post:  
<http://blog.esllibrary.com/2014/07/24/100-days-of-grammar/>

For answers requiring the simple future tense, *will + base verb* is listed, but other future forms may be possible (*be going to + verb*, *be + -ing verb*).

# Verb Tense Review 2 – The Perfect Tenses

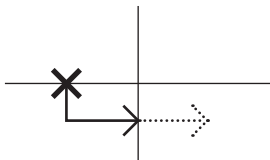
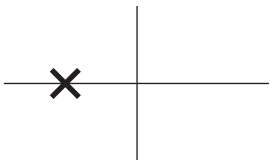
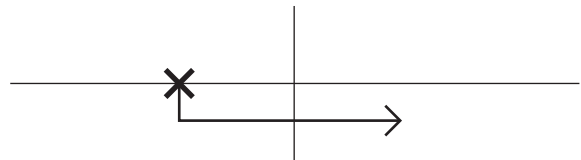
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## Grammar Notes

### THE 6 PERFECT TENSES & TIME MARKERS

#### A. Present Perfect & Present Perfect Progressive

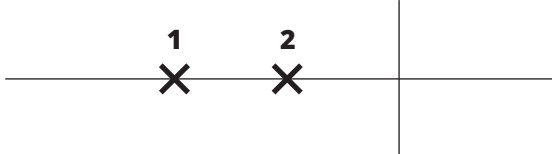
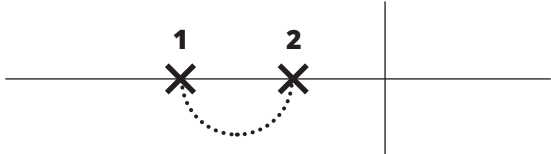
| Tense        | Present Perfect                                                                              |                                                                                                                 | Present Perfect Progressive                                                                |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |             |                                |          |
| Form         | Have / Has + Past Participle                                                                 |                                                                                                                 | Have / Has + Been + -ing Verb                                                              |
| Function     | An action that starts in the past, continues to the present, and may continue to the future. | An undefined past action (we don't know <i>when</i> the action occurred).                                       | An action starts in the past, continues to the present, and will continue into the future. |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>for</li> <li>since</li> <li>all</li> </ul>            | (none required, though <i>ever</i> , <i>never</i> , <i>already</i> , <i>still</i> , and <i>yet</i> may be used) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>for</li> <li>since</li> <li>all</li> </ul>          |
| Example      | I <b>have studied</b> English for five years.                                                | I <b>have been</b> to Paris.                                                                                    | I <b>have been living</b> in New York City since 2006.                                     |

#### Notes:

- For** and **all** indicate duration.
  - They have been traveling **for** six months.
  - We've been in a meeting **all** morning.
- Since** shows the starting point.
  - He has played the guitar **since** May 2012.
- Ever** emphasizes "at any time in the past."
  - Have you **ever** been to Europe?
- Never** emphasizes "at no time in the past."
  - I've **never** been to Europe.
- Already** emphasizes that an action has occurred.
  - We have **already** read this book.
- Still** and **yet** signify the intention to do something.
  - She **still** hasn't finished the assignment.
  - She hasn't finished the assignment **yet**.

## Grammar Notes cont.

### B. Past Perfect & Past Perfect Progressive

| Tense        | Past Perfect                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Past Perfect Progressive                                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                            |
| Form         | Had + Past Participle                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Had + Been + -ing Verb                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Function     | The first past action finished before the second past action.                                                                                                                                                            | The first past action continued until the second past action.                                                                                                                                |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>by the time</li> <li>when</li> <li>before</li> <li>after</li> </ul> (Note: The typical past markers <i>last</i> , <i>yesterday</i> , and <i>ago</i> are often additionally used.) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>by the time</li> <li>when</li> <li>before</li> </ul> (Note: The typical progressive markers <i>for</i> and <i>since</i> are often additionally used.) |
| Examples     | I <b>had finished</b> dinner by the time he called me last night.                                                                                                                                                        | My sister <b>had been studying</b> English for 11 years before she entered university.                                                                                                       |

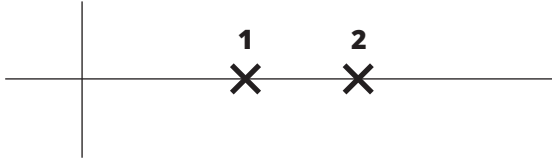
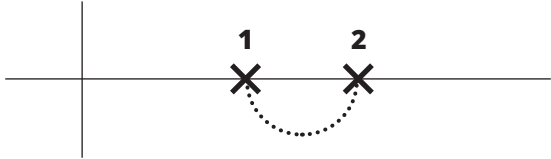
#### Note:

In English, it is possible to begin a sentence with either an **independent clause** (with the past perfect/past perfect progressive verb) or a **dependent clause** (with the time marker) with no change in meaning. Remember to use a comma when a sentence begins with a dependent clause.

- I **had finished** dinner by the time he called me last night.
- By the time he called me last night, I **had finished** dinner.
- My sister **had been studying** English for 11 years before she entered university.
- Before she entered university, my sister **had been studying** English for 11 years.

## Grammar Notes cont.

### C. Future Perfect & Future Perfect Progressive

| Tense        | Future Perfect                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Future Perfect Progressive                                                                                                                                                |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Diagram      |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                         |
| Form         | Will + Have + Past Participle                                                                                                                                                                                   | Will + Have + Been + -ing Verb                                                                                                                                            |
| Function     | The first future action will finish before the second future action.                                                                                                                                            | The first future action will continue until the second future action.                                                                                                     |
| Time Markers | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>by the time</li> <li>when</li> <li>before</li> </ul> (Note: The typical future markers <i>next</i> , <i>tomorrow</i> , and <i>from now</i> are often additionally used.) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>by the time</li> <li>when</li> <li>before</li> </ul> (Note: The typical progressive marker <i>for</i> is often additionally used.) |
| Examples     | I <b>will have finished</b> dinner by the time she calls me tonight.                                                                                                                                            | I <b>will have been studying</b> for two hours by the time she calls me tonight.                                                                                          |

#### Note:

In English, it is possible to begin a sentence with either an **independent clause** (with the future perfect/future perfect progressive verb) or a **dependent clause** (with the time marker) with no change in meaning. Remember to use a comma when a sentence begins with a dependent clause.

- I **will have finished** dinner by the time she calls me tonight.
- By the time she calls me tonight, I **will have finished** dinner.
- I **will have been studying** for two hours by the time she calls me tonight.
- By the time she calls me tonight, I **will have been studying** for two hours.

## Exercise 1

### PRESENT PERFECT & SIMPLE PAST

Write the simple past or present perfect form of the verb in parentheses.

1. I'm late. The class has already started .  
(start)
2. I \_\_\_\_\_ in a course a week ago.  
(enroll)
3. \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ preparing your presentation last night?  
(finish)
4. She \_\_\_\_\_ me back yesterday.  
(call, not)
5. My accountant \_\_\_\_\_ me the tax package.  
(give)
6. The athlete \_\_\_\_\_ for hours on the weekend.  
(train)
7. I sang while I \_\_\_\_\_ my house.  
(clean)
8. He \_\_\_\_\_ the latest news.  
(hear, not)
9. I \_\_\_\_\_ my face and I went to bed.  
(wash)
10. \_\_\_\_\_ you \_\_\_\_\_ for Paris yet?  
(leave)

## Exercise 2

### PRESENT PERFECT & PRESENT PERFECT PROGRESSIVE

Change the present perfect into the present perfect progressive whenever it's possible.

1. She has studied French for seven years.

She has been studying French for seven years.

2. The old woman has lived in this apartment since 1976.

\_\_\_\_\_

3. I have never been to this neighborhood before.

\_\_\_\_\_

4. Our teacher has given us a lot of homework lately.

\_\_\_\_\_

5. My brother has watched TV for the past two hours.

\_\_\_\_\_

6. We have made an appointment to meet with the CEO.

\_\_\_\_\_

7. Our waiter has only come by our table once.

\_\_\_\_\_

8. Have you already seen this movie?

\_\_\_\_\_

9. They have tried to fix the problem.

\_\_\_\_\_

10. My mother hasn't spoken to me about my behavior yet.

\_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 3

### PAST PERFECT & PAST PERFECT PROGRESSIVE

Fill in the blanks with a verb from the box.  
Use the past perfect or the past perfect progressive tense.

- The students had written their final exams before they graduated.
- His sister \_\_\_\_\_ for eight hours before her alarm clock rang.
- My father \_\_\_\_\_ for two hours by the time the doctor saw him.
- By the time he left work for the day, Mr. Jones \_\_\_\_\_ the report.
- By the time she arrived at the restaurant, they \_\_\_\_\_ home.
- My aunt \_\_\_\_\_ for three hours before everyone showed up.

#### Word List:

- wait
- go
- cook
- sleep
- write
- finish

## Exercise 4

### FUTURE PERFECT & FUTURE PERFECT PROGRESSIVE

Find and correct the error in each future perfect or future perfect progressive sentence.

- |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>She will have been waiting for two hours by the time the doctor saw her.<br/><u>She will have been waiting for two hours</u><br/><u>by the time the doctor sees her.</u></li> <li>Mrs. Cooper will has been traveling for weeks by the time she has to return the rental car.<br/>_____<br/>_____</li> <li>My friend will have been feeding his dog before he takes it to the vet.<br/>_____<br/>_____</li> </ol> | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Her teacher will have graded her final exam before she apply to university.<br/>_____<br/>_____</li> <li>The class will have been reading Chapter 4 before they begin Chapter 5.<br/>_____<br/>_____</li> <li>By the time they will have been going to the national competition, the teammates will have been playing together for months.<br/>_____<br/>_____</li> </ol> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

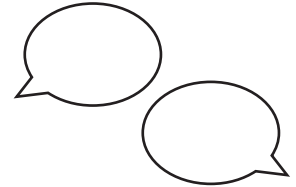
## Exercise 5

### ALL 6 PERFECT TENSES

#### A. Speaking

Tell your partner about your life's accomplishments and your future plans.

- Talk about your past achievements.  
*Use the present perfect, past perfect, and/or past perfect progressive.*
- Talk about goals you are working toward now.  
*Use the present perfect and/or present perfect progressive.*
- Talk about your future plans.  
*Use the future perfect and/or future perfect progressive.*



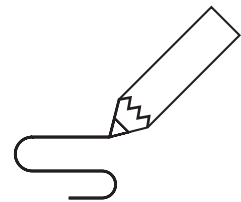
#### Examples:

- I had been learning French for four years by the time I was ten years old.
- I have been married for 14 years.
- I will have traveled all over the world for work before I retire.

#### B. Writing

Now write about your partner's life achievements and goals in your notebook.

- Write two sentences about past achievements.  
*Use the present perfect, past perfect, and/or past perfect progressive.*
- Write two sentences about goals he or she is working toward now.  
*Use the present perfect and/or present perfect progressive.*
- Write two sentences about future plans.  
*Use the future perfect and/or future perfect progressive.*



#### Examples:

- Lisa had received two science awards before she entered high school.
- Lisa has been driving for six years.
- Lisa will have been studying English for 25 years by the time she is 40.

## Exercise 6

### ALL 6 PERFECT TENSES

Make sentences with the verb forms indicated below. Choose a suitable time marker for each sentence. Words in parentheses will be necessary for some tenses, but not for others.

1. she / finish dinner / he / called

Past Perfect: She had finished dinner by the time he called.

Future Perfect: She will have finished dinner by the time he calls.

2. my cousin / play / the guitar / several years

Present Perfect: \_\_\_\_\_

Present Perfect Progressive: \_\_\_\_\_

3. everyone / leave / my coworker / lock up

Past Perfect: \_\_\_\_\_

Future Perfect: \_\_\_\_\_

4. my friend / do / yoga / 1995

Present Perfect: \_\_\_\_\_

Present Perfect Progressive: \_\_\_\_\_

5. you / sleep / eight hours / I / call / you

Past Perfect Progressive: \_\_\_\_\_

Future Perfect Progressive: \_\_\_\_\_

6. she / live / overseas / (get married)

Present Perfect: \_\_\_\_\_

Past Perfect: \_\_\_\_\_

Future Perfect: \_\_\_\_\_

7. he / study / English / for five years / (2010 or 2020)

Present Perfect Progressive: \_\_\_\_\_

Past Perfect Progressive: \_\_\_\_\_

Future Perfect Progressive: \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 7

### ALL 12 SIMPLE & PERFECT TENSES

Write each verb in the correct verb tense to complete the story.  
Some tenses will be used more than once. If more than one tense is possible, try to list all the possibilities.

### My Career Path

When I was a child, I really                       
1. be 2. want

to be a ballerina. By the time I                      ten years old,  
3. be

I                      ballet for six years. One day, I                      onstage when I  
4. practice 5. dance

                     and                      my ankle. I had to                      dancing for a while.  
6. fall 7. twist 8. stop

After that, I                      interested in interior design. I                      hours  
9. become 10. spend

rearranging my mother's furniture. I                      a lot by the time I                       
11. learn, already 12. enter

college to                      my degree in interior design.  
13. do

Now I                      at a design firm downtown. I                      my job! I                       
14. work 15. love 16. work

here for two years. I                      here for three years by the time I                      my own office.  
17. work 18. get

I                      very satisfied at that time.  
19. feel

In my life, I                      a lot of practice designing and decorating rooms.  
20. have

I                      I                      quite good at it, too.  
21. think 22. be

Can you                      that by the time I                      65, I                       
23. believe 24. be 25. work

at the same company for 25 years? At that time, I                      I                      ready to retire.  
26. think 27. be

#### Verb Tenses:

- simple present
- present progressive
- simple past
- past progressive
- simple future
- future progressive
- present perfect
- present perfect progressive
- past perfect
- past perfect progressive
- future perfect
- future perfect progressive

## Exercise 8

### QUIZ: ALL 12 SIMPLE & PERFECT TENSES

Circle the correct verb tense for each sentence.

1. By the time she gets this message, we \_\_\_\_\_ the meeting.
  - a) will start
  - b) will have been starting
  - c) will have started
  - d) are starting
2. My roommate must be tired. She \_\_\_\_\_ for nine hours.
  - a) am sleeping
  - b) has been sleeping
  - c) will have been sleeping
  - d) will be sleeping
3. \_\_\_\_\_ to Japan?
  - a) Have you traveled
  - b) Did you travel
  - c) Are you traveled
  - d) Had you traveled
4. Mr. Jacobs \_\_\_\_\_ here since 1991.
  - a) taught
  - b) will be teaching
  - c) is teaching
  - d) has been teaching
5. My husband's cell phone rang while he \_\_\_\_\_.
  - a) had driven
  - b) had been driving
  - c) was driving
  - d) drove
6. By the time their friend arrived, they \_\_\_\_\_ for three hours.
  - a) will have been waiting
  - b) have been waiting
  - c) had been waiting
  - d) are waiting
7. When he finishes preparing for his presentation, he \_\_\_\_\_ home.
  - a) will go
  - b) goes
  - c) will have gone
  - d) will have been going
8. He had been studying for two hours when the doorbell \_\_\_\_\_.
  - a) rang
  - b) had been ringing
  - c) was ringing
  - d) had rung
9. They \_\_\_\_\_ by the time the university president resigns.
  - a) will have been graduating
  - b) had graduated
  - c) had been graduating
  - d) will have graduated
10. I \_\_\_\_\_ what you mean.
  - a) saw
  - b) will be seeing
  - c) see
  - d) am seeing

# Answer Key

## LESSON DESCRIPTION:

This review lesson includes exercises that combine the present perfect, present perfect progressive, past perfect, past perfect progressive, future perfect, and future perfect progressive tenses. Use this lesson as a review or quiz after studying the tenses separately. Students will also have a chance to try exercises that combine all 12 tenses.

**LEVEL:** Adv

**TIME:** 2 hours

**TAGS:** verb tenses, perfect tenses, present perfect, past perfect, future perfect, present perfect progressive, past perfect progressive, future perfect progressive, quiz, mixed tenses, perfect tense review, verb tense review

## Exercise 1

- |                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| 1. has, started | 6. trained      |
| 2. enrolled     | 7. cleaned      |
| 3. Did, finish  | 8. hasn't heard |
| 4. didn't call  | 9. washed       |
| 5. has given    | 10. Have, left  |

## Exercise 2

1. She has been studying French for seven years.
2. The old woman has been living in this apartment since 1976.
3. Not possible.
4. Our teacher has been giving us a lot of homework lately.
5. My brother has been watching TV for the past two hours.
6. Not possible.
7. Not possible.
8. Not possible.
9. They have been trying to fix the problem.
10. Not possible.

## Exercise 3

- |                      |                     |
|----------------------|---------------------|
| 1. had written       | 4. had finished     |
| 2. had been sleeping | 5. had gone         |
| 3. had been waiting  | 6. had been cooking |

## Exercise 4

1. She will have been waiting for two hours by the time the doctor **sees** her.
2. Mrs. Cooper will **have** been traveling for weeks by the time she has to return the rental car.
3. My friend will have **fed** his dog before he takes it to the vet.
4. Her teacher will have graded her final exam before she **applies** to university.
5. The class will have **read** Chapter 4 before they begin Chapter 5.
6. By the time they **go** to the national competition, the teammates will have been playing together for months.

## Exercise 5

Individual answers.

*(continued on the next page...)*

# Answer Key cont.

## Exercise 6

Time markers will vary.

1. She had finished dinner by the time he called.  
She will have finished dinner by the time he calls.
2. My cousin has played the guitar for several years.  
My cousin has been playing the guitar for several years.
3. Everyone had left by the time the coworker locked up.  
Everyone will have left by the time my coworker locks up.
4. My friend has done yoga since 1995.  
My friend has been doing yoga since 1995.
5. You had been sleeping for eight hours by the time I called you.  
You will have been sleeping for eight hours by the time I call you.
6. She has lived overseas.  
She had lived overseas before she got married.  
She will have lived overseas before she gets married.
7. He has been studying English for five years.  
He had been studying English for five years by 2010.  
He will have been studying English for five years by 2020.

## Exercise 7

- |                         |                                 |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 1. was                  | 16. have been working /         |
| 2. wanted               | have worked                     |
| 3. was                  | 17. will have been working /    |
| 4. had been practicing  | will have worked                |
| 5. was dancing          | 18. get                         |
| 6. fell                 | 19. will feel / will be feeling |
| 7. twisted              | 20. have had                    |
| 8. stop                 | 21. think                       |
| 9. became               | 22. am                          |
| 10. spent               | 23. believe                     |
| 11. had already learned | 24. am                          |
| 12. entered             | 25. will have been working /    |
| 13. do                  | will have worked                |
| 14. am working / work   | 26. think                       |
| 15. love                | 27. will be                     |

## Exercise 8

- |      |      |      |      |       |
|------|------|------|------|-------|
| 1. c | 3. a | 5. c | 7. a | 9. d  |
| 2. b | 4. d | 6. c | 8. a | 10. c |

### SPELLING NOTE:

This lesson shows the American spelling of the words *Neighborhood, Behavior, Traveling, Traveled, and Practice*. Most other English-speaking countries spell these words this way: *Neighbourhood, Behaviour, Travelling, Travelled, and Practise* (when used as a verb, *Practice* when used as a noun). Also note that *Toward* is preferred in North American English, while *Towards* is preferred in British English. Make it a challenge for your students to find these words in the lesson and see if they know the alternate spellings.

### EDITOR'S NOTES:

Our Grammar Practice Worksheets, Basic Grammar Sentences, Grammar Stories, and Simple Sentences sections have many verb tense lessons for further practice.

- Grammar Practice Worksheets  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons>
- Basic Grammar Sentences  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/89/lessons>
- Grammar Stories  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/90/lessons>

Refer to our blog post, 100 Days of Grammar, for teaching tips, charts, and examples of the individual verb tenses:  
<http://blog.esllibrary.com/2014/07/24/100-days-of-grammar/>

Try *Verb Tense Review 1 – The Simple Tenses* for a review of the simple present, present progressive, simple past, past progressive, simple future, and future progressive:  
<https://esllibrary.com/courses/88/lessons/1963>